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The Sunday EXPRESS



EYE

THE WORLDS INSIDE A SONG

Irshad Kamil, one of Hindi cinema's most prolific lyricists, on how his roots in Punjab have shaped his writing for over three decades

SPOTLIGHT

Founders of The Table on building an empire, one brand at a time



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Imran's party seeks contempt action over his move to hospital

Reuters
Lahore, August 22

THE PARTY of Pakistan's jailed ex-prime minister Imran Khan filed a contempt petition against the government on Saturday after authorities took the cricketer-turned-politician to a state-run hospital instead of the private facility ordered by the top court, party officials said.

"The petition seeks action against the prime minister, law minister, information minister" and other government officials, said Naeem Panjutha, a legal advisor for the Pakistan Tehreek-e-Insaf, adding it also calls for Khan's treatment at the private hospital ordered by the court. A three-judge bench Tuesday directed the government to transfer Khan from Adiala Jail to private Shifa International Hospital in Islamabad within two days for medical examination.

Officials instead took Khan to state-run Pakistan Institute of Medical Sciences overnight on Friday for a brief check-up before returning him to jail and did not give him access to his personal physician, which the party also cites as a breach of court orders. The PTI interprets the order as requiring Khan to remain under medical supervision until at least mid-September.

RETALIATORY TARIFFS WILL START SEPTEMBER 8, MATCH U.S. DUTIES DOLLAR FOR DOLLAR, SAYS CARNEY

Canada vows retaliatory move as US puts 50% tariffs on some goods

New US tariffs to cover about \$20 bn of Canada exports

Reuters
Washington, Ottawa, August 22

CANADA WILL impose tariffs on imports from the United States starting September 8, Prime Minister Mark Carney said on Saturday, retaliating against President Donald Trump's new 50% tariffs after the two longstanding allies failed to reach a trade deal.

The new US tariffs took effect just after midnight on about \$20 billion of Canadian goods, including wine, furniture, dairy products, cement, clothing, fishing rods and hockey equipment.

They cover just over 5% of Canada's exports to the United States and do not qualify for preferential treatment under the US-Mexico-Canada free trade agreement.

"Canada will match Washington's new tariffs dollar for dollar in order to protect Canadian workers, farmers, families, and



Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney during a press conference after he suspended trade negotiations with the United States, in Ottawa, on Saturday. REUTERS

businesses," Carney said at a news conference.

Canada's tariffs will target US sectors including steel, dairy, appliances, agricultural equipment, pulp and paper and electronics, along with some sectors the US previously targeted in Canada. The government will release details over the next several days, Carney said.

"We cannot accept what they have offered, and we will not give what they have asked,"

Carney said.

After days of intense negotiations, the two countries failed to reach a deal late Friday, worsening a delicate relationship between the long-term trade partners and complicating the future of the continental free trade pact.

Carney said the US administration's last-minute demands halted progress.

"In recent days, the US proposed new terms that were un-

economic, unfair, and undermined the net benefits to Canada, calling into question the reliability of any deal," he said, adding that the demands included curtailing Canada's ability to forge new trade deals.

Carney had earlier said he suspended trade negotiations and directed Canada's negotiators to return to Ottawa. He also said Canada would announce support measures next week for industries hit by the

“Canada will match Washington's new tariffs dollar for dollar in order to protect Canadian workers, farmers, families, and businesses. We cannot accept what they (US) have offered & we will not give what they asked”

MARK CARNEY,
PRIME MINISTER OF CANADA

new US duties.

Hours before the talks collapsed, the two sides had appeared close to an agreement that sources said would have lowered tariffs on steel, aluminum and autos and potentially brought American alcohol back to Canadian liquor stores.

"Tonight, Canada declined to finalize the trade deal under the terms agreed earlier this week," US Trade Representative Jamieson Greer said during a White House briefing.

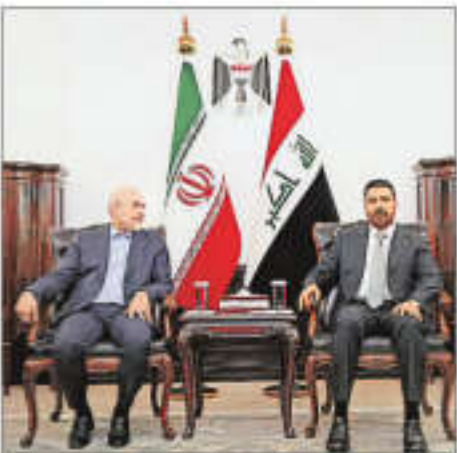
Iran allows Iraqi oil tankers to pass Hormuz

Reuters
August 22

IRAN HAS granted permission for a number of Iraqi oil tankers to pass through the Strait of Hormuz following repeated requests from Baghdad through various channels, Iran's state news agency IRNA reported on Saturday.

IRNA said obtaining special permission for Iraqi tankers was one of Baghdad's main requests during Iranian parliament speaker Mohammad Baqer Qalibaf's visit to Iraq.

Iraqi President Nizar Amedi said on Saturday that Iran had facilitated the passage of vessels carrying Iraqi oil



Iraqi Prime Minister Ali al-Zaidi with Iran parliament speaker Mohammad Baqer Ghalibaf in Baghdad. FILE

through the Strait in recent days and Baghdad had discussed the export of Iraqi oil through Hormuz with Iranian officials.

The issue remained complicated, he added, speaking at the Baghdad Dialogue policy conference.

Iraq has been among the countries most affected by Iran's effective closure of the Strait of Hormuz. Traffic in the strait remains significantly below pre-war levels and ships continue to face attacks in the area.

Iraq produced around 4 million barrels of oil per day before the outbreak of the Iran war.

Baghdad is working to expand its exports through Turkey's Ceyhan port and also to begin exporting oil through Syria's Baniyas port and Jordan's Aqaba port, Prime Minister Ali al-Zaidi said on Friday.

Move detained pilots to hospital: Tehran to Qatar

Tehran: An Iranian military official on Saturday urged Qatar to transfer detained Iranian pilots to a hospital on land, saying they were being held at sea in "poor physical condition". *Tasnim* news agency reported.

Mohammad Baqerzadeh said the site was unsuitable and called on the International Committee of the Red Cross to send an air ambulance to expedite their return to Iran. REUTERS

China, Indonesia agree to boost defence ties; work closer on minerals and energy

Reuters
Jakarta, August 22

China and Indonesia agreed on Friday to boost military ties and work closely on minerals, energy and technology, as Jakarta seeks to balance ties with both Beijing and Washington amid economic and geopolitical tensions, including in South China Sea.

Both countries should "seize the moment," China's Foreign Minister Wang Yi said in remarks made at the start of his visit to Jakarta. He was travelling with Defence Minister Dong Jun to meet their Indonesian counterparts.

"The current international situation is intertwined and complex. Unilateralism and hegemonic acts bring serious impact on global cooperation and stability," he said. "China actively aims to build China-Indonesia cooperation at a high level," Wang added.

The two countries pledged to cooperate across multiple areas



China and Indonesia's foreign and defence ministers pose during a 2+2 meeting in Jakarta, Indonesia on Friday. FILE

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Wang said both sides agreed to support each other's core interests and will cooperate more in energy and mineral resources.

Resource-rich Indonesia, a \$1.4 trillion G20 economy, has vast deposits of nickel, tin, copper, gold and bauxite and is the world's largest exporter of palm oil and of thermal coal, with China among its top buyers.

Nigeria: Scores kidnapped as armed groups attack villages

Abuja: A number of people were kidnapped from a mosque in a spree of abductions at several villages in Nigeria's north-central Niger state, police said Saturday.

The assailants attacked a mosque in Kpenya village after attacks in a string of villages in Borgu Local Government Area of Niger state Friday, police spokesperson Wasii Abiodun said. Abiodun did not provide figures but said no lives were lost and said the military was deployed to the area. Residents said scores of people were abducted, with some estimating between 60 and 80 people were kidnapped. A search for survivors was underway Saturday.

Borgu area council chairman Abdullahi Mohammed Nasir said at least 60 people were kidnapped and an unspecified number of people sustained gunshot injuries while trying to escape the gunmen. AP

• SOME OF THE WEAPONS HAVE EXPLODED IN THE INTENSE HEAT. BLASTS HAVE BEEN REPORTED IN FRANCE, BELGIUM, GERMANY AND THE NETHERLANDS, WHERE A BOMB-DISPOSAL TEAM WAS DISPATCHED TO CHECK A FOREST

As Europe burns, wildfires uncover bombs and mines left behind by two world wars

Sam Mcneil
Elsenborn (Belgium), August 22

THE WILDFIRES burning across Europe this summer have exposed a potentially deadly threat lurking beneath the blackened landscape: rusty bombs and mines from World War I and II that threaten crews responding to the flames.

Some of the weapons have exploded in the intense heat. Blasts have been reported in France, Belgium, Germany and the Netherlands, where a bomb-disposal team was dispatched to check a forest threatened by flames near a site of fierce fighting in the Lim-

burg province in 1944.

Fuelled by climate change, the fires and explosions show that the continent's "climatic luck" is running out, said Sarah Njeri, a peace and conflict scholar at London's School of Oriental and African Studies. Steady temperatures and predictable rainfall once ensured that most buried weapons stayed dormant.

"Climate change is now doing the work of unburying and reactivating what was previously stable," Njeri said. Fires can ignite old munitions but can also burn away the scrub and brush that hides them.

This wildfire season was supercharged by heavy rains in

January that spurred vegetation growth, which became kindling when the summer heat arrived.

Those temperatures, combined with drought conditions, low humidity and stiff winds, offered an ideal environment for fire, according to a study issued last month by the World Weather Attribution group.

As they advanced, the flames moved over territory that has long been known to hold unexploded weapons, a lethal legacy that lingered long after the guns fell silent.

In a forest in tinder-dry France, a massive wildfire outside the southwestern city of Bordeaux uncovered a cache of what is believed to be World



Members of a bomb disposal unit sit next to 1.8 ton World War II bomb after defusing it in Frankfurt, Germany. AP

War II-era ammunition.

In the eastern Belgian province of Liege, Gov. Hervé Jamar said "a few sporadic deton-

ations" were recently heard and that emergency services were adapting to account for munitions buried in a fire area.

He said no fire crews were in danger, but local media published photos of a firefighter handling a rusted bomb.

During World War II, booby traps, bombs and mines were sprinkled throughout the province's dense peat-bog forest known as the High Fens. In the first four years after Germany's surrender in 1945, the munitions killed six civilians, said Bernard Collard, a local historian who runs the Truschbaum Museum near Belgium's border with Germany that houses a collection of found objects from the war.

"When you go into a forest like this, you are not sure where the explosives are," he said. He remembers his father detonat-

• BRIEFLY

CHINA

Humanoid robot beats Usain Bolt's 100m world record in test run



A Lightning humanoid robot developed by Honor during test run

A HUMANOID robot developed by Chinese smart phone maker Honor ran 100 meters in 9.32 seconds, China's state broadcaster reported Saturday, beating the human world record held by Jamaican sprinting great Usain Bolt. The robot, dubbed Lightning, reached a top speed of 14.5 meters per second during a preparatory test event for the second World Humanoid Robot Games in Beijing on Saturday. The performance surpassed the 9.58-second men's 100-metre world record set by Bolt in 2009. REUTERS

TUNISIA

13 missing after migrant boat sinks off coast

AT LEAST 13 Tunisians are missing after a migrant boat sank off Tunisian coast while sailing towards Italy and two people have been rescued, head of a migrant rights group said Saturday. The boat was carrying young people, including seven members of a family, as well as a man and his wife, Mostafa Abdelkebir, head of the Tunisian Observatory for Human Rights said. REUTERS

UNITED KINGDOM

7 killed after car collides with police vehicle

SEVEN PEOPLE including two police officers died in a car crash in northeast England on Saturday after a vehicle heading the wrong way down a major road hit a marked police car, the local police force said. "This tragic incident will be felt across Cleveland, within our communities and throughout the policing family," Cleveland Police Chief Constable Victoria Fuller said. REUTERS

• NEIGHBOURHOOD WATCH

PAKISTAN

18 militants arrested in Pak's Punjab

LAW ENFORCEMENT agencies in Pakistan's Punjab province arrested 18 militants of various banned terrorist outfits over the past week, the police said on Saturday. Over 3 kgs of explosives, eight detonators, 13.1 feet of safety fuse, 4.5 feet of primacord, four pistols and 21 bullets have been seized. PTI

SRI LANKA

UN welcomes refugee return efforts from India

THE UNITED Nations on Saturday welcomed Sri Lanka's decision to simplify immigration procedures to expedite the voluntary return of refugees from India. The Sri Lankan government made special arrangements for the initiative aimed at streamlining the process to facilitate the returns. PTI

Congo gets over 16,000 doses of Ebola vaccine amid record outbreak

Associated Press
Bunia, August 22

CONGO HAS received more than 16,000 doses of the Ervebo vaccine as the country grapples with the fastest Ebola outbreak in history, the country's health minister said.

The 16,250 doses arrived at the N'djili International Airport in the capital, Kinshasa, late Friday, as part of 70,000 doses expected from the World Health Organization and partners that were announced on Thursday. More doses are expected early next week.

The current Ebola outbreak in Congo is caused by the rare Bundibugyo virus, which currently has no approved treatment or vaccine.

It can spread easily and go undetected because some of its symptoms are similar to other illnesses, such as malaria.

The Ervebo vaccine is licensed to treat Ebola and has been effective in past outbreaks. The WHO said it may provide some protection



Health workers during a Ebola awareness campaign in Beni, eastern Congo, on Saturday. AP

against the Bundibugyo virus. The latest outbreak, which has recorded 2,557 deaths out of the 5,375 confirmed cases across six affected provinces, is spreading at an unprecedented rate and is on track to surpass the deadliest outbreak on record, which killed over 11,000 people across West Africa between 2014 and 2016. Data from the Africa Centre for Disease Control shows that transmission has not yet peaked and could reach three times its known rate.



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PUBLIC AWARENESS — KNOW WHAT THE HIGH COURT ACTUALLY SAID

“ONE OF THE BIGGEST SCAMS IN THE STATE OF KARNATAKA”

THE NICE ROAD / BMICP TOLL PROJECT — IN THE KARNATAKA HIGH COURT'S OWN WORDS

Karnataka High Court, Division Bench judgment dated 29.07.2026 — W.A. No.1214/2025 & connected matters



SCAN FOR HC OBSERVATIONS



5 / 111 km
Expressway built in 25–26 years



20,193 Acres
of farmers' land acquired for the project



554 Acres
of "excess" land admittedly handed to NICE



20,000+ Acres
land bank NICE now sits on



THE JUDICIAL VERDICT: HIGH COURT FINDINGS

The Hon'ble High Court of Karnataka has observed that the Bengaluru-Mysuru Infrastructure Corridor (BMIC) project "appears to be one of the biggest scams in Karnataka".



THE CONTRACT VIOLATIONS: LEGISLATIVE REPORT

In December 2016, an 11-member Legislative House Committee headed by Shri T.B. Jayachandra submitted a comprehensive 391-page report confirming extensive contractual, financial, and environmental violations by NICE.

IN THE COURT'S OWN WORDS

"The State authorities are accomplice in this fraud and gross breaches and violations of the FWA. The proposed project has not done any public good or served any public purpose except to benefit the project proponent in unimaginable properties."
— Para 72, Page 281

"There is nothing nice about the NICE project except that the farmers have been robbed of their lands and livelihood of generations without payment of compensation as mandated under Article 300A of the Constitution of India."
— Para 88, Page 288–289

"It appears that this BMICP may be one of the biggest scam in the State of Karnataka... a State, which is the trustee of the natural resources on behalf of the citizens, can allow the private interest to flourish in utter violation of the constitutional mandate... for questionable considerations."
— Para 91, Page 290

"We fail to understand why the State is not reviewing the project or cancelling the same as the NICE has utterly failed in its objective i.e., developing 5 Townships and Expressway of approximately 111 kms."
— Para 92, Page 291

"This is a fit case where an independent assessment and investigation be carried out by the special team of experts by conducting forensic audit of its accounts and for committing fraud and other criminal acts of commissions and omissions."
— Para 93, Page 291

The BMICP was conceived to connect Bengaluru and Mysuru through:

- * Five townships;
- * An Expressway of approximately 111 kilometres together with interchanges and toll plazas;
- * A Peripheral Road of approximately 41 kilometres; and
- * A Link Road of approximately 9.8 kilometres. (paragraph 2)

The Court records the State's case that NICE violated the FWA by raising tolls without approval and receiving protected water-body lands, while also noting that NICE's claim of inadequate land was contradicted by the State's own affidavit confirming that 554 acres of excess land had been handed over. (Gist of Paragraph 31 and 32)

STATEMENT BY

SHRI H.D. KUMARASWAMY

State President, Janata Dal (Secular), Karnataka

The State High Court has made a strong observation that the NICE BMIC project appears to be one of the biggest scams in the state. Therefore, the State Government must take over the entire project. Vehicle users should not pay toll charges while travelling on the NICE Road from now on.



UNAUTHORIZED REAL ESTATE HANDOUTS (110 ACRES)

NICE executed secretive sale deeds, agreements, and Joint Development Agreements (JDAs) with private real estate developers, transferring approximately 110 acres of acquired public land worth hundreds of crores without transparency:

- Umang Realtech Pvt Ltd • Dhammanagi Developers
- SBK Properties Pvt Ltd • Ajmera Housing Corp. • Darshita Housing Pvt Ltd
- 2,472 Acres Reallocated: Land earmarked for five townships under the Outline Development Plan was quietly reallocated to road components without satisfactory documentation.
- **Environmental Damage:** Precious lake-beds and water bodies were illegally transferred to NICE, causing severe environmental degradation and impacting Bengaluru's water supply.

HOUSE COMMITTEE RECOMMENDATIONS FOR RECOVERY

- Return 11,060 Acres of Excess Land: Exclude 7,532 acres of private land and 3,528 acres of government land acquired illegally, and return it to original owners.
- Recover 242.45 Crore Penalty: Formally recover unpaid mining royalty and penalties from NICE for illegal mining.
- High-Level National Investigation: Order immediate probes by the CBI,

**1. ACQUIRED FOR THE PUBLIC. MONETISED FOR PRIVATE GAIN.
2. PUBLIC PURPOSE OR PRIVATE PROFIT?
3. ACQUISITION BECOMES COMMERCIALISATION.**

DEMANDS TO THE STATE GOVERNMENT BY TAX PAYERS

1. Take over the Bengaluru–Mysuru Infrastructure Corridor Project (BMICP) / NICE Road project with immediate effect;
2. Stop, with immediate effect, all toll collection by NICE on the Expressway, Peripheral Road and Link Road;
3. Constitute an independent special team of experts to conduct a comprehensive forensic audit of NICE's accounts and operations, as recommended by the Hon'ble High Court, and publish the report and action taken thereon;
4. Take appropriate departmental and, where warranted, criminal action against officials found complicit in the violations recorded by the High Court;
5. Restore and protect the lakes, tanks and tank-bed lands transferred to NICE, and take steps to remedy the resulting damage to Bengaluru's ecology and water supply;
6. Ensure that the affected farmers and landowners are paid fair and prompt compensation in accordance with Article 300A of the Constitution of India and applicable law

**WE, THE PUBLIC, DEMAND: STOP THE TOLL, NOW • TAKE OVER THE PROJECT
• ORDER THE FORENSIC AUDIT THE COURT ITSELF ASKED FOR**

Source: Karnataka High Court, judgment dated 29.07.2026 in W.A. No.1214/2025 and connected Writ Appeals

THE FCNR(B) SWAP FACILITY WILL CLOSE ON AUGUST 31

RBI's forex swap window attracts \$72.85 bn till Aug 21

George Mathew
Mumbai, August 22

WITH NINE days left for the closure of special forex swap facility, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) on Saturday said the scheme has attracted \$72.85 billion in foreign exchange inflows till August 21, underscoring the strong response to the central bank's measure to augment forex liquidity and support the rupee.

Data reported by authorised dealer banks to the RBI show that Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank), or FCNR(B) deposits accounted for the overwhelming share of the inflows at \$65.397 billion. This was followed by Overseas Foreign Currency Borrowings (OFCBs) at \$4.86 billion and External Commercial Borrowings (ECBs) at \$2.591 billion.

On August 14, the RBI decided to close its special forex swap facility prematurely on August 31, following an "encouraging response" as against the initial deadline of September 30. The swaps against FCNR(B) deposits mobilised under the facility, however, can be undertaken with the RBI till September 11.

With the dollar-rupee stabilising in the 95-handle, portfolio flows gradually returning, and the various funding windows likely having raised around \$70 billion-\$75 billion in aggregate, equivalent to 10-12% of prevailing foreign exchange reserves, the urgency for policymakers to maintain extraordinary support measures has diminished significantly, said Radhika Rao, ED and Senior Economist, DBS Bank. "The scale of hedging cost (borne by the central bank) was unlikely to have been a binding factor, with funds raised to-date deemed to be sufficient to prop the BOP back to a position of strength," Rao said.

The RBI may have closed the swap facility prematurely, with some suggesting that the high cost of hedging these deposits may have played a role. The potential cost to the RBI could be around 15% of the amount raised. Assuming \$70 billion is raised through the facility, this



Boosting deposits

FOREIGN CURRENCY Non-Resident (Bank) deposit — known as an FCNR(B) account — are fixed-term deposits that can be maintained by non-resident Indians, Overseas Citizens of India and Persons of Indian Origin in designated foreign currencies.

INTEREST ON FCNR(B) deposits is exempt from income tax in India as long as the depositor qualifies as a non-resident under Indian tax laws.

would translate into a cost of around \$10.5 billion, according to an SBI Research report. The RBI had introduced the special USD-rupee concessional swap facility on June 8 to encourage fresh foreign currency inflows through FCNR(B) deposits as well as eligible OFCB and ECB inflows. The facility was aimed at strengthening domestic liquidity and providing support to the foreign exchange market at a time when the rupee and the country's forex reserves had come under pressure.

The latest inflow data shows that FCNR(B) deposits have emerged as the principal channel through which banks have raised foreign currency under the scheme.

The sharp increase in the reported mobilisation since then reflects continued interest in the concessional swap facility.

The RBI offers banks concessional swap arrangements against eligible foreign currency inflows, enabling them to access rupee liquidity while

MAJOR BANKS are offering FCNR rates of around 6%-6.5%, while some newer, smaller banks are offering about 7%-7.50%. These rates remain above the 5-year US Treasury yield of around 4.2%, providing sufficient incentive for deposit mobilisation.

bringing foreign currency into the domestic financial system.

Major banks are offering FCNR rates of around 6%-6.5%, while some newer, smaller banks are offering about 7%-7.50%. These rates remain above the 5-year US Treasury yield of around 4.2%, providing sufficient incentive for deposit mobilisation. FCNR(B) deposits are fixed-term deposits that can be maintained by non-resident Indians, Overseas Citizens of India and Persons of Indian Origin in designated foreign currencies. Unlike ordinary rupee deposits, these deposits allow overseas Indians to retain their savings in currencies such as the US dollar, pound sterling, euro, Japanese yen, Australian dollar and Canadian dollar.

Interest earned on FCNR(B) deposits is exempt from income tax in India as long as the depositor qualifies as a non-resident under Indian tax laws.

FULL REPORT ON [WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](https://www.indianexpress.com)

How India's Rs 62.5k cr scheme aims to scale mobile manufacturing, build domestic brands

Soumyarendra Barik
New Delhi, August 22

AFTER TURNING India into a major assembly hub for global smartphone makers, the Centre's new Rs 62,500 crore phone manufacturing scheme is attempting to tackle two unfinished parts of the country's electronics story: keeping large-scale production growing after the first smartphone production linked incentive (PLI) scheme has run its course, and creating Indian smartphone brands that can compete with the foreign companies dominating the domestic market.

The five-year scheme, which will run from FY 2026-27 to FY 2030-31, has consequently been split into two distinct tracks.

The first is designed as a successor to the earlier PLI programme, offering incentives to large manufacturers and electronics manufacturing services (EMS) companies for expanding production, while increasingly

linking benefits to the domestic sourcing of components. The second sets aside a separate incentive structure for Indian smartphone brands, offering higher support for companies that not only manufacture in the country but also keep their intellectual property, management control, design and research and development capabilities in India.

Keeping the PLI engine running

The first component is the direct successor to the smartphone PLI and is aimed at companies manufacturing at scale, including EMS companies.

To qualify, a manufacturer must have recorded at least Rs 10,000 crore in turnover in FY 2025-26. For existing brands, sales must increase by at least Rs 5,000 crore over FY26 levels in the first year, with the threshold rising cumulatively to Rs 10,000 crore in FY28, Rs 15,000 crore in FY29, Rs 20,000 crore in FY30

and Rs 25,000 crore in FY31. Unlike the original PLI, the baseline itself will also move every year: it will be calculated as the preceding financial year's sales plus 15%.

Incentives will then be paid on sales above this baseline, subject to the annual threshold being met. The thresholds are calculated on a brand-wise basis, and the sales counted towards them can include exports.

"The new mobile phone manufacturing scheme builds on the central premise of PLI for smartphone makers: India will support manufacturers that can demonstrate scale and meaningful incremental production. Incumbents that have already built manufacturing capacity in India are therefore naturally positioned to benefit," Dhruv Shekhar, lead of manufacturing and supply chains at the Delhi-based consultancy firm Koan Advisory Group, told *The Indian Express*.

The quest for India's own Apple & Samsung

One of the more consequential aims of the new scheme is to incentivise the creation of a homegrown smartphone brand, a clear signal that the government's ambition for the electronics sector is moving beyond simply attracting factories and boosting assembly.

To qualify as an Indian brand under the scheme, a company must be incorporated in India; its trademark and intellectual property must be held in India; Indian citizens must exercise management control and hold more than 51% of the entity; and it must have in-house design and R&D capabilities in the country. "The more interesting shift in the new scheme is that the government is no longer looking only at how many phones India can manufacture, but at who actually owns and develops the

product... The Indian-brand track is an attempt to address that gap and, in some ways, rebuild the kind of domestic product capability that India had before foreign brands came to dominate the market," Shekhar said. As per the scheme details, eligible Indian brands will receive a 5% incentive on incremental sales.

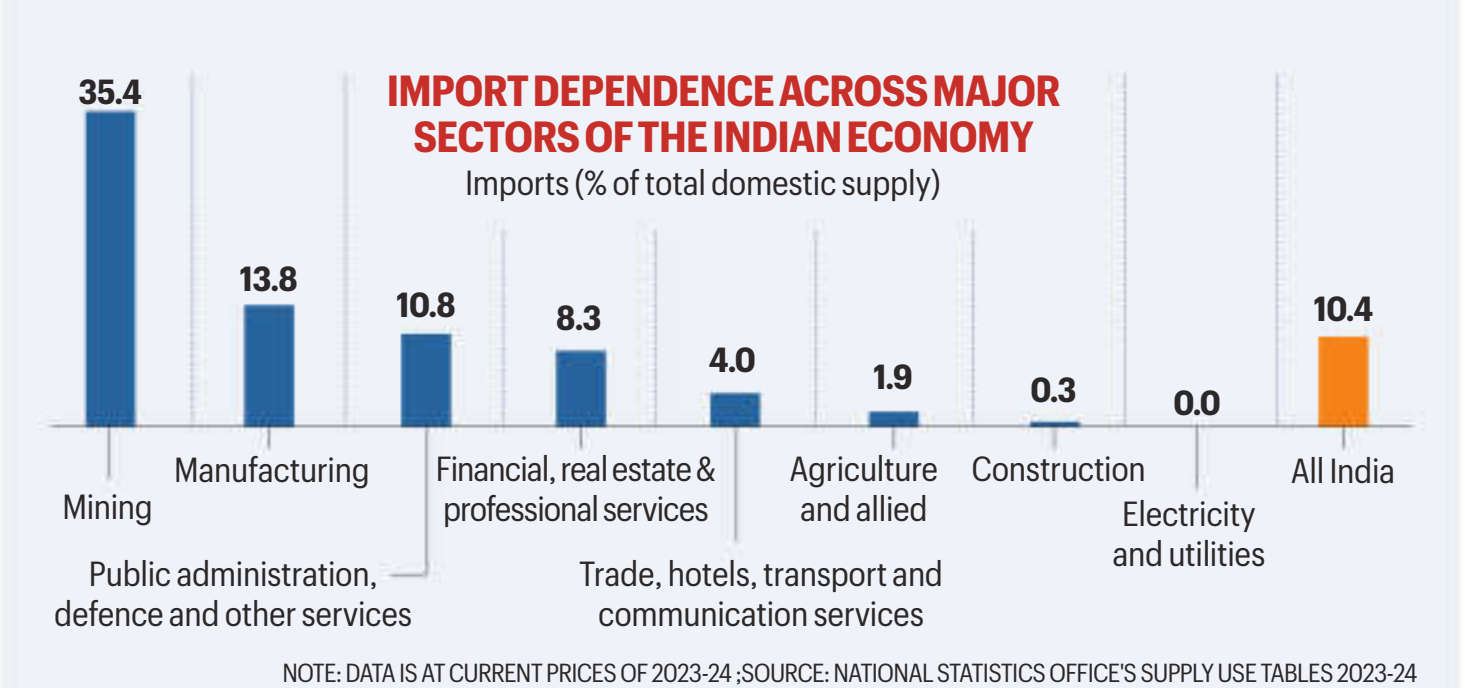
Products designed and developed in India can receive an additional 3% for design and R&D, apart from the domestic-sourcing incentive of up to 1.5%. Companies can also opt for a one-year gestation period, and the scheme leaves room for additional non-fiscal government support, which will be determined by a separate empowered committee.

The higher incentive structure is intended to offset some of the cost disadvantage a new Indian entrant would initially face against established global brands.

FULL REPORT ON [WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM](https://www.indianexpress.com)

• RANKING INDIA'S IMPORT VULNERABILITIES

The ongoing war in West Asia has disrupted critical trade routes, hitting the global supply chains for essential commodities and goods. It has shown that high import dependence can translate into economic vulnerability. According to a recent Crisil report, the conflict not only triggered a spike in commodity prices but also constrained the availability of products essential to major economic activities.



DISSECTING IMPORT DEPENDENCE ACROSS PRODUCTS

Imports (% of total supply)	
IMPORTS (% OF TOTAL SUPPLY)	KEY PRODUCTS
Above 80%	Crude oil
60-80%	Natural gas, copper, aircraft, ships
40-60%	Gems and jewellery, coal and lignite, Industrial machinery, medical instruments, TV/ radio broadcasting services
20-40%	Electrical inputs, chemical products, plastics Machine tools, R&D services, business services, air transport
Below 20%	Food products, clothing, footwear, automobiles, electricity, refined petroleum products, construction inputs, electrical machinery, tractors, trade, hotels, restaurants, IT, financial, education and health services

SOURCE: CRISIL

Tesla, other carmakers begin record vehicle recall in China

Beijing: Tesla and eight other automakers said on Friday they will recall a total of about 4.3 million vehicles in China over concerns that doors may be difficult to open in an emergency, marking the country's largest automotive recall.

The recall remedies range from software updates to warning labels and improved markings around door handles.

Beijing has this year increased oversight of the electric vehicle (EV) industry and introduced tougher safety requirements, as automakers, locked in a fierce price war, roll out technologies in the world's largest vehicle market.

China has also said it will ban concealed door handles

from 2027, making it the first country to phase out a design popularised by Tesla and widely adopted by domestic Chinese EV makers.

Tesla did not immediately reply to a request for comment, while Geely and Xpeng declined to comment. Xiaomi said it does not have additional information beyond the regulatory notice.

Leapmotor said it was committed to safety.

It said the upgrade involved only a warning label and upgrading the power-window control software, but that it was "managing and filing it in accordance with recall process out of a sense of responsibility to our users". REUTERS

Korea ship sets sail via Arctic to check viability

Seoul: A South Korean container ship sets sail on Saturday for Europe via the Arctic in the nation's first commercial voyage on the route to test its viability, with the hope of turning the southeastern port of Busan into a global maritime hub.

The PanStar Acro will sail north, hugging eastern Russia's Kamchatka peninsula, cross the Bering Sea, and take the Northern Sea Route, stopping in Felixstowe in Britain, Rotterdam in the Netherlands and Poland's Gdansk before returning on a journey expected to take 40 to 45 days. President Lee Jae Myung has made Arctic shipping a priority for South Korea. REUTERS

Around 8.7 crore youth not studying, working or undergoing training: NITI

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, August 22

AN ESTIMATED 8.7 crore Indian youth aged 15 to 29 are not studying, working, or receiving training, a recent NITI Aayog report said, highlighting the urgent need for subsidised training programmes to encourage self-employment and align with local demand and emerging sectors.

The Aayog, in the report titled 'Reimagining Skilling for Viksit Bharat@2047', said the estimate is based on data from the 78th round of the National Sample Survey conducted in 2021.

To ensure the highest impact, the Aayog organised India's workforce landscape and learners into five segments — schooling; tertiary education; formal and informal work; not in education, employment and training (NEET) youth; and women. "NEET" youth are constrained by the absence of income and the sunk cost of prior education. Students often cannot layer paid skilling onto existing financial commitments," it

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said. The Aayog has defined NEET youth as youth comprising individuals between the ages of 15 and 29 who are not engaged in education, employment, or training, as well as those who are unemployed.

"NEET youth and women require affordable or subsidised training options, alongside dedicated financial support where constraints are most binding. Across segments, the ability to combine learning with earning remains a central requirement. For the workforce and NEET youth, the need shifts towards mid-career reskilling, self-employment pathways, and learning options aligned with local demand and emerging sectors," the Aayog said in the report.

The report pointed out that students, especially those from low-income households, are already stretched by college expenses and, in many cases, private tuition.

As a result, it said making additional investment in paid skilling alongside a traditional degree is often financially unviable.

India and Mauritius sign five-year fuel supply pact

New Delhi: India and Mauritius have deepened their energy partnership with a five-year agreement under which Indian Oil Corporation (IOC) will supply the island nation's entire import requirement of petrol, diesel and aviation turbine fuel, strengthening New Delhi's role as a key energy-security partner in the Indian Ocean.

The agreement was exchanged during Petroleum Minister Hardeep Singh Puri's official visit to Mauritius on August 20-21, alongside a government-to-government memorandum of understanding (MoU) to expand cooperation in oil and gas, including petroleum product supplies, training and capacity building, and biofuels. The

long-term sales and purchase agreement between IOC and Mauritius' State Trading Corporation is designed to provide Mauritius with assured supplies and reduce its exposure to price volatility, an official statement said. This, it said, was the first long-term supply agreement by an Indian public-sector oil marketing company outside South Asia in recent years. Under the pact, "IOC will supply the entire import requirement of Mauritius of motor spirit (petrol), high speed diesel (diesel) and aviation turbine fuel (ATF)." Separately, IOC said the 27,500 tonne bunker fuel storage facility at MAP Land in Mer Rouge, Mauritius has been built at an investment of \$25 million. PTI

• FUND MANAGERS ARE INCREASINGLY DEMANDING HIGHER YIELDS TO ACCOMMODATE THE FLOOD OF ISSUANCE

US corporate AI debt surge tests investor limits as fatigue emerges

Reuters
New York, August 22

THE WAVE of debt issuance funding the artificial-intelligence buildup is testing the limits of investor demand, with some large bond buyers warning that the market is showing signs of indigestion.

While fund managers remain comfortable with the credit quality of companies such as Amazon and Alphabet, Google's parent company, they are increasingly demanding higher yields to accommodate the flood of issuance. This has raised concerns that a tipping point could emerge if AI spending continues to escalate.

"You've started to see the indigestion show up in tech spreads in particular," said Neil Sutherland, head of US fixed income at Schroders.

Tech corporate bond spreads are the extra yield investors demand to hold their debt over US Treasuries; wider spreads signal higher perceived risk, while tighter spreads reflect stronger investor confidence.

"It's not really a credit issue with higher-quality technology companies, such as Amazon and Google. But the more they have to issue bonds, the more investors are demanding a premium to absorb that debt."

Analysts cited Amazon's recent long-dated \$25 billion bond



The surge in AI-related bonds, alongside heavy government spending, has been a key factor pushing up Treasury yields. REUTERS

sale, which priced at roughly 120 basis points over Treasuries. Last year, the spread would have been roughly half of that, they said.

"Tech has gone from trad-

ing materially through the market to actually trading wider than the market," Sutherland said. "The higher spreads ... make other parts of the market

look more expensive on a relative value basis."

Alphabet declined to comment. Amazon did not respond to a request for comment.

Tech spreads are currently at 89 basis points, 9 basis points wider than the overall investment grade market, according to Karen Choi, portfolio manager at Capital Group.

The widening reflects a major change for a sector that historically enjoyed some of the tightest spreads in corporate credit due to strong balance sheets and relatively modest borrowing needs.

The surge in AI-related bonds, at a time when governments are still spending heavily,

has been a leading factor pushing up Treasury yields, as buyers demand higher returns to keep purchasing the flood of bonds hitting markets. Any pullback in tech issuance could support longer-dated Treasuries.

George Catrambone, head of fixed income, Americas, at DWS, said investors are beginning to demand larger concessions as issuance volumes reach record levels.

AI hyperscalers' debt issuance has reached \$220 billion in 2026, according to the latest BNP Paribas data as of August 10. That is roughly \$207 billion higher than in the comparable period last year, when it totalled \$12.5 billion.

• BRIEFLY

Regulator nod to 1,800-km LPG network

New Delhi: Oil sector regulator has authorised the development of nearly 1,800 km of new LPG pipelines at an estimated investment of Rs 7,000 crore, expanding the country's common-carrier LPG pipeline network by almost a quarter as it seeks to make fuel supplies more resilient and reduce dependence on road transport. The Petroleum and Natural Gas Regulatory Board has approved three strategically important LPG pipeline projects. PTI

Housing sales dip 6% in top 8 cities in Apr-Jun

New Delhi: Housing sales in eight major cities fell 6% to 91,729 units in the April-June quarter due to low demand, with buyers being cautious amid global uncertainties, according to PropTiger. Sales stood at 97,674 units in the same quarter last year. Listed realty firm Aarum PropTech Ltd's housing brokerage arm PropTiger said in its report that the sales declined in six cities — Mumbai Metropolitan Region (MMR), Delhi-NCR, Bengaluru, Pune, Kolkata and Ahmedabad. PTI

Happening today

● **INDIAN DOMESTIC** first-class cricket season gets underway with the Duleep Trophy in Bengaluru. The East Zone, which will take on North-East, will be led by Ishan Kishan and Vaibhav Sooryavanshi as his deputy.

● **MEMBERS OF A** high-level Japanese delegation, which is in Varanasi, will offer prayers at the Kashi Vishwanath Temple.

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Secretaries told to upskill in-house staff instead of hiring consultants

Harikishan Sharma
New Delhi, August 22

THE GOVERNMENT has asked Central Secretaries to train their officers in “specialised skills”, including “preparing, tendering documents, drafting of legislation and managing dispute mechanisms”, instead of hiring consultants from private firms, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

This is learnt to have been conveyed to Secretaries after their meeting with Prime Minister Narendra Modi on July 22. A week after the meeting, Cabinet Secretary T V Somanathan also sent out a missive to Secretaries, listing “action points” from their interaction with Modi. Among the points on which the Secretaries have been asked to initiate action, Somanathan has listed skilling of in-house officers instead of hiring consultants.

“Officers should be trained in preparing, tendering documents, drafting of legislation, managing dispute mechanisms and other specialised skills by ministries/ departments instead of hiring consultants from various consulting agencies in Central Government. Courses on IGOT (Integrated Government Online Training) platform also contain theoretical basic

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

NATION PAGE 5



RAHUL TARGETS PM IN PUNE: ‘BOYS CAN ABUSE, CULTURAL SHOCK IF GIRLS DO’

PANAMA-FLAGGED SHIP WITH 24 CREW MEMBERS SINKS OFF ODISHA COAST

● 48 FROM ACROSS STATES TO BE CONFERRED THE NATIONAL TEACHERS’ AWARD ON SEPTEMBER 5

Asteroid hunts to school breakfasts: The teachers changing how India learns

Express News Service
Jaipur, Kolkata, Ranchi, Thiruvananthapuram, August 22

FROM A Rajasthan government teacher who helped students hunt asteroids and a Chhattisgarh educator who introduced nutritional intervention to prevent school absences to a Jharkhand educator who pushed for an image makeover for government schools, this year’s National Teachers’ Award list is replete with unsung heroes who have striven to change the face of education in India. Instituted in 1958, the National Teachers’ Award is India’s

highest national award for school educators. This year’s list has 48 names — 3 from Uttar Pradesh; 2 each from Bihar, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Rajasthan and West Bengal; and 1 each from Andhra Pradesh, Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Chandigarh, Chhattisgarh, Dadra & Nagar Haveli and Daman & Diu, Delhi, Goa, Gujarat, Haryana, Himachal Pradesh, Jammu & Kashmir, Jharkhand, Karnataka, Kerala, Ladakh, Manipur, Mizoram, Nagaland, Odisha, Puducherry, Punjab, Sikkim, Tamil Nadu, Telangana, Tripura, Uttarakhand and Andaman & Nicobar Islands. These educators will receive

their awards from President Droupadi Murmu on September 5.

Divyendu Sen, Rajasthan
If there’s one thing Divyendu Sen lived by in his long teaching career, it is that curiosity mattered more than school scores. This belief helped him drill his passion for learning into students for 14 years, ultimately helping students of rural Rajasthan identify asteroids through a NASA-supported citizen space campaign. “People often think advanced science can only happen in big cities or elite schools,” the 40-year-old Divyendu Sen, who teaches biology

at the Mahatma Gandhi Government School in Jhalawar district’s Pachpahar, tells *The*

Indian Express. “Our experience has shown that children in villages are equally curious and

capable if given an opportunity. All they needed was some guidance and I pushed them.” Since COVID-19, students from his school have identified 12 asteroid candidates, four of which have been recognised as provisional discoveries. Beyond astronomy, Sen has introduced several technology-driven initiatives in his schools. Over the past three years, he has converted educational content into audio format using student voices. He also serves as a district coordinator for the National Children’s Science Congress and has encouraged students to participate in science competitions and talent-search programmes.

But it wasn’t without challenges — the biggest being making people understand the importance of these initiatives. “People used to ask me what was the point of it and whether it makes students employable. I have to make them understand that children will be able to learn computer skills. These programmes develop a scientific temperament in children, which might not have an immediate impact but can help in the long run,” he tells *The Indian Express*.

KP Sunil Kumar, Kerala
For three decades, KP Sunil Kumar has been more than a teacher. He has developed a

range of student programmes to address learning gaps while making education engaging. The 51-year-old, currently headmaster of a government upper primary school at Puzhathi in Kannur, has developed innovative initiatives that made classrooms more engaging and improved students’ language, literary, communication and creative skills. “After the COVID pandemic, a learning gap has been visible among students. Hence, I have conceived these schemes to improve their language efficiency and communication skills,” he said. Among his most notable

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Keep calm, your angry face is their ‘content’: Delhi Police dos and don’ts post-Jantar Mantar

Advisory framed by Central agencies shared with all 15 districts as well as the Railway and Metro units of Delhi Police

Mahender Singh Manral
New Delhi, August 22

“YOUR ANGRY face is their content... They are not fighting you. They are making a film in which they want you to play the villain. Refuse that role.” “Protesters may cry loudly, fall at the feet of personnel, or ask questions intended to create sympathy or anger, such as references to family background or salary issues. In such situations, personnel have been advised not to engage in debate or show agreement, and to use only a brief line if necessary: ‘Please co-

operate, we are doing our duty’. Then, maintain silence.” In the wake of the Jantar Mantar agitation where their role came in for backlash, Delhi Police personnel have received guidelines not just on how to tackle the new-generation protester, but also how not to. And to remember, always, that they are on camera. Earlier this month, an advisory framed by Central agencies was shared with all 15 districts as well as the Railway and Metro units of Delhi Police. The underlying message, like the

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

● New manual for the new protester



- Do not engage in debate or show agreement, and use only a brief line if necessary: ‘Please cooperate, we are doing our duty’
- Do not push away phones, snatch items, throw objects or shout in anger
- ‘If a protester faints, falls or is injured, they should be the first to step forward, lift the person carefully, call an ambulance and clear the path’
- Language and body language should be ‘respectful’
- ‘Let them (their cameras) see only two things — your calm face and a helping hand’



Proud parents

Ramesh Prasad Baranwal and Babita, the parents of Shrutika, 25, who was among those killed in a fire at a bed-and-breakfast facility in New Delhi in June, receive her master’s degree from TISS Vice Chancellor Prof Badri Narayan Tiwari at the institute’s annual convocation in Mumbai, Saturday. TISS

SHRUTIKA SECURED A first-class result in Water Policy and Governance

SHE HAD GONE TO DELHI on June 3 to complete the joining formalities for a job she had

secured via campus placement when a fire engulfed the facility where she was staying, killing 21

‘No compromise’: BJP slams Cong’s 2-stanza Vande Mataram stand

Passes resolution condemning CWC decision

Jatin Anand & Asad Rehman
New Delhi, August 22

THE BJP on Saturday passed a resolution to uphold the “honour, dignity, legacy and national status of the complete Vande Mataram”, condemning the Congress’s decision to sing only the first two stanzas of the national song.

In the resolution passed at the first meeting of its new national office-bearers appointed recently by BJP president Nitin Nabin, the ruling party said the Congress Working Committee (CWC) could not override constitutional institutions or laws of the country.

The BJP announced that it



Prime Minister Narendra Modi at the BJP headquarters in New Delhi, Saturday. ANI

will launch a campaign to take the historic legacy and significance of Vande Mataram across the country. At the start of the meeting, the party office-bearers recited all six stanzas of the national song.

“The BJP regards Vande Mataram as the national song of Bharat, an expression of reverence for Bharat Mata, a mantra

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

ONE NATION ONE ELECTION

On NDA table: Joint polls for 22 states/UTs with LS 2029

Current Bills’ timeline 2034; House panel chief says: It is for NDA CMs to decide

Damini Nath
New Delhi, August 22

EVEN AS the Joint Committee of Parliament on the One Nation One Election Bills is engaged in consultations, including interacting with Chief Ministers across states, the NDA is learnt to be exploring advancing the first simultaneous elections from the present timeline of 2034 to 2029 in the 22 states/UTs where it has a majority. To that effect, it is considering the dissolution of Assemblies before their terms end, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

A source familiar with the discussions said that of the 22 NDA-ruled states/UTs, 11 are due for elections over the coming two years, before the 2029 Lok Sabha elections. Four states have simultaneous elections with that of the Lok Sabha. These are Andhra Pradesh, Arunachal Pradesh, Sikkim and Odisha, which are today all ruled by the NDA.

The committee, formed in December 2024 to consider the Bills that would pave the way for simultaneous elections to the Lok Sabha and all Assemblies in 2034, has been visiting states to interact with stakeholders, including the

● Polls in 2028, 2029

NDA-RULED states with polls due in 2028: Chhattisgarh, Madhya Pradesh, Meghalaya, Nagaland, Rajasthan and Tripura

STATES WITH elections along with Lok Sabha in 2029: Odisha, Andhra Pradesh, Sikkim and Arunachal Pradesh

NDA-RULED states with polls due in second half of 2029: Haryana, Jharkhand, Maharashtra

OPP-RULED states where elections due in 2028: Himachal Pradesh, Karnataka, Mizoram and Telangana

OPP-RULED states/UTs where elections due in 2029: Jharkhand, J&K

state government, legislature, academia, legal fraternity and industry. It is expected to submit its report in the winter session this year.

Assuming the NDA retains its state governments over the next two years, the source said, the Assemblies of the 22 states/UTs could be dissolved by January 2029 by their respective

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Behind denial of nod for Revanth’s US trip, his tentative meetings with Vance, Mamdani

Nikhila Henry & Shubhajit Roy
Hyderabad, New Delhi, August 22

TELANGANA CHIEF Minister Revanth Reddy’s visit to the United States included possible meetings with Vice President J D Vance and New York City Mayor Zohran Mamdani on August 26, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

The Chief Minister’s Office, when contacted, said the meeting with the NYC Mayor was “tentative”. “There are a lot of events which are added to the schedule. No official communication was exchanged between the Mayor of New York and the CM’s office,” the CMO said.

Government sources in New Delhi confirmed to *The Indian Express* that the Chief Minister was planning to meet Vance



Telangana CM Revanth Reddy at a meeting with a Cambridge University team in UK, Saturday. X/@REVANTH_ANUMULA

and Mamdani during his visit. Explaining the reasons for the Indian government denying clearance to Reddy’s US visit, sources said that the Ministry of External Affairs — while issuing political clearance — looked at two basic aspects: the “level” of meetings and the “purpose”. »CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Joint polls for 22 states/UTs

Governors on the advice of their Council of Ministers. Article 174 (2)(b) of the Constitution gives the Governor the power to dissolve the Assembly. The Governor generally does so on the advice of the Council of Ministers or if the government loses majority.

Once the Assembly is dissolved, the Representation of the People Act, 1950 mandates that the Election Commission conduct elections within six months.

The Bills under consideration of the committee, the Constitution (One Hundred and Twenty-Ninth Amendment) Bill, 2024 and the Union Territories Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2024, would provide for all Assemblies elected after the first sitting of the Lok Sabha post general elections to have

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curtailed terms in order to have simultaneous elections in the next cycle. This would mean that the earliest the first simultaneous elections can be held, if the Bills are passed, would be 2034.

When asked if simultaneous elections could be held earlier than the Bills currently provide for, committee chairman PP Chaudhary told *The Indian Express*: "It is for the NDA Chief Ministers to decide. This issue is outside the mandate of the committee."

Significantly, some BJP Chief Ministers have already expressed their agreement for such a plan. After meeting the Joint Committee of Parliament, at least four Chief Ministers (Goa, Uttarakhand, Haryana and Delhi) came out in full support of simultaneous elections. The three civilians were picked up for questioning by the troops of the 48 Rashtriya Rifles (RR) in the wake of an ambush by terrorists on the Dehra Ki Gali-Buzflazi road on December 21, 2023, which left four soldiers dead and three injured. Several men from Topa Pir were picked up a day later, and three of them were eventually found dead with injuries indicating torture.

Refusing to interfere with Army's decision in the absence of any illegality or procedural violation in action taken against Brigadier Acharya, who was the commanding officer of Sector 13 RR under which the 48 RR operated, the AFT Bench comprising Justice Sudhir Mittal and Lt Gen Rambir Singh, in its order dated August 20, observed that the circumstances following the ambush, including the deaths and

elections.

Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, who met the committee on July 1 as a part of the consultation, said: "If aligning election schedules at the national level requires a suitable adjustment in Delhi's tenure, the Delhi Government is willing to consider it with a positive approach. If required in the national interest, Delhi could be among the leading states to extend such cooperation." In the case of Delhi, that would mean cutting the term of the existing Assembly by one year.

If the NDA decides to dissolve the Assemblies in time for elections with the Lok Sabha in 2029, it would mean cutting short the terms of the Assemblies of Goa, Gujarat, Manipur, Uttar Pradesh and Uttarakhand by three years; and

for accountability.

The same month, Defence Minister Rajnath Singh had visited Rajouri and met the family members of the deceased civilians and assured them of justice.

Addressing the troops at Rajouri Div, he had said, "The Indian Army is not an ordinary army. The soldiers are our protectors. It is their duty to not only safeguard national interests, but also to win hearts of the people."

To look into circumstances surrounding the death of civilians, the Nagrota-based 16 Corps Headquarters had initiated a Court of Inquiry and issued the Brigadier a notice asking to explain his position into the charges of failing to exercise proper command and control during the interrogation of civilians, using physical force against them, failing to prevent excessive and unlawful force, and failing to issue clear instructions to officers under his command in respect to the handling of civilians.

The GOC of Nagrota-based 16 Corps, after considering his response, awarded Acharya "severe displeasure" for two years in July 2024. The latter, however, challenged the award in the Armed Forces Tribunal.

— with input from AMRITA NAYAK DUTTA, NEW DELHI

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Chhattisgarh, Madhya Pradesh, Meghalaya, Nagaland, Rajasthan and Tripura by four years, as these states have elections due in 2027 and 2028 respectively.

Opposition-ruled states where elections are due before the Lok Sabha polls include Punjab in 2027 and Himachal Pradesh, Karnataka, Mizoram and Telangana in 2028. This would mean that after their next elections, these state assemblies would have over three to four years left when the Lok Sabha elections are scheduled to be held.

This is expected to sharpen faultlines between the NDA and the Opposition, already strained in the delimitation debate. When asked about the possibility of 22 NDA states/UTs syncing their elections with Lok Sabha 2029, Congress general-secretary in-charge of communications Jairam Ramesh declined to

comment, saying it was hypothetical. He reiterated the party's stand: "The Congress is opposed to One Nation One Election. It is unconstitutional, anti-democratic and against accountability. The JPC is examining the matter and has till the Winter Session to submit its report. Nothing has happened to change our position."

In 2024, Congress and DMK MPs, among others, opposed the introduction of the One Nation One Election Bills in Parliament, calling them unconstitutional. In May, when the committee met then-Karnataka Deputy Chief Minister D K Shivakumar, who is now Chief Minister, he had opposed the Bills.

So far, the committee has visited and interacted with elected leaders of Maharashtra, Uttarakhand, Haryana, Punjab, Himachal Pradesh, Karnataka, Gujarat, Delhi, Goa and Uttar Pradesh.

block believes this is more than just an award. At the same time, he hopes it will help get more support for the school.

"This is not an individual award but the collective effort of the whole school. We have limited resources. Think of what we can do when we get more."

Mummun Bhattacharjee, Jharkhand

When Mummun Bhattacharjee joined Madhya Vidyalaya Barmasia in Dhanbad as a teacher in 2019, one of her biggest challenges was turning around the perception that government schools cannot provide quality education.

For 43-year-old Bhattacharjee, now the school's headmistress-in-charge and Jharkhand's first awardee in 27 years, this year's National Teachers' Award is an endorsement that she has somewhat succeeded.

"Once I got the administrative responsibility, I felt I had more freedom to work and make the school better," Bhattacharjee tells *The Indian Express*. "I wanted to break the perception associated with government schools."

A major part of this has been creating teaching-learning material using whatever resources are available. "We don't have a lot of resources to provide drawing books and other materials to every child," she says. "So, we use whatever comes into our homes. Even Blinkit packets and bags are used for drawing, reading sheets and story sheets."

Inputs from PARUL KULSHRESTHA, SHAJU PHILIP, TANUSREE BOSE, SHUBHAM TIGGA

Draft Bill

has found. On the size of centres covered, who can teach, penalties and enforcement powers, its provisions go further than those in Rajasthan, Jharkhand, Assam and Haryana, the only four states to have enacted dedicated legislation linked to the coaching industry after the Union Education Ministry's January 2024 guidelines. Other states have brought in rules and guidelines.

The draft Maharashtra Private Coaching Centers (Registration and Regulation) Bill, 2026, comes three months after the NEET-UG paper leak in which nine of the 13 people arrested were from Maharashtra, with Latur and Pune, two of the state's biggest coaching hubs, at the centre of the investigation.

The School Education and Sports Department has released the draft Bill and invited suggestions and objections from the public until 6 pm on September 4.

Once finalised, the law would require every private coaching centre in the state to register, regulate its fees and comply with requirements on safety, staffing and student welfare. Existing centres would get six months to register through a state online portal, with registration valid for three years. Centres would also have to retain at least a month's CCTV footage and hold fire and building safety certificates.

The draft Bill casts a wide net as it would apply to any tuition or coaching centre teaching more than 25 students, the lowest threshold among the five laws. Rajasthan's law applies to centres with more than 100 students, while Assam's to above 50. A neighbourhood coaching centre with 30 students, therefore, would fall outside the law in Rajasthan and Assam but would have to register in Maharashtra.

Delhi Police

ones shared above, was that today's protesters, particularly those in the 18-28 age group, may not provoke them in the traditional sense. Instead, they would try to trigger an angry response, and turn the brief clip into online "content" as viral reels or memes, sources said.

A specific directive is to try not to touch women protesters, have women police personnel handle them and be ready to offer help.

The advice is to respond instead with calm, restraint and positive actions, and "look straight ahead" if protesters hold mobile phones close to their faces and ask personal or emotional questions such as whether they feel proud, how they sleep at night, or what they would tell their children, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

The Jantar Mantar protest saw several people confront police personnel with these questions, particularly after the July 20 attempt to march to Parliament that saw clashes. Security forces used lathis, teargas and, in at least one case, a pellet gun to disperse the crowds. Authorities have denied the use of excessive force.

"A calm face gives them nothing and police personnel are learnt to have been asked to not say anything in such situations. They have been clearly told that no controversial clip means no viral video," a source said.

Some of the actions personnel have been warned against

are pushing away a phone, snatching items, throwing objects or shouting in anger, or reacting to humour, mockery, songs, dances, mock salutes or placards aimed at them.

Sources said they have also been told that protesters may offer them flowers, sweets, water bottles or tea, knowing that either an angry rejection or an overreaction caught on camera could generate online traction. Police personnel are learnt to have been told to either politely accept such offers or politely refuse.

Other "meme traps" and "social media nets" the personnel have been warned against include protesters playing trending songs or audio clips, using police personnel's names in slogans, or creating point-of-view videos near the police line, with captions added later. Personnel have been told that while they cannot control captions or edits, they can control their own facial expressions and body language. "Treat this as background noise," the SOP says, adding that if personnel are briefed in advance, they are less likely to be confused or provoked.

Apart from advising restraint, the SOP also emphasises what it calls positive actions, such as, "if a protester faints, falls or is injured, they should be the first to step forward, lift the person carefully, call an ambulance and clear the path". Adds the advisory: "Such actions should be done naturally, not for

the camera, while noting that cameras are likely to record them."

Other such positive actions include removing barricades to allow ambulances, school-children or patients to pass, and to help elderly and disabled persons cross police lines or reach vehicles. "If a child is separated from parents in a crowd, they have been asked that they should stay with the child until the parents are found," a source said.

The language and body language should be "respectful", says the SOP. Such as "Uncle, come this way", "Aunty, please go to this side", "Sir, please cooperate", and when urging a crowd to move, using hands joined in appeal. This is more effective than a raised lathi and appears positive on camera, says the SOP.

"Respectful language from uniformed personnel can help calm a crowd," the source said.

In a statement issued after the July 20 clashes, a Delhi Police spokesperson said the protesters had displayed unruly, aggressive and violent behaviour in the New Delhi area. "More than 118 police personnel sustained injuries, including senior officers and women police personnel. During the scuffle, around 60 protesters were also reported to have got injured."

The Indian Express reported that a CRPF inquiry found that one Rapid Action Force personnel had fired seven shots from a pellet gun, and five had hit protesters.

"Let them (the protesters' cameras) see only two things," says the recent advisory. "Your calm face and a helping hand."

Upskill in-house staff

knowledge which can be utilised for capacity enhancement," Somanathan wrote.

Underlining continuous capacity building and upskilling of human resources in government, he said this is "necessary to meet the future demand and objectives of Viksit Bharat".

Somanathan also noted that initial discussions among stakeholder ministries' departments before a Cabinet proposal is finalised should be encouraged to avoid delays at later stages and for seamless implementation.

The emphasis on training of officers instead of roping in private consulting firms is significant as several government departments hire consultants or outsource work to various companies including McKinsey, Ernst & Young, PwC and Deloitte.

Last July, Union Minister of State for Rural Development Dr Chandra Sekhar Pemmasani informed the Lok Sabha that his

ministry alone had hired 362 consultants so far.

"The consultants also provide support for facilitating smooth day-to-day coordination of the ministry with the States/UTs, enabling the officers to focus on core policy issues and ensure the meeting of milestones within the set deadline," he said in a written reply.

"As on 25.07.2025, a total of 325 consultants were hired with different divisions of the DoRD (Department of Rural Development) and 37 consultants were hired by the DoLR (Department of Land Resources). These consultants are hired through institutions, autonomous bodies, public sector enterprises, etc.," he said.

Earlier, Minister of State of Planning Rao Indirjit Singh informed the Lok Sabha in July 2017 that the NITI Aayog had engaged Ernst & Young to promote public private partnerships in infrastructure in the States.

Detailing such engagement, he said in a written reply on July 26, 2017: "In order to transform health and education in three States each under Development Support Services for States (DSSS), consortium of McKinsey & Company and IPE Global; and Boston Consultant Group & Piramal Foundation Education Limited have been engaged respectively. M/s IPE Global in consortium with Horwath HTL France and Crowe Horwath HTL Consultants Pvt. Ltd has been engaged as consultant for preparation of Concept Development Plans and Detailed Master Plans for Holistic Development of Package-I Islands (Ross, Smith, Avis & Long islands in A&N) and Package-III Islands (Minicoy, Bangaram, Thinnakara, Cheriyam & Suheli islands in Lakshadweep)."

Similarly, in April 2018, then Minister of State for Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution, C R Chaudhary, informed the Lok Sabha that his ministry had engaged PwC for the buffer stock management of pulses.

BJP

of the freedom struggle and an immortal symbol of India's national consciousness," Nabin said in a post after the meeting.

He said the BJP condemns and "unequivocally opposes the decision taken by the Congress Working Committee on 19th August 2026 to reaffirm its 1937 resolution and restrict the singing of Vande Mataram to its first two stanzas at Congress programmes".

Later, PM Narendra Modi arrived at the BJP headquarters to interact with the new office-bearers, following which he said in an X post: "Organisational meetings are all about new ideas and perspectives aimed at strengthening the Party and deepening connect with the people. Great interaction with fellow Party colleagues and the new organisational team!"

Attacking the Congress, the BJP resolved to "reject every attempt to subordinate the national song to communal pressure, political appeasement or narrow vote-bank considerations", adding that "no compromise can be accepted with the honour and legacy of Vande Mataram".

The BJP also formed a Nabin-headed committee for reaching out to the youth and Gen Z, which includes new general secretaries Vinod Tawde and Smriti Irani besides Gujarat Deputy CM Harsh Sanghavi and Chhattisgarh finance minister O P Choudhary as members, party sources said.

Castigating the BJP's resolution, Congress national spokesperson Alok Sharma said: "Does the BJP or Mr Amit Shah consider themselves bigger than the Constituent Assembly... Our country's biggest leaders, including Mahatma Gandhi and Rabindranath Tagore, had backed limiting the public rendition of Vande Mataram to its first two stanzas."

Revanth's US trip

The application for political clearance cited "Rising Telangana", an investment promotion programme by the Telangana government led by Reddy, according to sources. This was the ostensible reason for his visit to the US.

The level of meetings means that the Chief Minister is expected to meet his counterparts in the US. So, a New York Governor would be appropriate, but a New York City Mayor is seen as some levels below the Telangana Chief Minister's position. Also, a meeting with the Vice President does not fit with the purpose of the delegation, sources reasoned.

Since the purpose was to attract investments into Telangana and put it on the global investment map, the two meetings were seen to be "political meetings" and not for the purpose of investment promotion, sources said. These are the reasons why the Indian government denied permission, sources said.

For the record, on why permission was denied for Reddy's US visit, the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) official spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal told reporters on Friday, "The visit of Chief Ministers, as indeed other dignitaries, is assessed by the Ministry in order to accord political clearance. The programme proposed in such cases should be appropriate to the office held and the purpose of the visit. In this particular case, that was not so in respect of the US. Therefore, clearance has not been given. Incidentally, his visit to the UK has been cleared."

On Saturday, the possible meeting with the NYC Mayor snowballed into a row in Telangana. Bharat Rashtira Samiti (BRS), the primary opposition, asked whether the Centre de-

nied permission to Reddy because he may have met Mamdani. "What does 'inappropriate' mean? The Centre and state government must explain the cancellation of the CM's US visit," BRS MLC Dr Dasoju Sraavan said.

Arvind Dharmapuri, the BJP MP from Nizamabad, said, "Telangana deserves to know: what business did Revanth Reddy have with Mamdani? Just days ago, Mamdani skipped NYC's main India Day Parade but attended a Pakistan Day event and publicly praised the Pakistani community and its roots."

"Mamdani previously also wrote a personal letter, expressing solidarity, to Umar Khalid, an accused booked under the UAPA in the 2020 Delhi riots conspiracy case," he said.

According to an itinerary accessed by *The Indian Express*, Reddy was also supposed to meet and greet the Indian community at a programme organised by the Indian Overseas Congress.

Reddy was supposed to visit Harvard University on August 25, where an MoU was to be signed, as well as the Massachusetts Institute of Technology campus, Northeastern University, and Virginia Tech.

The CM had earlier instructed the delegation to proceed with the US tour and to sign MoUs with top educational institutions in his absence. About his visit to the US, he had said, "The only purpose of the visit was to, as part of the Centre's new education policy, bring the world's best institutions to India, to Telangana, to Hyderabad. They would have been an answer to our youth's aspirations to get education, skills, and training from the best Ivy Leagues and top global institutions."

— With inputs from SREENIVAS JANYALA

IIT Delhi student dies by suicide on campus, no note recovered

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 22

A 31-YEAR-OLD MSc Physics student at Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Delhi allegedly jumped to death from the sixth floor of a building on the campus on Saturday morning, police said.

According to a preliminary inquiry, the deceased had entered IIT Delhi campus through the main gate around 8 am. He subsequently went to the Lecture Hall Complex and took a lift to the sixth floor. He then allegedly jumped from the front side of the building, a senior police officer said.

DCP (Southwest) Amit Goel said a PCR call was received at Kishangarh police station at 8.33 am regarding the incident. "A police team immediately reached the spot and found the injured student. He was rushed to the IIT Delhi campus hospital, where doctors declared him brought dead," he added.

Investigators are examining his mobile phone and obtaining records from the institute to establish the circumstances preceding his death, police said.

A crime team and a forensic science laboratory unit were called to collect evidence.

During investigation, police allegedly found no apparent injury marks on the deceased other than those attributable to the fall.

No suicide note has also been recovered so far, said police.

Officers said that a mobile phone was found in the pocket of the deceased.

The device would be examined, the officer said.

Police said they are obtaining the student's counselling records and other relevant information from the institute.

"The team is verifying available facts and examining the circumstances surrounding the student's movements before the incident," the officer said. IIT Delhi condoled the death in a statement: "The Institute deeply mourns the tragic and untimely demise of an M.Sc. student on August 22, 2026. The Delhi Police are investigating the sad incident. Our deepest thoughts and prayers are with the bereaved family. The Institute is providing all support to them."

This was the second alleged suicide at the institute this year.

Earlier, a 19-year-old BTech student was found dead inside his apartment on the campus in March.

JANGPURA

'Experienced burglar, stays in fancy hotels': Cops identify man who killed senior citizen

Pragynesh

New Delhi, August 22

A DAY after a 69-year-old retired school teacher was murdered inside her Jangpura home in Southeast Delhi, police said they have identified the accused, even as they picked up three suspects for questioning on Saturday.

According to the police, the nature of the robbery suggested that the accused might have been involved in other crimes as well. "The accused, who was wearing a mask, has been identified... he is an experienced burglar... stays in fancy hotels," said an officer.

Preeti Kumari was found dead on her bed by her daughter on Friday morning, with her hands tied and a severely injured face. She used to live alone in her ground floor Pant Nagar home, located around 100 m from a police booth.

Police suspect the attack took place between 3 am and 4 am. A phone and "significant" amount of gold jewellery was stolen from her home, they added.

According to the police, the attacker knew Preeti's daily routine. Every morning, she made tea and stepped out to distribute it among the homeless and vagabonds in her neighbourhood before heading to a community dispensary where she volunteered.

Police have said the accused -- who wore a face mask, a T-shirt and capri -- allegedly

waited patiently for Preeti to open the door in the early hours. There were no signs of forced entry and all other houses located on the ground floor had been found locked from outside, they added.

"Prima facie it appears that the accused entered from the side of the park located on the opposite side of the house. We have questioned over 10 people who visited the area around her house in the last 10 days," the officer said.

"Though the CCTV camera installed on the side of Preeti's house caught a glimpse of the accused, his full face could not be seen... money plants were dangling in front of the cameras. However, he was seen going towards a drain located on the rear side of the colony," the officer said.

The officer added that a carpenter, who came to Preeti's house for repairs a few days ago and a man who washed a car near her house, were among the three detained for questioning.

Pushpa Sharma (75), who had known Preeti for three decades and stayed on the ground floor of the building, said she found her house locked from outside when she woke up in the morning. "I didn't hear any voice. When I woke up, I found the main door locked from outside. I called someone to open the door... By the time I managed to come out, the police had already arrived," she added.

TRIPPING AT BASAI WATER TREATMENT PLANT, LEAKAGE IN MASTER SUPPLY PIPELINE

Water crisis in Gurgaon: DLF Phases 1 & 2 face low pressure supply, tankers called in

Abhimanyu Hazarika

Gurgaon, August 22

FOR FOUR days, the washing machine at retired ITC executive housekeeper Sarita Handa's home in Gurgaon's DLF Phase 1 has remained unused. There simply isn't enough water to run it.

What started on Wednesday with irregular and low pressure supply has now become a weak trickle, leaving families across parts of Gurgaon rationing every bucket, waiting for tankers and, in some homes, buying packaged drinking water to meet everyday needs.

The reason: According to Gurugram Metropolitan Development Authority (GMDA) officials, its Basai Water Treatment Plant witnessed tripping, followed by a major leakage detected on Wednesday in a 1,300-mm master supply pipeline.

Tripping is an automatic safety mechanism that instantly shuts off electrical power to a



(From left) Tankers supply water to houses in DLF Phases 1 and 2. ABHIMANYU HAZARIKA

machine or circuit, designed to prevent equipment destruction.

"The first two days, there was little to no supply. Since the last two days, we have been receiving low pressure supply. We have stopped washing clothes," said Handa, also the vice-president of the A Block RWA.

For larger families, she said, even the tankers being supplied by DLF aren't enough. Private tanker operators, meanwhile,

have more than doubled their rates — from around Rs 1,200 to over Rs 3,000, she added.

The situation is similar in DLF Phase 2. K Block resident Ajay Kumar said there was no water supply throughout Thursday. Another resident of the same block, Kunal Sharma, added, "It's been three days. People are suffering."

In neighbouring high-rises such as Silver Oaks in DLF Phase



1, home to around 700 families, residents reported near-empty underground reservoirs. They said they had been forced to buy packaged drinking water while relying on costly private tankers for basic sanitation.

In response, DLF City's Head of Facilities, Nitya Mohan, said the company has instructed security personnel to take appropriate measures, including recommending civic body action

against water wastage.

In an advisory issued to residents on Saturday, DLF said supply normalisation and "re-pressurisation" of the distribution network was under way.

It said restoration could take additional time in downstream and tail-end areas and urged residents to avoid wastage.

"...we request everyone to exercise utmost care in the use of water and avoid any wastage.

Our Security and Estate teams have been instructed to remain vigilant and take appropriate action wherever water wastage is observed, including car washing, overflowing tanks, excessive use of booster pumps, or other avoidable use of potable water," it added.

Construction sites found using potable water would also be identified for punitive action, the advisory further said.

While GMDA teams repaired the master supply pipeline on Thursday night to stabilise the network, fresh damage to another critical pipeline compounded the city's water woes on Saturday.

GMDA spokesperson Neha Sharma said a 1,000-mm/700-mm pipeline near Baani Square in Sector 50's South City II was damaged by an unidentified party during excavation work.

"Water supply to sectors 46, 48, 49, 50, 52, 56, 57, and 58 to 76 will be affected until repair work is completed," Sharma added.

EXPRESS special

From lottery draw to court: A child's fight for school seat

Abhimanyu Hazarika

Gurgaon, August 22

FOR RAJPAL Chauhan, the promise of a better life for his four-year-old son seemed to be just a lottery draw away.

On April 29, Reyansh was allotted a seat at The Shri Ram School Aravali under the Economically Weaker Section (EWS) quota, following a computerised lottery conducted by the Haryana Department of School Education.

For Rajpal, a resident of Begumpur Khatola in Gurgaon — he worked private odd-jobs in Delhi after his small business shut down during the Covid-19 pandemic — it was a chance to put his son in a school he had once thought might be beyond their reach.

But the school refused to admit Reyansh.

The reason: Reyansh's home was more than 3 km from the school, and therefore did not meet the neighbourhood criteria under Haryana's Right to Education rules.

The family decided to move court. What followed was Rajpal's two-month-long legal battle, until a district court in Gurgaon, earlier this week, ordered the school to admit the boy within 15 days.

The *Indian Express* has reached out to the school for a comment.

In an order on August 18, Additional District Judge Dr Gagan Geet Kaur questioned the manner in which EWS children were being denied seats even after being allotted the same through the state's own system. The court described such rejections as "tactics to deprive the children of weaker sections of society from education so that they could not get education along with



The Shri Ram School Aravali.

children of elite society in private schools..."

The order was the result of Rajpal's fight that began at the lower court.

He had initially approached the Civil Judge (Junior Division), seeking an interim mandatory injunction directing the school to admit his son immediately. On July 13, the plea was dismissed on the grounds that it would amount to granting the primary relief claimed in the suit before the trial concluded.

The family then moved the district court.

Advocate Jaljeet Thurana, who represented the family, told *The Indian Express*, "The boy belongs to a poor family. The father is the only breadwinner and does odd jobs. We had to appeal after the lower court ruled in the school's favour."

The district court overturned the lower court's decision citing a recent Supreme Court judgment that held that a private school cannot sit in appeal over the decision of the competent state authority or withhold admissions on its own assessment of eligibility once the government has scrutinised and allotted seats.

Before the district court, the school had argued that during scrutiny, the boy's residential address was found to not satisfy the

neighbourhood distance criteria outlined under the Haryana Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education Rules. It argued that the provisional computerised draw did not confer any "absolute, vested or indefeasible right" on the child.

Dismissing this, the court noted a "procedural lapse" — the state's admission application portal did not automatically restrict or filter school choices based on residential addresses. "It cannot be expected from the applicant, belonging to such section of society that he would know the definition of neighbourhood area/neighbourhood school," the court observed.

"...This procedural lapse fails the objective of RTE Act, 2009. The trial court has overlooked this aspect while rejecting application," the order said.

The counsel for the school submitted that 45 students had been allotted seats under the RTE quota by the Education department. Yet, after verification of documents, only one had been admitted. Among the 45, the school said it had rejected 16 allotted candidates on the grounds of distance.

The court observed that statutory mandates are "indirectly being defeated when only one admission is granted out of 45 allotted seats".

Tabshir Shams

New Delhi, August 22

FOR TABA Rigum, 30, who hails from Arunachal Pradesh's Doimukh, the double whammy of a months-long fight against blood cancer followed by swine flu diagnosis this week amid a surge in cases in Capital has turned out to be exhausting.

Finally relieved after beating both the diseases, Rigum was discharged from the Apollo Hospital on Saturday. "I feel elated... I can finally go back home... to my family," he told *The Indian Express*.

Delhi has logged 1,777 swine flu cases so far this year as the Capital witnesses a surge in H1N1 infections. According to experts, people with suppressed immunity, co-morbidities and the elderly are at higher risk of getting infected.

Taba's suppressed immunity due to chemotherapy put him at risk, according to doctors.

Dr Chatterjee, an Internal Medicine specialist at Apollo Hospital, who treated Taba, said, "He was undergoing chemotherapy, which had significantly suppressed his immunity. Even as he required minimal oxygen support, he was kept in an isolation room for five days. Now, he has fully recovered."

Earlier this year, Taba had gone to donate blood for his mother, who was being treated for ovarian cancer, at a hospital in Arunachal Pradesh. But his own blood test report came back with an alarmingly low platelet count. Subsequent tests confirmed the cause - he had Acute Myeloid Leukaemia (AML), a rare form of cancer that begins in the bone marrow and floods the body with abnormal white blood cells that



Cancer survivor Taba Rigum

multiply quickly but don't function properly, leaving the body unable to fight off infection. Roughly one lakh Indians are diagnosed with leukaemia every year. A recent Lancet study found leukaemia to be the most common childhood cancer across all SAARC countries, typically making up 35-50% of national childhood cancer cases.

Taba came to Delhi a few months ago. At Apollo Hospital, he was put on induction chemotherapy — the first and the most intensive phase of the treatment, aimed at destroying as many leukaemia cells as possible and pushing the disease into remission.

It worked, but the treatment came at a cost. The chemotherapy that killed off his cancer cells also affected his immunity, leaving him acutely vulnerable to infections that a healthy person would easily fight off.

That vulnerability caught up with him in August. He developed a cold and a runny nose, then a high fever and a wet cough that soon turned relentless.

On August 18, he was hospitalised for what was meant to be a routine check-up. Doctors ran a fresh round of tests.

His bone marrow biopsy - a procedure used to check for residual cancer cells - came back negative for leukaemia, a positive sign for the blood cancer treatment. But another test came back positive: Taba had swine flu. "I could not even complete a sentence while talking... it was so bad," he said.

Dr Chatterjee said, "When we admitted Taba on August 18, he had high-grade fever. His counts — TLC (Total Leucocyte Count) and ANC (Absolute Neutrophil Count) — were very low."

For now, Taba, who works in the real estate sector in Dimapur, has been discharged and is on his way back home.

But many people in the Capital with low immunity continue to deal with swine flu. "For those with co-morbidities such as diabetes, chronic heart or lung disease, the elderly, and immunosuppressed patients undergoing cancer treatment, swine flu carries the risk of 'respiratory failure' and 'secondary infection leading to multi-organ dysfunction,'" said Dr Chatterjee.

He added, "Their fight remains one against a virus which is preventable with a vaccine shot, and Oseltamivir, the antiviral drug, if taken early on."

Dr Rommel Tickoo, Senior Director, Internal Medicine, at Max Hospital, Panchsheel Park, Delhi, added, "Swine flu can be particularly dangerous in patients with co-morbidities such as diabetes, heart or lung disease, obesity, kidney disease or weakened immunity. They are at a higher risk of severe pneumonia, respiratory failure and worsening of their underlying illness, making early diagnosis and treatment crucial."

• NATIONAL TEACHERS AWARD 2026

She started teaching with Rs 60 a day, two decades later, a national honour

Sophiya Mathew

New Delhi, August 22

IN 2004, Suman Goel returned to the school where she had once been a student, this time as a teacher. She earned Rs 60 a day — money that helped pay for her college education.

More than two decades later, now a primary teacher at the school — GSKV Pooth Kalan in Delhi's Rohini — Goel has been selected for the National Teachers Award 2026.

Goel (41) had topped Class 12 while graduating from the school in 2002. She went on to pursue a BA at Lakshmibai College, but financial difficulties meant she began teaching at the school while still in college. By 2004, she was earning around Rs 1,200-1,300 a month. While she secured a govern-

ment teacher's job in 2009, she has been a primary teacher at the school since 2013.

For Goel, returning to her old school was more than a career choice. It was a return to an institution she credits with shaping her own life. "I was a student here myself, so I always think that my students should not have to witness the problems that I have faced," she said.

Goel calls herself a "mother teacher" — one who teaches early grades and remains with the same group of children through Class 5, building a bond over several years.

For Goel, this has meant keeping sweaters and stationery in her cupboard for children who may suddenly need them, conducting tooth-brushing activities twice a week under an ICMR initiative, giv-

ing children iron tablets every Wednesday and keeping track of their food under PM Poshan.

"Before education, I work on their well-being... the child has to feel safe first," she said.

Her students, Goel said, are mainly first generation learners who come from Pooth Kalan, Krishan Vihar and Mangey Ram Park in the neighborhood. Their parents are mostly contractual labourers, tailors and daily-wage workers.

Her "mother teacher" role extends beyond lessons. She regularly follows up with parents about attendance, books and any additional support a child may need.

At dispersal, around noon, she tries to speak to parents as they arrive to collect their children, giving them feedback about the day's work. "We



Suman Goel felicitated with State Teachers Award in 2022.

come to know about the parents' problems, the parents come to know about their children's problems, and then we work together," she said.

She also works closely with children with special needs. She

recalls two students she recently taught — one with around 90% intellectual disability and another with a heart defect. Initially, they would sit separately from the rest of the class. "I gave them space within the class-

room, got them to interact with everyone and worked towards their social acceptance. Creating peer groups for them really helped," she said.

She said all her Class 4 students have achieved foundational literacy and numeracy goals, helped by a NIPUN Maths Kit she developed. The kit was selected at the state level under NIPUN Sankalp.

Her students have also participated in state-level drama and presentation events, including at Thyagaraj Stadium. When some of her students reached Class 8, she encouraged 10-12 of them to write about their ideas and connected them with a children's publishing platform. Their books were subsequently published.

Goel's own journey could easily have taken a different

turn. She studied in Haryana until Class 10 and wanted to take science and become a doctor. But after her family moved to Delhi amid financial difficulties, that path was no longer possible. Teaching became a way to continue her education.

Her parents died when she was relatively young. She says the teachers who encouraged her and, later, her husband, Gaurav Goyal, played an important role in her professional journey.

It was Goyal, a builder, who eventually persuaded her to apply for the National Teachers Award. Goel had already received the State Teachers Award.

"The application process takes two to three months. I felt that for those months, I will get less time to spend with my family," she said.

But her husband disagreed.

He arranged the IT facilities she needed at home and pushed her to complete the application.

Her family has had to accommodate the demands of her work. Goel's son is in Class 5 and her daughter in Class 12. She recalls spending Sundays at school while preparing students for state-level events and staying back beyond school hours when required.

For Goel, the award is not simply recognition for an individual teacher. It is recognition for the often unseen work done at the grassroots level — where teachers spend years not just teaching children, but understanding the circumstances that determine whether they can learn. "This award belongs to all those primary teachers who teach children with their hearts," she said.

Delhi to get third skywalk by Nov at Madhuban Chowk

Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, August 22

THE MUCH-AWAITED skywalk at Madhuban Chowk in North-west Delhi is expected to be completed by November in a boost to pedestrian safety, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said on Saturday. Once completed, this will be the third skywalk in the Capital. The first skywalk was constructed at ITO, which connects Tilak Marg, Pragati Maidan and Supreme Court Metro Station. The second is located in South Campus.

Located in proximity to the Rohini district court, Pitampura market and a mall, Madhuban Chowk is one of the busiest intersections in the Capital that witnesses heavy traffic jams and is also one of the top 10 pedestrian blackspots, reporting frequent accidents. Between 2020 and 2023, a significant number of accidents occurred at this spot, with around 10-11 fatalities reported annually, as per the official data.

The skywalk, which is nearly 60% complete, will provide safe pedestrian passage between Pitampura Metro Station, Madhuban Chowk Metro Station and Rohini District Court. Once complete, pedestrians will not have to risk their lives to cross the busy Outer Ring Road, said



The work for the skywalk is 60% complete. EXPRESS

officials. "It will make commuting between these key locations safe for Metro commuters, and others, including court staff and lawyers who visit Rohini Court regularly," said Gupta. The Chief Minister said that a safe pedestrian crossing between the metro stations and nearby destinations will also promote sustainable, public transport-based mobility. The estimated cost of the project is around Rs 9.62 crore and is expected to be completed by November 30.

Officials said that earlier the Public Works Department (PWD) had a plan to construct an 800-metre-long footover bridge (FOB), connecting the two Metro corridors at the Pitampura station. However, later, it decided to go for a skywalk connecting the Rohini district court directly with the Pi-

tampura Metro Station on the Red Line. With a new metro station coming up under the Phase IV Metro project, another arm of this skywalk will connect Janakpuri West to RK Ashram on the Pink Line.

Besides, the dedicated pedestrian route at Madhuban Chowk will also help improve traffic flow and reduce congestion. "The project will provide a safe and convenient pedestrian facility in an area where there is currently no grade-separated facility for crossing the road," said an official.

The skywalk is being constructed in three parts — one connecting the two Metro stations, another part will end near Rohini Court, and the third part will connect to the road junction leading to Prashant Vihar and Wazirpur.

BEGGED THEM TO STOP, THEY DIDN'T LISTEN, SAYS TECHIE'S MOTHER; HIS WIFE AMONG 4 ARRESTED

Software engineer strangled, hit on chest by in-laws after fight with wife over child's medicine, say police

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 22

A FIGHT with his wife over medication administered to one of their children turned fatal for 31-year-old software engineer Vinay Gupta on Friday after he was allegedly assaulted by her relatives in Northwest Delhi's Nihal Vihar area near his house, police said. As Vinay succumbed to the injuries sustained in the assault, four people — his wife, her two brothers and her sister-in-law — were arrested, said Vikram Singh, DCP Outer District.

Vinay's mother, Renu, told the police that she witnessed the attack. "I kept telling them (the accused) — 'Don't raise your hands'. But they pushed me as well. My thumb was fractured in the commotion," she said, claiming that her pleas to not hit her son were not heeded by the



Vinay and his wife Rekha.

accused. Her son, she told police, was strangled and hit on the chest repeatedly.

The accused have been identified as Vinay's wife Rekha, 31; his brothers-in-law Raju Jindal alias Rajkumar, 37, a chartered accountant, and Ved Prakash Jindal, 33, who runs a cloth shop in Rithala and Raju's wife Poonam, 37.

According to police, Vinay and Rekha had been married for

around three-and-a-half years. The couple had four-month-old twins, a boy and a girl, through IVF. Vinay worked as a software engineer with a private firm in Noida, while Rekha was a homemaker.

Police said a fight broke out between the couple on Friday morning over medication being administered to one of their children. Rekha then allegedly called her family members, who live nearby and reached the couple's house within a few minutes and allegedly assaulted Vinay.

Vinay's mother, Renu, who said she witnessed the attack, described the sequence of events to police. She said that after the initial argument, Rekha called her brothers, sister-in-law and other relatives. "They live nearby and reached the house within around five to seven minutes," she said.

Vinay's father said his daughter-in-law's brother and other relatives then came to the house and went upstairs to speak to the couple. The family initially believed they would talk calmly and resolve the matter.

Renu, crying while recalling the incident, said the situation quickly escalated. She alleged that the men immediately grabbed Vinay and pressed his neck hard with their hands. "I kept telling his brother-in-law not to raise his hands and to talk to him calmly and peacefully and sort out the matter," she said. However, according to Renu, one of the men grabbed Vinay, and threatened him, "I'll pull out all your hair."

She alleged that they then brutally thrashed Vinay, strangling him with their hands. She tried to intervene but she said she was pushed aside.

By the time they went downstairs, Vinay had fallen to the floor, after which, she alleged, they repeatedly kicked him in the chest.

According to Renu, the altercation subsequently spilled onto the street. She raised an alarm and called for help as the assault continued. Neighbours intervened and helped take Vinay to a hospital, where he succumbed to his injuries.

"My son was a simple man who didn't even drink or have any bad habits. He had an annual package of Rs 60 lakh and always kept his family first," Renu said.

A case under Sections 103(1) and 3(5) of the BNS has been filed. Police are examining CCTV footage, statements of eyewitnesses and other evidence to establish the sequence of events and the role of each accused.

Day 2 of protest by ABVP against promotion policy at varsity's Ghaziabad campus, police complaint filed

Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, August 22

TENSIONS CONTINUED to simmer at Christ University's Ghaziabad campus for the second day on Saturday as around 20 people, including members of the Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad (ABVP) and students, gathered outside the Mariam Nagar campus against the varsity's promotion policy. The protest began on Friday after 13 students were denied promotion to fourth year due to backlogs.

Even as the varsity officials said that a memorandum submitted by the affected students will be placed before its Examination Committee on Monday for consideration, the Christ University has lodged a complaint with the Ghaziabad Police against ABVP members who have been protesting outside its campus. *The Indian Express* has learnt. The complaint has been acknowledged by the Ghaziabad Police Commissionerate.

On Saturday, police said the



ABVP members at Christ University campus Saturday.

GAJENDRA YADAV

students and ABVP members, who claimed to be representing the affected students' families, were dispersed and there was no violent clash.

Around 13 students of the School of Law's BA LLB programme at the Ghaziabad campus face a delay in promotion after completing their third year as they have not cleared backlogs from the first or second year. While the university had revised its promotion policy for

other courses in line with the National Education Policy 2020 (NEP), the School of Law's policy was unchanged since it falls under the ambit of Bar Council of India regulations, the administration said.

Under this policy, according to the officials, students are required to "successfully complete" all courses from the first year to be promoted to the third year, and all courses of the first and second years to be promoted to the fourth year.

For promotion to subsequent semesters, the policy mandates that students must have been cleared in at least 50% of the total number of courses, including practical courses, from the cumulative semesters of the previous academic years, unless otherwise specified under programme regulations.

The revision made by the university on March 25 withdrew the earlier restrictions on promoting third-year UG students with first-year backlogs, while retaining the other pro-

motion requirements. Law students, however, were excluded from the revision as it applied only to UG programmes covered under the NEP.

Prof Akhilesh Tiwari, in-charge of administration at the Ghaziabad campus and an MBA faculty member, told *The Indian Express* that the issue affected students across multiple campuses and therefore could not be resolved through a campus-specific decision.

"The university has six campuses. Around 13 students face backlogs after finishing third year here, while in other campuses the number is higher: Bangalore has roughly 23, and two other campuses too have such students. There cannot be individual site-level decision that can be taken as a uniform action would be required across all these campuses."

Tiwari said students had been given time to clear their backlogs and that the university had received undertaking letters from them stating that

they were aware of the promotion policy.

Tanishq Shishodia, ABVP's Ghaziabad media coordinator, said attendance shortage was among the reasons behind student backlogs.

"Detention is a regular issue on this campus. They take hefty fines for attendance shortages and allow students to appear for examinations, but for those who aren't able to pay those who suffer and are not promoted," he claimed.

"We came to know about the issue five or six days ago, when parents approached us and said that nothing was happening on the matter," Shishodia said.

Satyam Sahu, a BBA LLB (Honours) student of the 2022 batch, said a medical condition and an attendance shortfall had affected his academic progression.

Anishka Joshi, another protesting student, said, "Pursuing law itself is a five-year process, which this policy has made into a six-year strenuous task."

• Skywatch

Forecast: August 23, 2026
Generally cloudy sky, a spell of very light to light rain.

MAX: 33-35

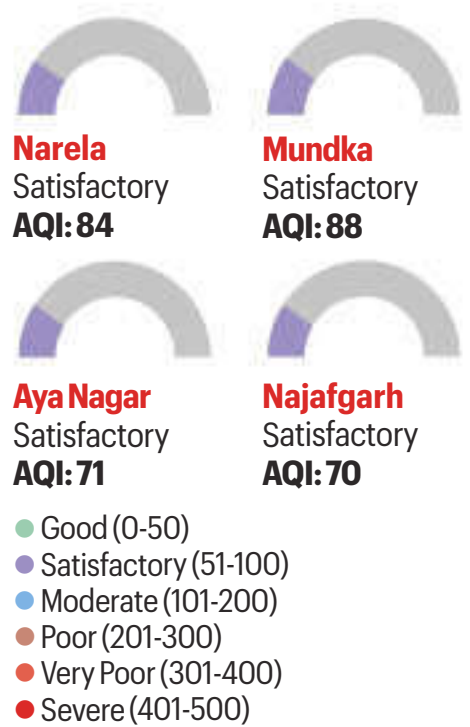
0.8°C below normal

MIN: 24-26

2.5°C below normal

- *Sunrise: 5:55 AM (August 24)*
- *Sunset: 6:53 PM (August 23)*
- *Moonrise: 3:51 PM (August 23)*
- *Moonset: 2:00 AM (August 24)*

• AQI Tracker



Man flaunts pistol in video, arrested

New Delhi: A 23-year-old man allegedly seen in a social media video with an illegal firearm was arrested in Northeast Delhi. A semi-automatic pistol and seven live cartridges recovered from his possession, police said on Saturday. The accused, Anas, a resident of Welcome Colony, was arrested following a tip-off, they said. An FIR was registered at the Welcome police station against him. The source of the clip is being verified. **PTI**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82(2)(ii) Cr.P.C.
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person namely **Deepak Raj S/o Sumer Singh, R/o: H. No. 268, Gali No. 04, Phase-1, Mangla Puri, Delhi** (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 456/2016, U/s 377/506/498A/406/34 IPC ACT**, registered at P.S.: Mayur Vihar, Delhi and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused **Deepak Raj** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Deepak Raj** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Deepak Raj** accused **FIR No. 456/2016, U/s 377/506/498A/406/34 IPC ACT**, registered at P.S.: Mayur Vihar, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.10.2026**.
By Order
Ritika Kansal
Judicial Magistrate First Class
(Mahila Court)-02, Court No. 24, Karkardooma Courts, Delhi
DP/11664/ED/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023
Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Idrish S/o Yousuf R/o Baikha PS Aurangabad Bulandshar, U.P** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **case FIR No. 59/23 U/s 419/420/468/471/120B IPC PS: Connaught Place New Delhi**, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Idrish** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Idrish** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Idrish** accused of **FIR No. 59/23 U/s 419/420/468/471/120B IPC PS: Connaught Place New Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **16.11.2026**.
By Order
Ms. Charan Salwan
JMFC - 01, Room No. 21
Patiala House Court, New Delhi
DP/11845/NDD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 BNSS/82 CrPC
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Ajay @ Komal S/o Late Sh. Rohtash R/o H. No. WZ-7, Village Nimri, Shastri Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 35/2018 U/S 380/411 IPC, PS Subzi Mandi, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Ajay @ Komal** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Ajay @ Komal** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Ajay @ Komal of FIR No. 35/2018 U/S 380/411 IPC, PS Subzi Mandi, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **23.09.2026**.
By Order,
Ms. Preeti Rajoria
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07(Central)
Room No.32
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi
DP/11823/N/2026(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.P.C.)
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Mohd. Sajid S/o Mohd. Shahid R/o H. No. 140, D Block, Street No. 3, Rajiv Nagar, Shri Ram Colony, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **Case FIR No. 349/2019, U/s 498A/406/506/34 IPC, PS Jafrabad, Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Mohd. Sajid** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Mohd. Sajid** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Mohd. Sajid of Case FIR No. 349/2019, U/s 498A/406/506/34 IPC, PS Jafrabad, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **30.09.2026**.
By Order
Pooja Suhag
Judicial Magistrate First Class
Mahila Court-03, Room No. 08, 2nd Floor, Karkardooma Courts, Delhi
DP/10471/NE/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
(See Section 82 Cr. PC/ 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused namely **Vijender Kumar S/o Sh. L. Raghvender Singh R/o N-2, Top Floor, Kalkaji Nagar, New Delhi-19** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **Case FIR No. 476/05, U/s 379/419/420/468/471 IPC PS: Connaught Place, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Vijender Kumar** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Vijender Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Vijender Kumar of FIR No. 476/05, U/s 379/419/420/468/471 IPC PS: Connaught Place, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **25.11.2026**.
By order
Charan Salwan
Judicial Magistrate First Class-01
21, First Floor, Main Building
Patiala House Court, New Delhi
DP/11569/NDD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Vishal Sharma S/o Ramesh Sharma R/o Village Chauhan Joshi, P.S. Rai, Distt. Sonapat, Haryana** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **case FIR No. 251/2018 U/s 33/58 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Welcome, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Vishal Sharma** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Vishal Sharma** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Vishal Sharma of case FIR No. 251/2018 U/s 33/58 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Welcome, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **21.09.2026**.
By Order
Ms. Deepakshi Rana
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
Room No. 19, First Floor, Shahdara District
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi
DP/10721/NE/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Gaurav Dhali, S/o: Shyam Sunder Dhali, R/o: 3, 4 Ground Floor, H-Block, Sector-11, Rohini, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **case FIR No. 30/2010, U/s 420/448, P.S.: Rani Bagh, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Gaurav Dhali** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Gaurav Dhali** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Gaurav Dhali** accused of offence in **case FIR No. 30/2010, U/s 420/448, P.S.: Rani Bagh, Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.10.2026**.
By Order
Ms. Anuradha Jindal
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate
Room No. 101, Rohini Court, Delhi
DP/11667/NW/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Nikhil Kumar Pandey, S/o: Bali Shankar Pandey, R/o: C-83, Camp No. 4, Jwalapuri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **case FIR No. 16/2021, U/s 420/409/120B IPC, P.S.: South Rohini, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Nikhil Kumar Pandey** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Nikhil Kumar Pandey** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Nikhil Kumar Pandey** accused of offence in **case case FIR No. 16/2021, U/s 420/409/120B IPC, P.S.: South Rohini, Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **01.10.2026**.
By Order
Sh. Jitender
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07
Room No. 208, Rohini Court, Delhi
DP/11751/RD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
(See Section 82 Cr. PC)
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Shrey S/o Late Mahesh Kumar R/o H.No. I-2/103-104 Sec-16, Rohini Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **case FIR No. 373/20 U/s 279/304 A IPC at PS: North Rihini, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Shrey** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Shrey** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Shrey of FIR No. 373/20 U/s 279/304A IPC at PS: North Rohini, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **03.10.2026**.
By order
Aakanksha
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
(North) Room No. 107, Rohini Courts, Delhi
DP/11617/RD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 BNSS
Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Sandhya W/o Rajendra R/o H. No. F-70, Gali No. 03 West Vinod Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **Ct Case No. 5491/2018 U/s 138 NI Act PS: Badarpur, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sandhya** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sandhya** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sandhya** accused of **Ct Case No. 5491/2018 U/s 138 NI Act PS: Badarpur, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **29.10.2026**.
By Order
Ms. Shruti Sharma-I.
JMFC- 02, Room No. 609
Saket Courts, New Delhi
DP/11829/SE/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Karan Singh @ Kishu, S/o: Ramsankar, R/o: N-15/BR-105, Nirankari, Indra Vikash Colony, Mukharjee Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **case FIR No. 305/2023 U/s 379/411/34 IPC, P.S.: Prasad Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Karan Singh @ Kishu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Karan Singh @ Kishu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Karan Singh @ Kishu** accused of offence in **case FIR No. 305/2023 U/s 379/411/34 IPC, P.S.: Prasad Nagar, Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **04.11.2026**.
By Order
Sh. Karanbir Singh
Judicial Magistrate First Class-02 (Central)
Room No. 26, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi
DP/10800/CD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sh. Shah Jamal, M/s Al Khadam Group, R/o 1) H.No. 8-24, DDA Flats, Mata Sunderi Road, Minto Road, Delhi-110001, 2) Fajal Guest House, Hazarat Nizamuddin, 3) 2,291, Lal Mahal Ghali Road, Nizamuddin, Delhi 11-13** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **case Ct Case 1658/2020, U/s 452/506/34323/341 IPC Act, P.S. Mayur Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Sh. Shah Jamal** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Sh. Shah Jamal** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sh. Shah Jamal** accused of **Ct Case 1658/2020, U/s 452/506/34323/341 IPC Act, P.S. Mayur Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **07.10.2026**.
By Order - **Ms. Ritika Kansal**
Judicial Magistrate First Class (Mahila Court)-02
Room No. 24, Karkardooma Courts, Delhi
DP/11661/ED/2026

Dipke booked over alleged school intrusion in Maharashtra

Vallabh Ozarkar
Mumbai, August 22

CJP CONVENOR Abhijeet Dipke has been booked along with CJP's Ajay Shinde and four to five unidentified persons for allegedly entering a Zilla Parishad school in Latur district without permission, questioning teachers in front of students, filming the proceedings and circulating the footage on social media.

The case was registered at Ausa police station in Maharashtra on Saturday following a complaint by a 53-year-old Zilla Parishad education department employee.

According to the police record, the incident took place around 1.10 pm on August 20 at a Zilla Parishad school in Urdh Ausa, around two km from Ausa in Latur district. The complaint states that Dipke, Shinde and the unidentified persons entered the school premises and sat among the students. They allegedly questioned those present about teaching and government-related work, disrupting the functioning of the school.

The complainant alleged that the group recorded the proceedings and circulated the footage on social media. "Although the children were students of the same school, they alleged that students of another school had been made to sit there, thereby defaming the school. They also looked at the teacher there and said, 'Yeh log haram ka khate hain' (These people take illegal money) and threatened him, saying, 'I will get you suspended,'" the FIR states.

FIR alleges that the accused obstructed teaching and government work at school. Police have invoked BNS Section 132, which deals with assault or use of criminal force against a public servant to deter him from performing his duty, as well as Sections 329(3) (criminal trespass), 351(2) (criminal intimidation), 356(2) (defamation) and 3(5) (acts done by several persons in furtherance of common intention).

My hands are clean, no hawala dealings by family: Pinarayi amid ED probe

Express News Service
Thiruvananthapuram, August 22

FORMER KERALA CM and Leader of Opposition Pinarayi Vijayan Saturday said his hands are clean and neither his daughter T Veena nor any other member of his family has engaged in hawala transactions.

This comes amid Enforcement Directorate's widening probe into alleged illegal payments made by Cochin Minerals and Rutile Limited (CMRL) to the IT firm owned by his daughter. "My hands are clean and I have full confidence that neither my daughter nor any of my family members have engaged in any hawala dealings. My hands will always remain clean," said Vijayan.

Questioning ED's claim regarding hawala transactions, Vijayan, also a member of CPI(M) politburo, said, "Veena was facing unusual actions on the ground that she is my daughter. She does not have huge wealth. She had cooperated with the probe and will continue to do so."

With ED probe going beyond the CMRL-Exalogic alleged payoff scam and more party leaders coming under scanner, the CPI(M) on Sunday will organise a meeting in Kozhikode in which state secretary M V Govindan is set to present the party's stand on the issue. Govindan has already said the searches were targeted at destroying CPI(M)'s credibility.

ED had earlier alleged that Exalogic Solutions, owned by Veena, received Rs 2.78 crore from CMRL in the guise of IT consultancy payments. Early this week, they searched eight premises linked to local CPI(M) leaders in Kozhikode, the home town of Vijayan's son-in-law and ex-minister Mohammed Riyas.

The ED had said it had found evidence related to transfer of money through hawala routes.

Boys can abuse but PM gets cultural shock if girls do it: Rahul in Pune

Soham Shah & Manoj More
Pune, August 22

CONGRESS MP and LoP Rahul Gandhi on Saturday urged girl students to "smash patriarchy", while targeting PM Narendra Modi over his remark that he was shocked to hear girls using abusive language during the students' protest at Jantar Mantar last month.

Gandhi said even though both boys and girls used abusive language during the protest, the PM "felt a cultural shock because girls used such a language". "If boys abuse, there is no problem, but if a girl abuses, it is a cultural shock," the Congress leader said. He was referring to a video released by the PM shortly after the CJP ended its Jantar Mantar protest. In the video the PM said he "forgave" the students for the insults.



Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi in Pune on Saturday. PAVAN KHENGRE

Interacting with students during his Chhatron ki Goonj programme at Pune's SSPMS Ground, Gandhi said the BJP and the RSS hold a mindset that wants women to be "confined within cages". "What is the mindset? That a girl should

be locked in a cage, she should be controlled, she should not work, and boys should get full freedom. They can do whatever they want, if they want to abuse they can abuse, if they want to work they can work... We do not want such an India," the Congress leader said.

gress leader said.

Gandhi also spoke about the various types of violence faced by women in the country. He quoted a verse from the Manusmriti, which says "a woman must obey her father in her childhood, in youth she belongs to her husband, and later she belongs to her sons".

"There is nothing wrong in being a daughter, a wife or a mother. But this cannot be your only identity," he said.

"For thousands of years, women have been denied their rights and entitlements in the country. The Manusmriti rules that women should not be independent, but women must be given freedom... Women must stand on their own feet and build their own identity... You belong to nobody, except yourself. You have a relationship with your father, brother, husband, your son, but you do not belong to

them, and you belong to yourself," he said.

During the event, several women, mostly college students, went up on stage and spoke to Gandhi about the issues they face daily. Through multiple slides presented on a big screen, Gandhi spoke about the cost of violence faced by women, the disrespect they are subjected to and how time has been weaponised against them.

"In the name of safety, 50% of women are denied education or employment opportunities. Then there is economic violence... Women are subjected to various forms of control in the country," he said. Women and girls are India's strength, its foundation and its future, Gandhi said, adding, "patriarchy suppresses you, scares you, threatens you, controls you". "Together we have to finish this patriarchy — smash the patriarchy."

WAS HEADED TO SINGAPORE

Panama-flagged ship with 24 crew members sinks off Odisha coast

Sujit Bisoyi
Bhubaneswar, August 22

A PANAMA-FLAGGED cargo ship sank in the Bay of Bengal on Saturday, about 240 nautical miles from the Paradip coast in Odisha, officials confirmed.

The ship, with 24 crew members on board, had left the Odisha coast on August 21 and was headed towards Singapore. The vessel, MV Ocean-Winner, was carrying around 1700 tonnes of iron ore from Odisha when the tragedy struck.

According to sources, two crew members have been rescued, while efforts are underway to trace the others. A senior IPS officer said 20 of the 24 crew members are Chinese nationals, three are from Myanmar, and one is from Bangladesh.

"A rescue operation has been launched by the Indian Coast Guard and Indian Navy

A senior IPS officer said 20 of the 24 crew members are Chinese nationals, three are from Myanmar, and one is from Bangladesh.

after receiving a distress call. Other vessels in the vicinity have been alerted to assist in the rescue effort," he said. "The Indian Coast Guard has been deploying additional boats from Andaman to expedite the rescue efforts. Efforts are being made to establish contact with the crew members."

Asked about the circumstances that led to the mishap, the police officer said they are yet unknown. Neither the Paradip Port nor the Indian Coast Guard has issued a statement.

SHAH MEETS GORKHA LEADERS IN SILIGURI

Govt forms panel for 'permanent political solution' to Gorkha issue

Atri Mitra
Kolkata, August 22

THE CENTRE on Saturday constituted a committee to find a "permanent political solution" to the Gorkha identity issue in the Darjeeling hills and adjoining areas, officials said following a key meeting of Gorkha leaders with Union Home Minister Amit Shah and West Bengal government in Siliguri.

The new panel has been tasked with preparing a report on resolving the Gorkha issue within the Constitutional framework, and submit its findings to the Centre. The MHA statement said, "All issues relating to the hill population of West Bengal were discussed in detail. Their demands pertaining to a distinct identity, a permanent political solution and recognition under the Constitution of India were taken up. The Union Home Minister promised a permanent political solution soon under the umbrella of the Constitution. He



Home Minister Amit Shah and CM Suwendu Adhikari at a meeting with representatives of hill areas of Bengal, in Siliguri on Saturday. ANI

also promised to sympathetically look into all other demands of the community and said that adequate funding from the Centre will ensure all pending issues are taken care of."

The meeting was attended by CM Suwendu Adhikari and leaders of parties of the hills and other stakeholders of the region. The panel will be led by former deputy NSA Pankaj Kumar Singh. He was appointed by MHA as interlocutor for issues relating to the Dar-

jeeling hills, Dooars and Terai in 2025.

Shah addressed the demand for ST status for 11 Gorkha communities and presented a blueprint for fulfilling their demands. On X, he said, "...Reiterated that under the leadership of PM Modi Ji, the government is firmly committed to addressing these issues. Assured them every possible effort will be made to address legitimate aspirations within the framework of the Constitution."

'Tremendous, largely untapped potential in India-Turkiye relations across every pillar'

ALMOST A year after he took over as Türkiye's Ambassador to India, steering bilateral ties in the most difficult phase in the aftermath of Operation Sindoor, where Ankara was seen to be siding with Islamabad, leading to a boycott by Indian travellers and business, **Ali Murat Ersoy** speaks to **Divya A** on how much of lost ground has been recovered, how they plan to keep the ties insulated from geopolitical disruptions, and what he sets out to achieve during his tenure here. Excerpts:

How much of the lost ground has been recovered after the boycott of 2025? What measures were taken?

We took this moment seriously and responded with concrete action. We intensified direct engagement with the Indian travel trade. We also invested in transparent, direct communication with Indian media to ensure the strength of the India-Turkiye relationship — at the people-to-people level — was not lost in a Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRbRG6JKOH6oBd0F>

moment of geopolitical noise.

The relationship between Türkiye and Indian travellers has always been built on genuine warmth and mutual respect, and we are encouraged by the pace of recovery we've seen since 2025 last quarter. Arrivals from India have been gradually increasing and reached almost 120,000 between January and August this year. Early indicators for the second half of the year suggest that momentum continues to build. We understand that trust, once affected, has to be rebuilt with consistency, not just messaging.

Has the thaw in ties — especially resumption of foreign office consultations — helped other sectors, such as tourism?

Tourism, by its nature, tends to be one of the more resilient sectors when it comes to weathering geopolitical fluctuations, largely because it is powered by people-to-people connection rather than policy alone.

Tourism is one of the most



ALI MURAT ERSOY
TURKIYE'S AMBASSADOR TO INDIA

Going forward, our approach is to build a tourism relationship that is diversified and deeply rooted — not dependent on any single narrative or news cycle. That means continuing to invest in direct relations with Indian travel trade, media and travellers themselves, so that perception of Türkiye is shaped by real experiences rather than external noise.

What are the key pillars of India-Turkiye ties in the present context?

Tourism is one of the most

visible pillars, but it sits alongside a broader relationship spanning trade, defence-adjacent co-operation in some areas, education & cultural exchange. Trade between our two countries continues to grow, and we see increasing interest from Turkish businesses in construction, textiles and infrastructure, alongside growing Indian investment interest in Türkiye. Educational & cultural exchange also remains an important pillar...

Turkiye visa cost is among the highest, even surpassing EU and US visas. Is there any thought on easing or slashing the visa fee?

This is a topic we take seriously in our ongoing conversations with relevant Turkish authorities. While visa policy sits outside direct mandate of the tourism promotion bodies, we relay market feedback — including on cost sensitivity — as part of our broader effort to make Türkiye more accessible to Indian visitors.

Turkiye offers a relatively efficient e-visa process for eligible Indian travellers, and our focus remains on ensuring speed, convenience and reliability. Any changes to the visa fee structures would be a decision for the Ministry of Foreign Affairs, but the strength and priority of the Indian market is very much part of that conversation.

What are you looking forward to build upon during your tenure here?

India is a country I have enormous respect for, and I see tremendous, largely untapped potential in the India-Turkiye relationship across every pillar we've discussed. During my tenure, I want to focus on deepening trust — through consistency, transparency and sustained engagement rather than moments of high visibility alone. I want my time here to leave the relationship stronger, broader and more resilient than I found it.

Delhi-Dhaka chill: Jaishankar flags mutual interests, common ground

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, August 22

AMID THE ongoing diplomatic tug-of-war between India and Bangladesh, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar said on Saturday that they have to look at "mutual interests" and meet at a "common ground".

His remarks come at a time when Bangladesh Prime Minister Tarique Rahman's visit to India is facing uncertainty over the issue of extradition of ousted Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina.

Responding to questions on how he views Dhaka's demand for Hasina's extradition, Jaishankar said at the Economic Times World Leaders Forum: "I am not going to sit here and discuss what could be or may not be conversations or not between us and a neighbouring country. See, what I can tell you is, for any relationship to work, it has to meet the extent of mutual interest. It has to work for them. It has to work for us. I am also realistic. I am not expecting neighbours to only do what is in my interest. There has to be a fair degree of, a reasonable degree of, my recognising and respecting what is their interest, just as I expect them also to do so. It is when you get that landing point, that common ground, that relationships work smoothly. So, I would say this, in respect of all neighbours, that relationships, at the end of the day, are a kind of mutuality which underpins that exercise."

Ties between the two countries, severely strained following the August 2024 ouster of PM Sheikh Hasina who sought refuge in India, had been looking up after Rahman took charge of Bangladesh in February this year. But Hasina's public interaction in New Delhi via an audio link on August 5 — it marked two years of her ouster — angered Dhaka, which has been seeking her extradition to Bangladesh where she faces a death sentence. It also cast a shadow over Rahman's visit to India, which is being explored by the two sides.

At a time when the world faces conflicts and intense competition, Jaishankar also said that "de-risking" is the strategy to move forward. "De-risking would be my biggest mantra and the second would be to diversify. So the more partners, more sources that you have, clearly to that extent, you have de-risked it," he said.

"We are finding a very distorted energy market, a very distorted fertiliser market, very distorted shipping. So, because the chokepoints are creating distortions, once upon a time, they said, 'trust but verify'; today, I'd say, 'distrust and diversify', which assumes that things may not go right. Build it into your plans... don't let your supply chains really be just in time anymore. Don't always assume that the lowest cost will be the determinant. Today, you have to build in that margin of safety... energy markets are a very good example. So, even for businesses, I think the supply chains, the more you diversify it, the more you hedge, because you can't trust the world to work in the most efficient manner because of all these distortions. I think this is the reality of the world, and it applies to national policymakers," he said.

"I think we need to hardwire the risks into our thinking and make de-risking almost like a second habit," he added.

On the situation with China,



We have to do business with the entire world... China too, but it is important we deal with them confidently: Jaishankar

• Jaishankar begins Russia visit today

Ahead of Russian President Vladimir Putin's visit to India in September for the BRICS leaders' summit, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar will be on a two-day visit to Moscow beginning Sunday to hold talks with Russian Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov and First Deputy Prime Minister Denis Manturov. The MEA said Jaishankar will undertake an official visit to Russia on August 23-24 to co-chair the 27th Session of the India-Russia Inter-Governmental Commission on Trade, Economic, Scientific, Technological and Cultural Cooperation. This meeting will take place with Denis Manturov. He will also meet Lavrov — the second meeting in a month — and exchange perspectives on regional and global issues, according to MEA. ENS

Jaishankar said: "I think we went through a particularly bad patch between the summer of 2020 and the autumn of 2024, and that was primarily an outcome of the situation in the border areas... At the end of the day, peace and tranquility in the border areas is a prerequisite for good relations, and the state of the border, to a very large measure, naturally would determine the state of the relations. Having said that, I think naturally, if assuming things are stable and the needle is more cooperative, obviously, I mean we are both very big economies. In many ways, we are markets to each other. We are part of the supply chain. They industrialised much faster and much bigger and much earlier, largely because of many of the policies we advocate."

"The world is competitive. We must build up our strengths. We have to do business with the entire world. That includes China too, but it is important we deal with them confidently. We stand our ground, as we have stood on the border. We develop our strengths, which unfortunately from the 1960s for half a century, we did not do. We have to make up for the shortcomings and the mistakes of the past, and that is really what we are hoping to do. So I think a stronger, more self-reliant India, a more industrialised India, a more manufacturing India will be able to actually compete with China as it will with other major countries of the world," Jaishankar said.

He said the government has "taken up" the problem of business visas being faced by Indian applicants with China. On the concept of G-2 (US and China), he said: "I would advise you to treat it with some caution because the fact is, if you look at the US-China relationship, I think at its heart it's a fundamentally competitive relationship. But, as is often the case, it can also be collaborative in certain matters. It can be indifferent in certain sectors... so it's a very complicated relationship, as is natural."

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5 family MPs ensured SP never split: Akhilesh lists parivarvad benefits

Lalmani Verma
Lucknow, August 22

SAMAJWADI PARTY (SP) president Akhilesh Yadav on Saturday said that parivarvaad (dynasty politics) has its own advantages and his party never split because it has five MPs from one family.

Yadav made the remark during a press conference at SP headquarters in Lucknow where he also rejected rumours that attempts were made by opponents to split the party.

In reply to a question about BJP's allegations of SP encour-

aging nepotism in politics by giving tickets to many candidates from one family, Yadav said that one should also think about the advantages of parivarvaad. "Kabhi kabhi aapko yeh bhi sochna hai ki parivarvaad se laabh kya hota hai (sometimes you should think about the advantages of nepotism)," Yadav said, adding that it was heard recently in Lok Sabha that poaching of MPs was being done.

"Several parties faced a split. Did you ever think why the SP did not face a split?" Yadav questioned and subsequently replied, "... because five



SP chief Akhilesh Yadav and MP Dimple Yadav in Lucknow, Saturday. PTI

of its MPs were from the same family. And we had many Muslim MPs... and some were die-hard Samajwadi. I am saying that sometimes there are advantages to parivarvaad," he said, adding that no attempts were made to break the SP.

In June this year, NDA ally SBSP chief Om Prakash Rajbhar had claimed that SP could be the next Opposition party — after Trinamool Congress — to face a split in Parliament.

The five MPs Akhilesh Yadav was referring to are: Yadav himself, MP from Kan-

naur; his wife Dimple, MP from Mainpuri; and his cousins Aditya Yadav, Akshay Yadav, and Dharmendra Yadav, MPs from Badaun, Firozabad, and Azamgarh, respectively.

Confident of retaining its core Muslim-Yadav voter base and seeking to make inroads into the votes of non-Yadav OBCs, Akhilesh in the 2024 Lok Sabha elections had fielded only five candidates from the Yadav community in the 62 seats it contested in Uttar Pradesh. Incidentally, all five are from party founder Mulayam Singh Yadav's family, and all won.

While Aditya is the son of

Mulayam's brother and Jaswantnagar MLA Shivpal Yadav, Akshay is the son of the SP patriarch's cousin Ram Gopal Yadav, who is a Rajya Sabha MP. Dharmendra is the son of Mulayam's brother Abhay Ram Yadav, who has stayed away from politics.

The Muslim MPs Yadav referred to include Afzal Ansari of Ghazipur, Iqra Choudhary of Kairana, Zia Ur Rehman from Sambhal and Mohibullah from Rampur. Except Mohibullah, the other three have inherited the political legacy of their families.

Sanskrit Board topper accused of changing name, birth date; UP orders award recovery

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, August 22

MONTHS AFTER Pratapgarh native Rajneesh Yadav was felicitated for topping the Class 12 Sanskrit Board examination, the Uttar Pradesh government has ordered the recovery of the awards after an inquiry found that he had allegedly changed his name and date of birth by manipulating his Aadhaar card. In June, Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath had presented the accused with a Rs 1 lakh cash prize, tablet, medal and certificate for passing the state government's Uttar Madhyama examination this year in first division. An inquiry reportedly found that Yadav is actually Ajay Kumar, a resident of Baijalpur village, and that he had falsely shown his year of birth as 2010 instead of 1998. Following the allegations, the education department ordered an inquiry and constituted a two-member panel to verify records and examine the claims. "We checked the relevant documents and other details and found the allegations to be true. We submitted our findings to the District Inspector of Schools (DIOS), who forwarded the report to the department headquarters in Lucknow," said Ashok Kumar, principal of a government higher secondary school in Pratapgarh and a

member of the inquiry panel. Another panel member was government college principal Vindhachal Singh. The state government has ordered the recovery of the cash prize along with the return of the tablet, medal and certificate. "We visited his house to recover the items, but it was locked," Kumar said. The matter came to light following a complaint by the accused's relative, Jagat Prasad, who demanded a thorough police investigation to establish how the accused prepared the alleged forged documents. The police booked Ajay Kumar on charges of cheating and forgery. Prasad said it needs to be investigated whether anyone else directed or helped him. According to police, Jagat Prasad stated in his complaint that Ajay passed his High School and Intermediate exams conducted by the Board of High School and Intermediate Education, Allahabad, and his graduation exam from Purvanchal University, and in all those records, his DOB is May 13, 1998. His name in the ration card is also recorded as Ajay Kumar, son of Harilal, with the date of birth as May 13, 1998. His name also appears as Ajay, son of Harilal, in the electoral roll as well, he said. Pratapgarh DIOS Omkar Rana did not respond to calls seeking his comment.

Bar of India deserves better: 2 BCI members want Mishra to resign

Express News Service
Bengaluru August 22



Bar Council of India Chairman Manan Kumar Mishra

THE DEMAND for the resignation of Bar Council of India (BCI) Chairman Manan Kumar Mishra intensified on Saturday as Senior Advocate Manoj Kumar N, the Vice-Chairman of the BCI Executive Committee, sought his removal during the General Council meeting, chaired by Mishra, at the BCI office. BCI Co-Chairman and Senior Advocate Y R Sadasiva Reddy wrote to Mishra on Saturday, asking him to quit the post forthwith even as a lawyer filed a plea in the Supreme Court challenging the legality of his prolonged tenure as the Bar Council chief. Mishra, however, pushed back the resignation demand, saying the allegations against him were baseless and had no value in the eyes of the law. He also claimed that Reddy was not the BCI Co-Chairman and no longer a council member. Speaking to *The Indian Express*, Advocate Kumar said: "I demanded that the Chairman resign from his post forthwith. Advocate Srinath Tripathi, member of BCI (from Uttar Pradesh), supported my demand. Reddy, who has written a letter separately to Mishra seeking his resignation, was not present at the meeting." Later, Kumar too sent a letter to Mishra raising the demand. The letters written by the BCI members sought Mishra's resignation in the larger interest of

Chairman. He is not even a member of State Bar Council. While he was a member of BCI, he was opposed to me, tried to contest against me, but couldn't get even a proposer. Politically also he is opposed to me... Everything is transparent here. He has made all false and baseless allegations after getting ousted from the Bar Council." In response to Kumar's allegations, he said: "It's a democratic institution; every member has the right to have his voice." Mishra came to be surrounded by controversy after he issued a directive on August 13, asking state Bar councils not to enrol students of NALSAR's (National Academy of Legal Studies and Research, University of Law, Hyderabad) 2026 batch following a campaign by around 450 students of NALSAR opposing an invitation to CJI Surya Kant to the university convocation. Mishra withdrew the circular hours later, saying the BCI had closed the proceedings after concluding that the students had "no role in any disturbance or movement". Kumar and Reddy in their letters stated that the direction against the graduating batch of NALSAR was issued without material being placed before the BCI, without the Council deliberating upon it, and without any resolution of the BCI authorising it. Reddy said: "I was not consulted. To the best of my knowl-

edge, the Council as a body was not consulted. The office of Chairman was used to threaten the entire graduating batch of law students — young men/women with no power and no voice — with exclusion from the profession, as a reprisal for having held an opinion." A plea has been filed in the SC challenging the legality of Mishra's prolonged tenure and seeking his removal. Mishra was first elected as BCI Chairman in 2012. Although he briefly demitted office in 2014, he returned in November that year and has remained in the post since then, said the plea, filed by advocate Yogamaya MG. The petition contends that Rule 12(2) of the BCI prescribes a two-year term for the chairman and vice-chairman, or until cessation of membership, whichever is earlier. Both Kumar and Reddy also opposed Mishra continuing as BCI Chairman. Reddy said: "You have held office continuously since 2012, and were returned for a further consecutive term in 2025. This is without precedent. An elected office that has one occupant for fourteen years has ceased, in any real sense, to be an elected office." Mishra refuted this claim, saying there is no fixed tenure under the Advocates Act for a Chairman to continue in the office. "I am an elected member by my voters and thus there cannot be a limit on my tenure," he told the media.

BRIEFLY



Firefighters at the site of explosion at a pharmaceutical company in Yadadri Bhuvanagiri district, Telangana. PTI

TELANGANA

Two dead, 9 injured in reactor explosion at pharmaceutical unit

TWO WORKERS were killed and nine others injured in what police described as a reactor explosion at a pharmaceutical industrial unit on the outskirts of Anthammagudam village in Telangana's Yadadri-Bhuvanagiri district on Friday. "This is the second incident at the pharma unit," Pochampally Police told *The Indian Express*, referring to a worker's death at the unit in July. The police have launched an investigation into both incidents. ENS

IISc student found dead in hostel

A 22-YEAR-OLD MTech student at the Indian Institute of Science (IISc) in Bengaluru allegedly died by suicide in his hostel room on Thursday, the police said, adding that the student may have been facing relationship-related issues. Investigation is underway. The death comes 15 days after another student was found dead in his room. ENS

FIR over 'false' message on X

AHMEDABAD CITY Police on Saturday booked the individual behind the X handle "Pawan Tyagi (@PAWANTYAGI_07)" for allegedly publishing what they said was a "false message" about Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel. As per their statement, the post "caused damage to the constitutional post of the Chief Minister. ENS

EXPRESS special

Arrest of migrant from Valley in Jammu marks key moment in narco-terror network probe

Arun Sharma
Jammu, August 22

WHEN THE sleuths of the State Investigation Agency (SIA) arrested a 35-year-old man from Jammu for alleged involvement in a cross-border narco-terror financing network, it revealed a new and challenging dimension of the problem. A specialised anti-terrorism and law enforcement agency set up by the J&K government, SIA has been looking for this man for four years to little success. The man would keep changing his hideout, and rarely carried a mobile phone. He had managed to give police the slip, leaving behind a stash of heroin, only three months ago. The arrest, therefore, marked a major success for the police. But what made the operation even more significant was his identity — he is a Kashmiri Pandit, a community who had to leave their homes in the Valley and take refuge in Jammu over 35 years ago. Identified as Manoj Kumar Bhat alias Pintu, he is said to be the son of a retired government employee who lived in Rehari Colony in Jammu's Bakshi Nagar. The arrest has shocked the community, though no one in the city seemed to have any association with Pintu. Members of the community



The SIA raid at Pintu's residential premises in Jammu led to seizure of 15 grams of heroin. SHUAIB MASOODI

find it difficult to accept that one of their own could have anything to do with Pakistan-sponsored terror — the very reason that triggered their mass exodus from their native places in the Valley in 1990. "Badnaam kar ke rakh dia (he has given us a bad name)," said a resident of Subhash Nagar. SIA claims that Pintu is the first Kashmiri Pandit they have arrested for alleged involvement in cross border narco-terror financing network in J&K. Pintu's family had migrated to Jammu from the Rainawari area of Srinagar, officials said, adding that his father was an employee in the Roads and Building (R&B) Department and retired as Deputy Director.

cording to an SIA statement. The case was registered following the recovery of a kilogram of heroin from two people — Zeeshan Ahmad Sofi and Waseem Ahmad Khan — at Nowpora in Sopore district of Kashmir. Subsequent investigation resulted in recovery of 7kg of poppy straw and 4kg of poppy seeds, possibly to make opium. The SIA raid at Pintu's residential premises in Jammu led to seizure of 15 grams of heroin. A few gadgets and a motorcycle were also seized, which are presently under forensic/technical examination, it said. In the four-year period he eluded the police, Pintu visited Kashmir multiple times, an SIA official said. During questioning, nearly half-a-dozen persons arrested in the case from different parts of Valley confirmed that Pintu had been visiting Kashmir to collect narcotics smuggled from across the LoC, the official added. However, to evade counter-terror and law-enforcement agencies, he made sure not to keep any mobile phone with him during his stay, the official added. The agency found that he was active in Jammu's Rehari, Sidhra, Nagrota, Nai Basti and Qasim Nagar. The SIA had raided a place in Jammu nearly three months ago, but Pintu managed to give

the sleuths the slip, leaving behind a sizeable quantity of heroin, which was seized. Having collected fresh information about Pintu's movement in a particular area in Jammu, an SIA team, which was already in the city looking for him, swooped down on him. His mistake: Switching on one of his mobile phones. SIA has not revealed the exact location of Pintu's arrest. The probe has revealed a sinister nexus in which narcotics are trafficked into J&K, distributed through an established network, and the proceeds generated from their sale pumped into activities intended to sustain and further the terrorist ecosystem, SIA added. Apart from Pintu, Sofi, and Waseem, police have arrested Ahmad Khan, Bashir Ahmad Koli, Mohammad Ashraf Lone, Mohammad Saleem Khan, and Zafraan Khan in the matter. Barring Pintu, Sofi and Waseem, all were picked from Baramulla. By targeting the entire chain — from cross-LoC narcotics trafficking to local distribution to the financial proceeds generated therefrom — we are pursuing the broader objective of financially strangulating and dismantling the support structures that sustain terrorism, an SIA, Kashmir, official told *The Indian Express*.

Kanchan Vasdev & Abhimanyu Hazarika
Chandigarh, Gurgaon, August 22

PUNJAB CHIEF Minister Bhagwant Mann's wife, Dr Gurpreet Kaur, Saturday sent a legal notice to retired Punjab and Haryana High Court Justice Ranjit Singh after the National Human Rights Commission directed Punjab Chief Secretary and police chief to inquire into allegations she sought Rs 5 crore to suppress a rape case, officials said. When contacted, Justice Singh, however, told *The Indian Express* he had not made any complaint to the NHRC. "I have not complained to anyone about anyone," he said when asked about the NHRC notice to the DGP and Punjab government. He also said he has "not received any notice from Dr Gurpreet Kaur either". In the notice to Justice Ranjit Singh (retd), Gurpreet Kaur sought an apology within 24 hours, failing which legal proceedings would be initiated. Justice Singh's statement assume significance as NHRC member Priyank Kanoongo said in a media briefing that the Commission issued the notice after taking cognisance of his complaint.

"We have received a complaint from former Punjab and Haryana High Court judge, Justice Ranjit Singh, alleging that the wife of Punjab CM Bhagwant Mann attempted to hush up a rape case in exchange for a bribe of Rs 5 crore," Kanoongo told media. The complaint raised concerns that such "interference" could compromise the victim's right to dignity, safety, fair investigation, and access to justice, as per the a statement issued by the Commission. The complainant has requested independent verification of the allegation, preservation of evidence, and "impartial inquiry into any attempt to dilute or influence the investigation," it said. Issuing notices under Section 12 of the Protection of Human Rights Act, the NHRC directed the Chief Secretary and DGP to inquire into the allegation and submit an action taken report within two weeks. It, however, did not issue any personal notice to Dr Gurpreet Kaur, an official said. Justice Singh is the brother-in-law of Congress MLA Sukhpal Singh Khaira, a connection highlighted by the Chief Minister's Office while announcing the legal notice. Punjab Congress president Amrinder Singh Raja Warring

said the chief minister "should give his clarification on the issue". Former chief minister and Congress leader Charanjit Singh Channi said the matter pertaining to the allegations should be inquired by CBI. Shiromani Akali Dal leader and former Punjab Minister Bikram Singh Majithia too said Mann should respond to the allegations. "You have lost the trust of the people of Punjab on moral grounds. Immediately send your resignation to the Punjab Governor," Majithia said in a social media post. Aam Aadmi Party's Moga MLA and party's women wing president Dr Amandeep Kaur hit back making false allegations and attacking an individual's private life, reputation and character would not be accepted at any cost. "When lies cross all limits, they will be answered not only politically but also through legal means," she said. Later in the day, Chief Minister Mann called on Governor Gulab Chand Kataria and held a closed door meeting with him. "We do not know what it was for," said an official. A few days ago, the CM had met the Governor to seek 10 days parole for former chief Minister Beant Singh's assassin, Jagtar Singh Hawara.

FROM US COURT TO CANADIAN BORDER IN 24 HOURS

Gujarat man in \$7.5 million fraud case caught before Doha flight

Aditi Raja
Vadodara, August 22

LESS THAN 24 hours after walking out of a US courtroom on pretrial release, a 21-year-old Indian national — accused in a \$7.5-million fraud targeting elderly victims — was allegedly on the run — crossing into Canada and booking a flight to Doha before being stopped at Toronto airport. Jay Sunilbharthi Goswami, who is from Gujarat, had been living in Jersey City, New Jersey. He has been charged with wire fraud, conspiracy to commit wire fraud, money laundering and conspiracy to commit money laundering. The charges carry a maximum penalty of 20 years in prison, according to the US Attorney's Office.

Goswami appeared before US Magistrate on August 17 and was released on conditions. The next morning, at approximately 10.25 am, authorities said, he crossed the Peace Bridge into Canada. Investigators subsequently learnt that he was booked on a flight from Toronto to Doha that evening. The US Probation Office filed a violation report, following which the court issued an arrest warrant. At 7.13 pm local time, Canadian authorities took Goswami into custody at Toronto Pearson International Airport on immigration violations. He was formally arrested on August 20 following a US request for his provisional arrest pending extradition, as per the release of the US Attorney. The criminal complaint stems from what US investiga-

tors describe as an elaborate Internet- and telephone-based fraud scheme that preyed on elderly people in western New York and elsewhere in the country. According to the US Attorney's Office, the perpetrators allegedly convinced victims that their "bank accounts, funds, and/or personal information" had been "threatened or compromised in some manner". The victims were then allegedly persuaded to turn their assets into cash, gold or gift cards. Where the alleged scheme involved cash or gold, the conspirators used what investigators called "money mules" to physically collect the valuables and pass them further through the network. According to the complaint, Goswami was one of them.

New book topstitches a Savile Row master's Indian heritage

Trisha Mukherjee
New Delhi, August 22

GOOGLE ANDREW M Ramroop. He is a bespoke tailor. He is a Trinidadian. He lives in London. He owns the famed Savile Row tailoring institution Maurice Sedwell. And he is black. All true, except that Ramroop's ancestral heritage is Indian. Setting the record straight is a new book — *Bespoken: From Tunapuna to Buckingham Palace* — by former civil servant Ashok Kumar Bal, which was launched in Delhi on Saturday. It tells the story of Ramroop's relentless pursuit of excellence to create "ultra-bespoke tailoring". By connecting his success with his roots, Bal shows how, notwithstanding a life of poverty, Ramroop today is the most sought-after hand by the likes of cricketer Brian Lara and actor Samuel L Jackson. Despite being identified as Black on several occasions, including on the news, in films



AMIT MEHRA

(From left) Rajiya Sabha Deputy Chairman Harivansh, master tailor Andrew M Ramroop, Design Council of India chairman Sunil Sethi and author Ashok Kumar Bal at the launch of his book on Saturday

and even on Maurice Sedwell's official website, Ramroop, 73, never attempted to correct the narrative. "I never felt the need to," he shrugged. Recalling a BBC documentary from 1998, titled *Black Firsts*, that introduced him as the "first Black tailor on Savile Row", Ramroop told *The Indian Express*, "To be described as black... I always regard it as

only my colour as opposed to being African." "Ashok Bal has given me an opportunity to correct this in an important way," he added. *Bespoken* happened serendipitously both to Ramroop and Bal. The author, in early 2023, needed a suit stitched for the wedding of a close friend's son. He landed at a shop in Mumbai's Kala Ghoda. On the wall was a certificate from Savile Row Bespoke Academy that bore Ramroop's signature. "I knew about Savile Row but had no clue about Andrew. The tailor at the shop spoke to me for nearly an hour detailing Andrew's achievements. My interest was piqued," Bal said. Soon after, he found himself digging deep into Ramroop's life history. He discovered Luchmin, a 26-year-old widow from Lucknow. She travelled to Calcutta with her nine-year-old son Munnao to board the ship for the unfamiliar Trinidad as indentured labourers. They finally left the country in 1889. On the voyage, she met Bhairo Prasad, a fellow labourer, whom she went on to marry. Luchmin and Prasad were Ramroop's great grandparents. They chose to stay back in Trinidad after completing their indenture, setting forth a timeline that would some day yield one of the finest tailors in the history of bespoke tailoring.

The more Bal discovered, the more eager he became to speak to Ramroop, whose private personality refused all requests to tell his "life's journey". The latter never felt his life was interesting enough for other people and couldn't "see or visualise what everybody from outside is looking in". It took Bal 36 cold emails and the right angle — his Indian ancestry — to convince Ramroop. In the mail accepting Bal's offer of a book, he wrote, "Many, in African countries, and African Americans, think that my heritage is African — I need to correct this perception". One of Ramroop's biggest contributions to the fashion industry has been the 'ultra-bespoke', a philosophy he trademarked and introduced at Maurice Sedwell in 2008. "Fashion is about seasons. Ultra-bespoke outlasts fashion. I stitched the suit I am wearing in 2002. It is about sustainability," said the artisan.

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I, MUZAMMIL MERAJ S/o MERAJ UDDIN, R/O G-45A EAST OF KAILASH SRINIVASPURI DELHI 110065, have changed the name of my minor Daughter aged 2 Yrs from **HALEEMAH** to **HALEEMAH MUZAMMIL** permanently.
0071056171-1

I, Venus Gupta D/o Mamta Sharma R/o House No.6 BLK-F Parshant Vihar Rohini Delhi 110085, have changed my name to **Venus Kashyap**.
0040873916-4

I, ANCHAL SEHGAL GANDHI, W/o Harpreet Singh, R/o-Unit No.-1207, Tower-10, Shapoorji Pallonji Joyville, Sector-102, Dhanwarpur, Daultabad, Gurgaon (Haryana)-122006, have changed my name to **ANCHAL SEHGAL**.
0040873962-8

I, MANJIT SINGH, S/o Bholu Singh, R/o-C-4/16 Sector-5, Rohini Delhi-110065, have changed my name to **MANJEET SINGH**, and also, my correct Date of birth is 22.04.1969.
0040873955-6

I, SANDEEP SHARMA s/o Sh. P.L. Sharma residing at B-160, Phase-1, Ashok Vihar, Delhi - 110052 have changed my name to **SANDEEP SHARMA**.
0130068385-1

I, Santosh Sah S/o Dhanesh Sah residing at Ward No-4, Gram-Chainpur, Kaimur (Bhabua) Bihar-821103, have changed the name of my minor daughter Ritu Kumari aged 16 years and she shall hereafter be known as Rashi Ahirani.
0071056251-1

I, RAJNISH KUMAR GUPTA S/o Mahendra Pal Gupta R/o WZ-416, IInd-Floor, Basai Darapur New Delhi-110015, have changed my name to **RAJNISH GUPTA**, for all purposes
0040873962-1

I, Dhanesh Kumar Garg, S/o Rajender Kumar Garg residing at TM-30, Vishwakarma Marg, Gali No.21A, Baljeet Nagar, Patel Nagar, Central Delhi, Delhi-110008, have changed my name to **Dinesh Kumar Garg**, Henceforth, I shall be known as Dinesh Kumar Garg for all purposes. Dhanesh Kumar Garg and Dinesh Kumar Garg are one and the same person.
0071056140-1

I Mukesh Singh Chouhan S/o-C.S. Chouhan R/o-House No-44F, Gali No-6B, K-Block, Mahipalpur Extn., Malik Pur Kothi Alias Rang Puri, Delhi-110037 have changed my name to **Mukesh Singh Chauhan** for all purposes.
0040873899-1

I, PUSHAJ RAJ TANWAR, S/o Hans Raj, R/o-E-40/3, Gali No-5, Rama Vihar Mohammed Pur Majri Karala Delhi-110081 have changed my name to **PUSHARAJ TANWAR**.
0040873955-8

I, FARAH KHAN RIZVI, W/O-AZIM HASAN RIZVI, R/O-A9-004, GRD-FLOOR, TOWER-A-CASA, GREEN-1 SECTOR-16, GREATER-NOIDA WEST, GAUTAM BUDDHA NAGAR, UTTAR PRADESH-201306, HAVE CHANGED, MY NAME FROM **FARAH KHAN RIZVI TO, FARAH KHAN**
0040873962-3

I Seema Jain w/o Sudesh Kumar Jain r/o A-24, Shahabad Mohammadpur, Delhi-110061 have changed my name to **SEEMARANI JAIN**.
0040873936-1

I, SURESH KUMAR alias SURESH KUMAR DHAWAN, S/o Shyam Lal Dhawan, R/o 5681, Block-B, Sant Nagar, Burari, Delhi-110084, have changed, my name to **SURESH KUMAR DHAWAN**, for all future purposes.
0040873955-1

I, P, Parkash Gandhi, S/O. Suraj Prakash Gandhi, R/O.21/16, Ashok Nagar, Tilak Nagar, New Delhi-110018 have changed my name to **Prakash Gandhi** for all Purposes.
0040873962-7

I, Abodh Sahni S/o Raghuvir Sahni R/o Village Madhupur, Post-Madhupur, Dist-Darbhanga, P-S Kamtaul, PO-Madhupur, Distt-Darbhanga, Bihar -847306, have changed my name to **Avadh Kumar**
0071056215-1

I, Vimlesh W/o Khushi Ram R/O-37 A Gali no-2 Kundan Nagar, Laxmi Nagar, Delhi-110092, have Changed My Name From **Vimlesh Varun To Vimlesh** for All Future Purposes
0040873860-2

I FARHA SHAFIQ, W/O-SHARAFAT HUSSAIN, R/O-D-808, THIRRD FLOOR, NEW FRIENDS COLONY, SOUTH EAST DELHI-110025, I have changed my name to **FARHA HUSSAIN**.
0040873975-1

I, Jyoti Agrawal W/o Rajesh Agrawal R/O D-4, Rashmi Apartments, Harsh Vihar, Pitampura , Delhi, have changed my name to **Jyoti Agarwal** permanently.
0040873893-2

I, Amit Subhashchandra Dixit, S/o Subhash Chandra Dixit, R/o H.No.-62 Birch Court, Nirvana Country, Sector-50, Gurgaon (Haryana)-122018, Have changed my name to **Amit Dixit**.
0040873962-10

I, Sarmad Raza S/O: Md Hsainin, Village-Drijbigaha, Post-Nagwan Pathra, Thana Imamganj, Distt.-Gaya, Bihar, pin-824210, have changed my name to **Sarmadar Raza** for future Purposes.
0071056142-1

I, Sarmad Raza S/O: Md Hsainin, Village-Drijbigaha, Post-Nagwan Pathra, Thana Imamganj, Distt.-Gaya, Bihar, pin-824210, have changed my name to **Sarmadar Raza** for future Purposes.
0071056142-1

I, Ashok Kumar S/o Sankatha Prasad Singh R/o H.No J-144, Sector-beta-2, Greater Noida U.P have changed my name to Ashok Kumar Singh for all future purposes.
0071056164-1

I, Kavya Duddy, son of Manjeet Singh, resident of B-604, Plot No. 6B, Harmony Apartment, Sector-23, Dwarka, Delhi - 110077, India, hereby declare that on my earlier documents my photograph, signature and address appeared in the name of Kavya, son of Manjeet Singh, whereas in my Aadhaar, bank records and other documents I am now Kavya Duddy, son of Manjeet Singh. Kavya and Kavya Duddy are one and the same person, i.e. myself.
0040873934-1

I, NAZIYA, D/O MUSTAK AHMAD, R/O E-49- L 260, MAZDOOR JANTA COLONY SEELAM PUR DELHI 53 HAVE CORRECT MY LATE FATHER NAME TO MUSTAK AHMED
0040873955-5

I Have Changed My Son Name From Alman Sultan To Mohammad Alman Sultan For All Future Purpose. Mohammad Saleem Sultan S/O Abdul Rasheed Saifai R/O Plot-29 Ananta Sultan marriage home Khanna Nagar Gate-2 Loni dehat Ghaziabad.
0071056143-1

I Sudesh s/o Lalta Prasad Jain r/o A-24, Shahabad Mohammadpur, Delhi-110061 have changed my name to **SUDESH KUMAR JAIN**.
0040873936-2

I, Shammi Kumar Sawhney, S/o Chanan Shah Sawhney, R/o P4/30, Second Floor, DLF Phase-2, Sikanderpur Ghosi, Gurgaon, Haryana, have changed my name to **Shammi Sawhney**, for all purposes.
0040873955-2

I, GULAM VARIS S/o Mohammed Yunus Ansari, J-459, JJ Camp, Tigr, Delhi-62 have changed my name to **GULAM WARIS**.
0071056176-1

I, PRIYA W/O DEEPAK GUPTA R/O HNO.626/23 BHAGAT SINGH LANE BAHADURGARH JHAJJAR HARYANA-124507, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO **PRIYA GUPTA**.
0040873962-4

I ABREEQU HUSSAIN, S/O-SHARAFAT HUSSAIN, R/O-D-808, THIRD FLOOR, NEW FRIENDS COLONY, SOUTH EAST DELHI-110025, I have changed my name to **ABREEQ HUSSAIN**.
0040873975-2

I, hitherto known as Sudhanshu Ranjan S/o Santosh Kumar Singh residing at Vill-Baghini, Post Harhathpur, Mohania, Kaimpur (Bhabua) Mahania, Bihar-821109, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as **Ayush Kumar Singh**.
0071056205-1

I, Manjeet Kaur W/o Rajinder Singh R/o B-223, Saraswati Vihar , Pitampura , Delhi , have changed my name to **Manjit Kaur** permanently.
0040873893-3

I, Chander Vishvkarma S/o-Ran Bahadur Vishvkarma R/O-A2-978, J3 Colony Madanpur Khadar, New Delhi-76, have changed my name to **CHANDER BAHADUR** for all purposes.
0040873954-1

I, Mandabi Chaudhuri, W/o Subhamjit Deb, R/o Tower-4, Flat-1407, AIMS Golf Avenue-11, Sector-75, Noida, Gautam Budh Nagar, Uttar Pradesh, hereby inform that my previous names were **Mandabi Chaudhuri/ Mandabi Chowdhury**. I have now changed my name to **Mandabi Chaudhuri** and shall be known by this name for all future purposes.
0071056155-1

I, Ramesh Chander, S/o Babu Lal Chouhan, R/O-H.No.C-1/860, Ground Floor Kharsa No. 1886, Aya Nagar, Delhi, 110047, have changed my name to **Ramesh Chand Chouhan**, for all purposes.
0040873955-4

I, Rajkumari Bedarani Devi, W/o Late Kshetrinmayam Keshore Kumar, R/o Laishram Leikai, Khurai, Lamlong, Porompat, Imphal, M. nipur, PIN-795010, have changed my name to **Kshetrinmayum Bedarani** for all purposes.
0040873962-6

I BHUPENDER SINGH, S/O VIJAY PAL SINGH, R/O-A-3-F-1, NEAR SHIV MANDIR, WEST JYOTI NAGAR, MANDOLI, NORTH EAST DELHI-110093, I have changed my name to **BHUPENDER KUMAR**.
0040873975-4

I Rishikesh Kumar Choubey S/o Ganesh Choubhe R/o Kauwadih, Samhota, PO: Pipra, DIST: Rohtas, Bihar-821107, have changed my name to **Ranjan Kumar Choubey**
0071056210-1

I, Babita Sharma W/O Om Shiv Sharma R/O LIG FLAT NO-3A, POCKET-D-6, SECTOR-6 ROHINI, ROHINI, PO: ROHINI SECTOR-7, DIST: NORTH WEST DELHI, DELHI 110085, have changed my name to **Km Babita Sharma**.
0040873957-2

I, Mohammad Sufyan, S/o-Babu R/o-80 Basti Khawaja Mirdad Road Delhi, has changed my name to **Mohd Sufyan**, for all purpose
0040873962-2

I, Pramila Devi W/o Janardan Pandey R/o 00, Kaenpura, Banault, Rohtas, Chenari, Bihar-821104, have changed my name to **Urmila Devi**
0071056222-1

I, Surandra Prasad Gupta S/o Shivdhari Prasad Gupta residing at Ward 06, NayaGaon, Naya Gaon, Sheohar, Bihar - 843329, have changed the name of my minor son Subhanand Kumar Aged 17 Years and he shall hereafter be known as **Shubhanandan**.
0071056209-1

I, Mousam Rani D/O Roshan Lal R/O H.No.4661/4 Gali no. 112 Block-B Sant Nagar Burari Delhi - 110084 Have Changed My Name **Mosam To Mousam Rani**. Both are one the same.
0040873957-1

I, JAI PRAKASH TIWARI, S/o. Late Suresh Tripathi, R/o C-177, Mange Ram-Park Phase-1, Budh-Vihar, Delhi-110086, inform that, my father name **Suresh Tripathi, Suresh Tiwari, and Suresh Tiwari Narayan**, all names are same person
0040873955-9

I, RAKESH KUMAR MATHUR, R/O A 87, Sehkhari Nagar, kavi nagar ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201002 I have change my name to **RAKESH KUMAR**.
0040873975-5

I, NAVEEN PAL, S/o Brij Mohan Pal, R/o-314 Desu Road Shalimar, Village Delhi-110088 have Lost my 12th claes Original Certificate, UP Board Year 2021, Roll-No. 215364410 finder, Contact-7065606896 0040873962-11

MATRIMONIAL

DOCTORS
95 Born Chandigarh Brahmin girl 5.4" MBBS Doctor in Army as Captain. Doctor Army Officer, Civil Services Preferred. Contact/7009176579
0020518584-1

EDUCATION
LAW MASTERS [CLAT UG Preparation Classes] Admissions Open!#9953193193
0050295867-1

PUBLIC NOTICE
This is for the information of general public that my client, Hajinder Kaur W/o Sh. Gurjit Singh R/o House No. 20, Second Floor, Ashoka Park Extn., Punjabi Bagh, Delhi-110026, has disown and debarred her son Hardeep Singh and his daughter In-law Gurpreet Kaur from all her moveable and immovable properties, and also severed all her relation and connection with them because they are out of control of my client. Anybody dealing with them shall do so at his/her own risk and responsibility.
M. K. JHA (ADVOCATE)
G. F. Sr.-II, Authority Building
Dist. Court, Janki Pur, New Delhi-110058

PUBLIC NOTICE
Notice is hereby given that Sh. Rakesh Verma and Sh. Sandeep Verma alias Randi Verma, residents of 1885/96, Uday Chand Marg, Kola Mubarak Pur, New Delhi-110003, along with their relatives, have disowned and debarred their son, situated at Gurdwara Road, Uday Chand Marg, Kola Mubarak Pur, New Delhi-110003, along with their relatives, structures and immovable rights. Any person having any right, interest, claim or objection in respect of the said property or the above transaction may submit the same, along with supporting documents, to the undersigned within 15 days from the date of publication. Failing this, no claim shall be entertained hereafter.
GAURAV GOGIA, Advocate
Ch. No. 269, Lawyer's Chamber Block-I, Delhi High Court, New Delhi - 110 003

PUBLIC NOTICE
My clients Sh. Des Raj S/o Late Nandu Ram and Smt. Jasma Devi W/o Sh. Des Raj both R/o 14/5, Gali No-12, B-Block, Babu Colony, Burari, Delhi-110084 and also having residential Flat-A-43, Ground Floor, Asha Homes, Krishna Enclave, Sadhe Majra, Tehsil Derabassi, District SAS Nagar, Mohali, Punjab have severed all relations and debarred their son named Tushar Kaur and his wife Smt. Urmila Devi @ Neetu and their children namely Upreksha (Daughter) and Tanish (Son) from all their moveable and immovable properties due to their hostile misbehaviour and misconduct as well as implication in false cases. My clients shall not be responsible for any acts or deeds in any criminal and civil activity of them in future at any cost. My clients have socially boycotted them.
Sd/-
AMIT TALWAR (Advocate)
Enrl. No. D/S62006
OFF-B-1/3, Brij Vihar, Behind D.C.P. Office Outer Distt., Pitampura, Delhi-110034

PUBLIC NOTICE
Under instructions from my clients Sh. Rishikesh Kumar Gautam son of Sh. Shri Late Shri Kishan Lal and Smt. Lajwanti Gautam wife of Shri Rohtas Kumar Gautam both resident of 223-D, Pocket B, Mayur Vihar, Phase 2, Delhi-110091, I hereby inform the general public that my said clients have disowned their son Milind Gautam and his wife Smt. Amrita Chaudhary both residents of 223-D, Pocket B, Mayur Vihar, Phase 2, Delhi-110091, and have severed all their relations and connections with them with immediate effect. My said clients have divested them of all their moveable and immovable properties. Any one dealing with them shall be responsible for his or her dealings with them and that my clients will not be held liable in regard to such actions/dealings".
Sd/-
NAVEEN ARYA
Advocate
Ch. No.-83, Patliba House, New Delhi-110001

PUBLIC NOTICE
Notice is hereby given on behalf of My client Sh. Naveen Chander S/o Sh. Hari Ram, R/o H. No. 327, Type-3, Lodhi Road, Block-18, Lodhi Road, New Delhi-110033 that my client has disowned and severed all relationship with his son namely Deep Chand Bhathnagar and his wife Manisha due to their continuous misconduct, disrespectful behavior, abusive language and repeated use of filthy and derogatory words towards my client, causing him mental harassment, humiliation and distress. My client hereby declares that he shall have no responsibility or concern whatsoever with regard to any act, deed, transaction, liability, borrowing, commitment or dealing of any nature whatsoever undertaken by his son and daughter in law.
My client further declares that his said son and daughter in law shall have no authority whatsoever to represent themselves as his authorized representative or to enter into any transaction or commitment on his behalf. My client has further decided, subject to his lawful right and applicable law, to disinherit his son and daughter in law from his self acquired moveable and immovable property and assets. Any person dealing with them in respect of any transaction or liability shall do so at his own risk and responsibility.
Sd/-
ANIL KUMAR
Advocate
Ch. No. 402, Block-11/rd, Delhi High Court New Delhi 110003

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In Surat weaving hub, higher production cost forces owners to shut units for 2 days a week

Express News Service
Surat, August 22

THE DISRUPTION to the supply of crude oil following the Iran-US-Israel conflict has had on the impact on Surat's textile weaving industry.

**NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY**

Open Tender Notice No. SrDEE-TRD-BSB-2026-27-T24 Date- 19.08.26
Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/TRD, North Eastern Railway, Varanasi for and on behalf of President of India, invites sealed "OPEN" E - Tender for the following work.

S.N.1:- Name of work: 25 KV Electrification work in connection with Provision of Bangra Halt (H-3 Category) in between Raja Patti- Masarakhi Station, BSB division of N. E. Railway. Tender reference no: SrDEE-TRD-BSB-2026-27- T24. Approx. Cost (in Rs.): ₹ 8097096.63. Earnest money (in Rs.): ₹ 162000/- Cost of tender documents (in Rs.): Nil. E-Tender closing date and Time: 10.09.2026 up to 14:45 Hrs, Completion period: 9 Months, E-Tender Online will be submitted up to 14:45 Hrs on date 10.09.2026. For full details and submission of bid kindly visit the Official website of Indian railway i.e. www.irops.gov.in Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/TRD CPRO/Elect-158 Varanasi

Never travel on roof and foot boards.

**"IMPORTANT"**

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**GOVERNMENT OF NATIONAL CAPITAL TERRITORY OF DELHI**
OFFICE OF THE DIRECTORATE OF GURDWARA ELECTIONS
2ND FLOOR, F- BLOCK, VIKAS BHAWAN, I.P. ESTATE, NEW DELHI-110002
Phone No. 23370225 Email ID: dge.2011@gmail.com

FORM 3
(See Rule 10)

NOTICE OF PUBLICATION OF ELECTORAL ROLLS IN DRAFT

To
The Electors of Ward No. 1 to 46

Notice is hereby given that the Electoral Rolls have been prepared in accordance with the Delhi Sikh Gurdwara Management Committee (Registration of Electors) Rules, 1973 and a copy thereof is available for inspection, at ERO/AERO offices of respective wards, during office hours w.e.f. 24.08.2026.

If there be any claim for the inclusion of name in the Electoral Rolls or any objection to the inclusion of a name or any objection to particular in any entry, it should be lodged on or before 14.09.2026 in forms 4, 5 and 6 as may be appropriate.

Every such claim and objection should either be presented in our ERO/AERO offices or sent by post to the address of the ERO/AERO offices of respective wards so as to reach us not later than the aforesaid date i.e. 14.09.2026.

Sd/-
ELECTORAL REGISTRATION OFFICERS
WARD 1 TO 46
DIP/Shabdarth/Classified/0188/26-27 **DIRECTORATE OF GURDWARA ELECTIONS**

**BRIDCUL (ब्रिडकुल)**
ब्रिज, रोपवे, टनल एण्ड अदर इन्फ्रास्ट्रक्चर डेवलपमेंट कॉन्सोर्शियम ऑफ उत्तराखण्ड लिमिटेड
(सहकारिता संस्था का उद्देश्य)
मुख्य में उत्तराखण्ड राज्य अन्तर्गत विकास निगम लिमिटेड
प्रधान कार्यालय : अवस्थापना भवन, 583-07, राजकीय आईटीआईआई नरिन्गपुर के सामने, माजरा, सहारनपुर रोड, देहरादून-248001

Ref. : 1343/ BRIDCUL - 1085 (1)/ 26 **E-Tendering** Dated : 22/08/2026

On behalf of Hon'ble, Governor of Uttarakhand, E-Tenders are invited by Managing Director BRIDCUL, Sr.no. 1 from the Contractors registered with BRIDCUL only in Category-II (Rs 02 to 05 Cr.) and for work at Sr. no. 2 & 3 from the Contractors registered with BRIDCUL only in Category-III (Upto 2 Cr.) for the works given as below:-

S. No.	Ref. No.	Name of Project	Estimated Cost (In Lac Including GST)	Earnest Money (In Lac)	Cost of Tender Document (In Rs.)	Time Period
1	BRIDCUL/HQ SGR/27/2026-27	Electrical & Allied work for Multiskill Centre & MP Hall at Govt. Degree College Koldwar (Pauri Garhwal)	241.13	4.82	5000 + 18% GST	18 Month
2	BRIDCUL/HQ SGR/28/2026-27	Electrical & Allied work for Multiskill Centre & MP Hall at Govt. Degree College Koldwar Bhabar (Pauri Garhwal)	146.78	2.94	5000 + 18% GST	15 Month
3	BRIDCUL/HQ SGR/29/2026-27	Electrical & Allied work Exam Hall & Multiskill Development Centre at Govt. Degree College Chinyalisaur (Uttarkashi)	60.57	1.21	5000 + 18% GST	15 Month

For above tenders, document download start date is 25.08.2026 and Bid submission end date is 08.09.2026 at 1500 Hrs. The details of e-tender of above works can be obtained directly from website <https://uktenders.gov.in>.
Changes, if any will be intimated only through website <https://uktenders.gov.in>.

DGM (HQ)

**कार्यालय कार्यपालन यंत्री, नगर पालिक निगम उज्जैन**
पाँचवा निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

नगर पालिक निगम उज्जैन द्वारा निम्नलिखित कार्यो हेतु ऑन लाईन निविदाओं का आमंत्रण केन्द्रीकृत प्रणाली में पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से निम्नानुसार नगरीय प्रशासन एवं विकास विभाग द्वारा जारी एस.ओ.आर. दिनांक 02.08.2021 से लेमसम आधार पर किया जाता है।

नि.स.क्र.	कार्य का विवरण	कार्य की अनु. लागत	प्रतिभूति राशि	ऑन लाईन निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य	समयावधि	निविदा क्रय एवं द्र प्रस्तुत करने की अंतिम तिथि
2026_UAD_487998_5	Execution of Balance work construction laying jointing commissioning of Sewerage Network, Manhole, IC, House Service Connection with Road Restoration of Sewer Zone - 3 under AMRUT - 1.0	74456237/-	372281/-	20000/-	270 दिवस	03-09-2026
2026_UAD_488004_5	Execution of Balance work of Sewerage Network, Manhole, IC, House Service Connection with Road Restoration of Sewer Zone 5 Part - I under AMRUT - 1.0	95065111/-	475325/-	20000/-	270 दिवस	03-09-2026
2026_UAD_488006_5	Execution of Balance work of Sewerage Network, Manhole, IC, House Service Connection with Road Restoration of Sewer Zone 5 Part - II under AMRUT - 1.0	84415414/-	422077/-	20000/-	270 दिवस	03-09-2026
2026_UAD_488135_5	Execution of Balance work of Sewerage Network, Manhole, IC, House Service Connection with Road Restoration of Sewer Zone 5 Part - III under AMRUT - 1.0	89637044/-	448185/-	20000/-	270 दिवस	03-09-2026
2026_UAD_488166_5	Execution of Balance work of Sewerage Network, Manhole, IC, House Service Connection with Road Restoration of Sewer Zone 5 Part - IV under AMRUT - 1.0	86687763/-	433438/-	20000/-	270 दिवस	03-09-2026

निविदा संबंधित अन्य विवरण एवं विस्तृत निविदा सूचना की जानकारी वेब साईट <https://mptenders.gov.in> पर ऑन लाईन दर्शाई गई है।

कार्यपालन यंत्री- अमृत
लो.स्वा.यां. संधा.खण्ड न.पा.नि. उज्जैन

आयुक्त
नगर पालिक निगम उज्जैन

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

No.: JHS/Commercial/e-Auction/26/78 Date: 20.08.2026

E-Auction Notice

On Behalf of the President of India, The Divisional Railway Manager (Commercial) Jhansi invites e-auction as per categories given as under :-

Category: Advertisement **Catalogue No.:** JHS-NFR-ADV-78

Asset Details

E-AUCTION FOR CONTRACT UNDER

1. Advertisement right through RDN NON-DIGITAL media (flex board/ glowsign board/ translight led flange static advertisement)) inside ORAI railway station.

2. Display of commercial publicity at circulating area of CHITRAKUTDHAM KARWI Railway Station under OOH policy.

3. E-AUCTION FOR ADVERTISEMENT RIGHT THROUGH RDN NON DIGITAL MEDIA ON FENCING WALL PAINTING AT VGLJ, BNDA & MCSC RAILWAY STATION

Auction Start : 03.09.2026 at 11:00 hrs Auction End : 03.09.2026 at 11:50 hrs

Note:- Prospective bidders are requested to visit e-Auction Leasing module on IREPS website (www.irops.gov.in). The Lot-wise details are available therein under the above mentioned Catalogue Number. 1932/26(AK)

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

**NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF TECHNICAL TEACHERS TRAINING AND RESEARCH**
(Deemed to be University under Distinct Category)
(Ministry of Education, Govt. of India)
SECTOR-26, CHANDIGARH-160 019

Advertisement No. 268/2026

Admission to Ph.D. Programmes Session December 2026

NITTR Chandigarh invites online applications for admission to Ph.D. (Regular and Modular modes) Programmes for the Session December 2026 in the following departments.

Applied Science (Physics)	Curriculum Development
Civil Engineering	Information Management and Emerging Engineering
Computer Science and Engineering	Mechanical Engineering

Important Dates:

1. Entrance Test application deadline : 13/09/2026

2. Entrance Test on : 20/09/2026

3. Ph.D. Programme admission application deadline : 11/10/2026

Note:

- Those having currently valid score in NITTR entrance test OR any national level tests such as GATE/NET etc. need not apply for the Entrance test schedule on 20.09.2026..
- Any addendum/corrigendum to this advertisement and/or subsequent advertisement related to Ph.D. admission shall be posted only on the NITTR, Chandigarh website.
- For detailed information, kindly visit the institute website: <https://www.nittrchd.ac.in/core/php.php>

DEAN (ACADEMICS & STUDENTS)

**ई-निविदा सूचना**

विद्युत वितरण मण्डल रानीखेत निम्न ई-निविदा आमंत्रित करता है :-

क्र.सं.	ई-निविदा संख्या	कार्य का नाम	ई-निविदा कब/जमा करने की अनिवार्य अंतिम तिथि एवं समय	ई-निविदा (भाग-1) खुलने की ऑफलाइन/ऑन लाइन तिथि एवं समय
1	वि०वि०म० (रा०) 59/2026-27	वि०वि०म०, बागेश्वर के अधीन उपखण्ड-द्वितीय के अन्तर्गत काण्डा एवं धोलासेरा पोषकों में 11 केवी० फॉल्ट फेसज इन्स्लेटर की आपूर्ति एवं स्थापित करने सम्बन्धी कार्य।	14.09.2026 15:00 बजे तक	15.09.2026 12:00 बजे
2	वि०वि०म० (रा०) 60/2026-27	वि०वि०म० बागेश्वर के अन्तर्गत हंगोली अनुभाग के विभिन्न ग्रामों में पूर्व में स्थापित पुरानी / क्षतिग्रस्त ए०बी०सी० कैबिल बदलने का कार्य मय विकेन्द्रीकृत सामग्री को पूर्ण।	14.09.2026 15:00 बजे तक	15.09.2026 12:30 बजे

उक्त ई-निविदाओं की अन्य नियम व एवं शर्तें वेबसाईट www.uktenders.gov.in पर देखी जा सकती है। उक्त ई-निविदाओं का शुद्ध पत्र/वित्तीयकरण / निस्तीकरण आदि की सूचना वेबसाईट www.uktenders.gov.in में ही प्रकाशित / उपलब्ध होगी।

ग्राह्य हित में बिजली बचाये "
Customer Toll Free No-1800 419 0405

पत्रांक 5277/वि०वि०म०(रा०)/ई-निविदा दिनांक 22.08.2026 अधीक्षण अभियन्ता

**SANTUSHTI SHOPPING COMPLEX**
AIR FORCE STATION NEW DELHI
ALLOTMENT OF SHOPS ON RENT

1. The following shops are offered for allotment on rent at Santushti Shopping Complex, Tejas Camp, Lok Kalyan Marg, New Delhi-110003.

Sl No	Shop No	Size (sqft)	Trade Allocated	Tentative Date of Allotment
01	07	263	Leather Boutique	01 Nov 26
02	26	443	Artefacts/Gift Items/Cosmetics	01 Nov 26
03	35	395	Handicrafts/Designer Boutique/Home Decor	01 Nov 26
04	10	1737	Multi Cuisine Restaurant	01 Nov 26
05	14	425	Cigar Shoppe/Artefacts/Gift Items	01 Nov 26
06	15	425	Jewellery Shop	01 Nov 26
07	19	756	Ethnic & Khadi Handicrafts	01 Jan 27
08	40	293	Unisex Bridal Ethnic wear/Designer Boutique	01 Dec 26
09	01	150	Jewellery Shop	01 Jan 27
10	09	526	Designer Boutique	01 Jan 27
11	12	380	Cosmetics	01 Jan 27
12	17	195	Artefacts/Gift Items	01 Jan 27
13	33	437	Handicrafts/Designer Boutique	01 Jan 27
14	37	190	Handicrafts/Designer Boutique	01 Jan 27
15	16	239	Ethnic Boutique	01 Mar 27
16	18	413	Ethnic Curious/Antiques/Souvenir/Gift Items	01 Mar 27
17	23	379	Cigar Shoppe	01 Mar 27
18	34	419	Handicrafts/Designer Boutique/Home Decor	01 Mar 27

2. **Applicable Rent :** License Fees @ ₹ 160/- per sqft plus Maintenance Charges @ ₹ 60/- per sqft & GST as applicable per month.

3. **Sale of application forms** : 24 Aug 26 onwards (1100 hrs -1600 hrs) (Monday to Friday) excluding closed holidays

4. **Last date for submission of application forms** : 09 Sep 26 (1600 hrs)

5. Applicants are advised to go through the "information for applicants" in the application form. For further details please contact SSC office on 011-20867237 (10 AM to 4 PM) or email on santushishoppingcomplex123@gmail.com.

**UNION TERRITORY OF JAMMU & KASHMIR**
OFFICE THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PWD
R and B DIVISION BAKSHI NAGAR JAMMU

Short e-NIT No.55 of 2026-2027 Dated:-20-08-2026

For and on behalf of the Lieutenant Governor, Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir e-tenders are invited on percentage basis from approved and eligible Contractors registered with Union Territory of J&K, CPWD, Railways, MES and other State/Central Governments for each of the following works :-

S. No	Name of Work	Name of Division	Advertised cost (Rs. In lakh.)	Cost of Tender document (in Rs.)	Earnest Money (in Rs.)	Time Allowed for completion	Time and date of opening of tender	Class of Contractor
1.	Proposed Toilet complex for Male and Female at Convention Centre premises in Directorate of Hospitality and Protocol Right of side	PWD (R&B) DIVISION BAKSHI NAGAR Jammu	34.19	600	2% of Advertised Cost	60 Days	29-08-2026 (12.00 Pm)	"A&B"
2.	Levelling of School Ground Establishment of Drainage System and Construction of Footpath from Main Gate to New Building Construction of attached Toilet 6 rooms at HSS Nowabad Jammu.	PWD (R&B) DIVISION BAKSHI NAGAR Jammu	58.42	1500	2% of Advertised Cost	60 Days	29-08-2026 (12.00 Pm)	"A"

Position of AAA / TS : Accorded

The Bidding documents Consisting of qualifying information, eligibility criteria, specifications, Drawings, bill of quantities (B.O.Q), Set of terms and conditions of contract and other details can be seen / downloaded from the departmental website <http://jktenders.gov.in> as per below schedule:-

1	Date of Issue of Tender Notice	21-08-2026
2	Period of downloading of bidding documents	From 21-08-2026 to 27-08-2026 upto 1800 Hrs
3	Date, Time and place of pre-bid meeting	-
4	Bid submission Start Date	21-08-2026
5	Bid Submission End Date	27-08-2026 upto 1800 Hrs
6	Date & time of opening of Technical Bids (Online)	29-08-2026 on or after 1200 Hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Bakshi Nagar Jammu
7	Date & time of opening of Financial Bids (Online)	To be notified after technical bid evaluation is completed

Sd/-
(Er. Karanjeet Singh)
Executive Engineer
PWD (R&B) Division
Gandhi Nagar

No: - EE/R&B/BN/5525-34
Dated:- 20-08-2026
DIP/J-8621/26 – DATE 22 AUG 2026

**MUMBAI RAILWAY VIKAS CORPORATION LTD.**

INVITATION FOR TENDER: MRVC-W-404R

(Single Stage single Envelope e-Procurement Tender Process)

Mumbai Railway Vikas Corporation Ltd. (MRVC) having its corporate office at Second Floor, Churchgate Station Building, Mumbai-400020, invites e-Tenders for "Modification of 2 nos. of TSS at VGI & KJT and 1 no. SP at BVS and 1 no. SSP at SHELU & associated work for 3rd & 4th line between Badlapur-Karjat Section of Central Railway at Mumbai under MUTP-IIIB." Details of Tender and Tender documents are available on e-procurement website "https://eprocure.gov.in". The last date for completed e-Tender submission at website "https://eprocure.gov.in" is 23.09.2026 up to 15:00 hours. Corrigendum, if any, will be posted on the website only.

**DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL, DEHRADUN**
2nd Floor, Paras Tower, Mazra, Saharanpur Road, Dehradun, UK. 248171

R.C. No. 123 of 2026 Date: 21.08.2026

Bank of Maharashtra **Certificate Holder**

Versus

M/S Shaurya Enterprises & Anr **Certificate Debtors**

DEMAND NOTICE

To,

CD No. 1. M/s Shaurya Enterprises through its proprietor Gori Shanker registered office address: 101 Kartarpur Road, Teen Pani Dam, Rudrapur, Udham Singh Nagar, Uttarakhand-263153.

CD No. 2 Gori Shankar S/o Sh. Itvari Lal (Proprietor) M/s Shaurya Enterprises), R/o Dev Homes Bigwara, Rudrapur, Udham Singh Nagar, Uttarakhand-263153.

Second Address: 101 Kartarpur Road, Teen Pani Dam, Rudrapur, Udham Singh Nagar, Uttarakhand-263153.

In view of the Recovery Certificate issued in O.A. No. 226/2025 passed by the Presiding Officer, DRT, Dehradun an amount of Rs 24,63,271.44/- (Rupees Twenty Four Lakhs Sixty Three Thousand Two Hundred Seventy One And Paise Forty Four Only) along with pendente-lite and simple interest yearly @ 7.00% for the first year, 8.00% for the next year and 11.00% on balance after second year w.e.f. 28.03.2025 till realization and costs of Rs 78,873/- has become due against you (Jointly and Severally).

Whereas it has been shown to the undersigned that it is not possible to serve you demand notice in ordinary course, therefore, this notice is given by way of this publication directing you to pay the above sum within 15 days of the publication of this notice, failing which the recovery shall be made in accordance with the provisions of the Recovery of Debts and Bankruptcy Act, 1993 and Rules there under.

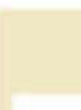
You are hereby ordered to appear before the undersigned on 05.11.2026 at 10:30 a.m. for further proceedings.

In additions to the sum aforesaid you will be liable to pay:

a. Such interest as is payable for the period commencing immediately after this notice of the execution proceedings.

b. All costs, charges and expenses incurred in respect of the service of this notice and other process that may be taken for recovering the amount due.

Recovery Officer,
Debts Recovery Tribunal, Dehradun

**SALUTE THE SOLDIER**

GORKHA RIFLES
RFN RAM BAHADUR THAPA

On this day 5045072 Rfn Ram Bahadur Thapa of 5/1 Gorkha Rifles made the supreme sacrifice during 'OP RAKSHAK', Jammu and Kashmir in Aug 1998 in a true act of valour and courage. The brave soldier will always be remembered for his enthusiasm. To this brave heart we pledge that we shall always be guided by his immortal spirit and make his name proud.

CO AND ALL RANKS, 5/1 GORKHA RIFLES

BORDER SECURITY FORCE

	CONSTABLE GOVIND SINGH 144 BN BSF 01.01.1964-23.08.2015	Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Govind Singh on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he made ultimate sacrifice while on operational duty in area of BOP Kalupota-I, Kolkata (West Bengal).
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CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE

	Veer Balidani Shri Rishipal Singh Deputy Commandant 124 Bn	Veer Balidani Constable/Driver Raj Kumar Gaur 124 Bn 15-8-1972 To 23-8-1999
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DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to two valiant troopers of 124 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while countering an ambush by insurgents in Assam on 23 August 1999. #CRPF salutes the bravehearts and pledges never to let their sacrifice go in vain.

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

No.: JHS/Commercial/e-Auction/26/76 Date: 20.08.2026

E-AUCTION NOTICE

On behalf of the President of India, The Divisional Railway Manager, (Commercial) Jhansi invites e-auction as per categories given as under:-

Category: Advertisement **Catalogue No.:** JHS-NFR-MISC-76

Asset Details: E-AUCTION FOR CONTRACT UNDER

1. Contract for Installation, Maintenance and operation of Electric Vehicle (EV) Charging stations at MORENA Railway station.

2. CONTRACT TO OPEN MILLETS STALL AT ORAI RAILWAY STATION.

3. Operate and maintain of battery-operated vehicles (BOV) with advertisement at BANDA & MAHOBA JN railway station.

4. Permission to install MOBILE STORE AND ACCESSORIES KIOSK CUM OTHERS UTILITY ITEMS at DATIA & POKHRAYAN railway station.

5. E-auction is invited for a POOJASAMAGRI KIOSK at DATIA Railway station.

6. E-Auction for to install and Operate of the Static General Outlet at MORENA, DATIA, DABRA & BANDA Railway Station.

Auction Start: 02.09.2026 at 11:00 hrs.

Auction End: 02.09.2026 at 12:30 hrs.

Note:- Prospective bidders are requested to visit e-Auction Leasing module on IREPS website (www.irops.gov.in). The Lot-wise details are available therein under the above mentioned Catalogue Number. 1928/26 (PH)

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

**UP POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LTD.,**
ELECTRICITY TRANSMISSION DESIGN CIRCLE
10th Floor, Shakti Bhawan Extn., Lucknow

E-Tender Notice

Invites Open Tender for

“Construction of LILO of 220kV Metro depot- Jalpura @ 220 kV S/s Ecotech 10 & 220 kV Ecotech10 - Avaada SC line with Zebra equivalent HTLS Conductor on MC/DC Monopoles and Narrow Base Multi circuit Lattice tower”

Tender Specification no-TD-551/26

Bid Portal (Download & Submission): <https://etender.up.nic.in>.

Bidding: Online, EMD: ₹ 77.87 Lacs

Estimated cost of work: ₹ 77.87 Cr.

Completion Period: 12 Months

KEYDATES:

Online Bid Submission Start: 22/08/2026

Online Bid Submission Closing: 14/09/2026 at 15:30 Hrs.

Bidders are advised to visit E-Portal regularly for amendments/Corrigendum's etc.

Superintending Engineer, Electricity Transmission Design Circle

सं०-1489/टीडी/551/26 22अगस्त 2026

E-Mail: seetdc@upptcl.org Tele: (0522) 2286759,2218645

**CSB Bank**
Trusted Mortgage Smart Future

PUBLIC NOTICE ON AUCTION OF PLEDGED GOLD ORNAMENTS

The borrower/s in specific and interested bidders in general, are hereby informed that on account of non-repayment of the Banks due by the borrowers as under despite the payment notice and recall/activation notice issued by the Bank, the gold ornaments pledged with the bank security by the respective borrowers for the loan advanced by them will be sold in public auction on "as is where is" and "non-resource" at branch premises on 22nd September 2026 at 10.30 AM. The auction may be adjourned to any other later date at the discretion of the bank upon publication of the same in the Bank's notice board. The borrowers are hereby further informed that the gold ornaments will be disposed of by Public auction/auction, if the auction is not successful and if there is a further balance to be recovered thereafter, legal action will be initiated against the borrowers for recovery of the balance amounts due to the bank. "In case of Deceased borrower, all conditions will be applicable to legal heirs."

S. No.	Auction Center CSB Branch	Account Name	Client ID	No. of Acc.	Bal. Outstanding as on 20-08-2026	Weight (grams)
1	Ashok Vihar-Delhi	Anil Yadav	05041777	001	38,750.85	6.30
2	Ashok Vihar-Delhi	Ashima Bhatia	05062106	002	8,17,663.34	98.51
3	Ashok Vihar-Delhi	Mohd Imran Shakuntalia	04889247	002	4,76,592.72	68.53
4	Ashok Vihar-Delhi	07991458	001	92,633.81	17.18	
5	Ashok Vihar-Delhi	Shila	04205940	001	1,79,646.59	36.99
6	Greater Kailash-II	Manoj Lodhi	10115111	001	37,352.14	44.00
7	Greater Kailash-II	Nirmita Patra	10020998	001	1,01,184.17	18.53
8	Gautam Nagar	Mohit Saini	10218317	001	1,31,047.36	13.80
9	Gautam Nagar	Poonam	04711500	001	76,732.48	15.10
10	Gautam Nagar	Priyanka Gupta	03436614	002	5,24,035.85	105.34
11	Gautam Nagar	Tarun Gautam	03184235	001	1,00,695.93	19.82
12	Karol Bagh	Sohan Lal	04918837	002	4,24,580.78	44.99
13	Karol Bagh	Vicky	10018934	001	3,22,619.63	53.42
14	Palam	Gautam	10041566	001	1,07,257.17	11.62
15	Palam	Mukesh Devi	10275150	003	5,84,394.26	59.85
16	Palam	Rahul	07992182	001	4,29,797.23	42.99
17	Palam	Rajput Dayashankar	04500924	001	14,34,614.72	157.96
18	Palam	Umashanker Shanker	04323315	001	89,886.72	11.73
19	Janakapuri	Nikita Sharma	07995351	001	6,66,112.81	118.27
20	Janakapuri	Parag Sharma	04985239	001	2,22,891.84	30.68
21	Janakapuri	Rajvir	10019200	001	2,56,940.86	37.54
22	Janakapuri	Sudha	10287591</			

About E20: Why choice, pricing matter



OFF THE RECORD
BY P VAIDYANATHAN IYER

THE ETHANOL-petrol debate refuses to abate on the streets, and just like the Cockroach Janta Party’s Jantar Mantar NEET protest, it is getting traction on Instagram, and other social media platforms. The government is finding it challenging to quell public disenchantment and turn opinion in favour of E20 (petrol blended with 20 per cent ethanol). There are reasons beyond politics why reasoned communication by the government is being disregarded by people, and there are possible solutions, which are being resisted by the government due to big implementation hurdles.

But some in the government have their ears to the ground, are filtering the noise, and picking the right signals. They are looking behind to see what could have been done to incentivise those who feel short-changed on mileage due to E20 rollout. And now, thinking ahead, if something is still possible to win them back. In India, Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F>

they understand mileage and price are two key aspects that influence decision-making in lower and middle-income families.

All along, the NDA government has defended the blending programme and rightfully so, while simultaneously emphasising that it did not begin under the present government. Indeed, the pilot was launched during AB Vajpayee’s government in 2001, and the E5 roll out across several states was attempted in 2006 under the UPA. But it gathered momentum after the present government assumed charge in 2014. Ethanol blending reached 10 per cent in 2021-22, and gradually rose to 19.2 per cent in 2024-25, and is now set at 20 per cent.

There is no doubt, ethanol blending has many advantages. It cuts fossil fuel use, produces lower carbon emissions, reduces dependence on imports, saves precious foreign exchange, and insulates the country from the vagaries of geopolitics that affect supplies. While this may be appreciated by those affected, they are not convinced how all this translates into benefits for them.

They don’t get it, because as a government officer explains, the consumer is not seeing a tangible price benefit despite bearing the cost of a lower mileage. And this is because the consumer does not have a choice. For example, when petrol pumps started dispensing E5, could they have offered it alongside petrol? Con-

Consumers are not seeing a tangible price benefit despite bearing the cost of a lower mileage. This is because they do not have a choice today.

sumers then have a choice. They could be incentivised to transition to E5 by being charged lower than petrol for this blended fuel. Similarly, for E10, and now E20. Differential pricing becomes an incentive; consumers would make peace with a 3-5 per cent lower mileage because of a lower-priced E20 compared with E10.

This can be best explained by what the government did following changes in the income tax regime, points out another officer. A new tax regime with lower taxes but no major exemptions was introduced in April 2020. It was voluntary. As the new tax regime evolved over the years, the Finance Ministry continued to offer tax payers the option to file returns under the old tax regime. The old regime offers exemptions, but tax rates are high. It has been six years, and the two systems continue alongside. But almost 90 per cent of all individuals have shifted to the new tax regime.

To be fair, the government has tried to explain the advantages of E20 by comparing India’s retail fuel prices with that of other countries in South Asia and Europe. The petrol price hike in India between June 2022 and June 2026 was in the lower single digits, at less than 6 per cent, whereas it was more than 15 per cent in European countries, and more than 20 per cent in South Asian countries.

Be that so, it is tough to make the Indian consumers believe the counterfactual. What did not happen, but could have Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1

happened, is a concept that does not stick easily. The fact that E20 was a reason why the government could keep petrol prices low despite the Indian crude oil basket averaging over \$100 a barrel is still lost on most consumers.

The transition from E10 to E20 happened in four years. Given the West Asia crisis, it is possible the government was worried about its impact on oil prices in the long term. It is possible prices could remain higher for longer. It has not played out that way, but uncertainty prevails in the region, and the motivation for transitioning to E20 could be many. When global crude oil is at \$70 a barrel or less, E20 is costlier to produce than pure petrol, according to government estimates. Ethanol becomes much cheaper at relatively high global crude oil prices of \$120-130 a barrel.

Clearly, for many reasons, moving away from fossil fuels is a long-term strategic imperative. Ethanol blended fuel is definitely an alternative, but requires behavioural changes among consumers. It is here that public policy gets interesting, and challenging. Offering consumers a choice of fuel and making them see a price advantage will make a difference. What can’t be done about mileage, can choice and differential pricing cover for that?

The writer is Managing Editor, The Indian Express. Off the Record is a fortnightly column

Unemployment is not about just education



PULAPRE BALAKRISHNAN

IN THE nationwide protests that followed the leakage of the NEET paper, students had demanded more than just a fair examination system. They had highlighted the poor quality of higher education and the challenge of youth unemployment. While the youth are right to perceive the education system as ripe for drastic reforms, it would be appropriate not to attribute all of current unemployment to poor education. Two strands of evidence suggest this. First, unemployment in countries with far superior educational systems is higher than in India today — Finland and Sweden being two examples. Within India, there is Kerala, which has a better-educated workforce but still has a high youth unemployment rate. Second, if educational qualifications and skills are scarce in India, the real wage of skilled workers must rise, but we see little of that happening currently. Even in India’s IT sector, apart from those with AI-related competency or working in the Global Capability Centres of multinationals, wage increases for the remaining employees are not particularly high. This is not to say that education and skills do not matter. They matter for productivity. Economy, though, is related to aggregate demand for goods. The demand for labour is a derived demand; it exists due to a demand for goods.

Everything points to a slowing of aggregate demand growth in India over the last decade. Seven out of the 11 sectors at the initial level of disaggregation of national income slowed, three grew at the same rate as before, and only one grew faster. The sector that grew faster was real estate, which is neither large nor one employing many. With such a comprehensive slowdown in the economy, a slackening in the demand for labour would have occurred. But why did the economy slow? Both short-term and long-term factors are responsible. There is by now sufficient evidence to show that the trigger was the demonetisation of 2016. Growth slowed annually over the next three years before output actually contracted in 2020-21 due to Covid. As expected, the economy rebounded after the lockdown, but that could not prevent a decline in the average growth rate.

There are two long-term factors. The first is the slowdown in capital formation — or investment — from 2009-10. The slowdown is in public investment. The pace of private investment has been constant, despite the Modi government being the most business-friendly one the country has ever seen. Among other overtures, it had cut the corporation tax rate significantly in 2019, particularly for new companies. Yet, private investment has not picked up. An explanation would take us to the second long-term factor, namely, the rising price of food. Having remained steady during a phase of India’s all-time high growth in the early 2000s, the real price of food, that is, price of food relative to that of all goods, began to rise. It has risen by 53 per cent since 2008-09. Globally, countries became richer, as food got cheaper. We know why.

While the impact on welfare — of food becoming more expensive — is immediately understood, its consequence for growth, and therefore for employment, is not. As the price of food rises, unless wages rise, households are poorer, and demand less of other goods. Industrial firms are now left with excess capacity, leading them to postpone investment. This explains the unchanged pace of private investment, even as firms pay lower taxes.

There is evidence that the real wage in India has stagnated for most rural workers for nearly a decade, and that real earnings have declined for regular workers and the self-employed. So, consumption expenditure, which represents demand, have been impacted. As firms observe the slow growth of the market for their goods, they have likely become pessimistic about their prospects for future growth. It explains the unchanged growth rate of private investment. Public investment can to an extent make up for the unchanging pace of private investment. But for this to work, the government must choose projects wisely. The Modi government shows a marked preference for big infra, highways and airports, but it is infrastructure more closely aligned to production, roads, electricity, sewerage and transportation, that may be expected to yield greater returns in terms of employment generated.

Only when the employment crisis India faces today is understood can the necessary corrective action be taken. While India owes its youth the best education, public policy must aim to keep India’s aggregate demand for goods high.

Balakrishnan is the author of India’s economy from Nehru to Modi: A brief history

Coomi Kapoor’s Inside Track column will be back in a fortnight

Historian, constant rebel whose work reshapes the future



HISTORY HEADLINE
BY DEEPAK TENGURIYA

IT WAS the late 1970s in Sussex, England. Two historians sat well past midnight, talking. They spoke of Indian peasants, their anger, their quiet rebellions.

One of them later wrote that he sat “practically spellbound”. Ranajit Guha, the founding figure of the ‘Subaltern Studies Collective’, did most of the talking that night. The man who was listening was Sumit Sarkar.

Sarkar, who helped shape an entire era of Indian history writing, died on August 13, 2026, aged 87.

In the cold evenings of England in the late 1970s, a new way of writing Indian history was beginning to take shape in Oxford and elsewhere — one that would come to be known as ‘Subaltern Studies’ in 1982, when the first volume of the series, *Subaltern Studies: Writings on South Asian History and Society*, edited by Ranajit Guha, was published. It was an approach to “history from below”. Most history books had been focused on the big leaders and political parties. But Guha argued that ordinary people, peasants, workers, and tribal communities had their own “autonomous domain” of politics, one that did not simply follow the lead of the nationalist elites. ‘Subaltern Studies’ tried to recover their voices and actions.

Sarkar became one of the key contributors to this collective, alongside historians Shahid Amin, Partha Chatterjee, Dipesh Chakrabarty, Gautam Bhadra, and David Hardiman. His first book, *The Swadeshi Movement in Bengal, 1903-1908*, published in 1973, had already moved the story of Bengal’s anti-colonial revolt away from famous leaders towards workers, peasants, and small artisans — an approach that fed directly into the group’s founding spirit.

It is one of history’s small ironies that the same man would years later become



{ SUMIT SARKAR }
1939-2026

one of the school’s sharpest and most respected critics. By the late 1980s, the project had increasingly turned away from class-based histories towards critiques of Western thought, secularism and Enlightenment values, drawing on Western thinkers such as Michel Foucault and Jacques Derrida. Distancing himself from the group, Sarkar, in his essay, *The Decline of the Subaltern in Subaltern Studies*, warned that some of these critiques came dangerously close to the arguments made by the Hindu Right.

Sumit Sarkar was born in 1939 into a Brahmo family in Calcutta, in a home where mornings began with Tagore and evenings ended in arguments about Marx. His father, Sushobhan Sarkar, was a celebrated Marxist historian at Presidency College. His uncle was PC Mahalanobis, the statistician after whom India’s premier statistical institute is named.

For Sarkar, becoming a historian was almost inherited — not chosen. Yet even within that inheritance, he rebelled, writing sharply about the Bengal Renaissance, sharp enough that a senior Communist Party of India (CPI) worker once

accused him of betraying his father’s legacy. Interestingly, without telling him, his father responded with a sharp rejoinder, defending him.

Decades later, generations of students learned modern Indian history from Sumit Sarkar’s book *Modern India, 1885-1947*, first published in 1983. The kind of book that ends up on a shelf with a torn spine and pencil marks on every page. Later he focused on the economy, environment and culture, and *Modern Times: India 1880s-1950s* was published in 2014.

Sarkar’s moral courage comes out in the later part of his life, as well. In 2004, West Bengal’s Left government granted him the Rabindra Puraskar literary award. But in 2007, after police fired on farmers in Nandigram, Sarkar returned his award and donated the prize money to a relief fund. He argued that while Jalianwala Bagh had happened under colonial rule, Nandigram was in some ways more shocking because the violence had occurred under a Left government in independent India.

In his later years, Sarkar grew fascinated with “microhistory”. He unearthed a forgotten newspaper account from Doyhata, a village in East Bengal, where a ‘lower-caste’ man had murdered another ‘lower-caste’ man before his ‘upper-caste’ guru, later going on to assault ‘upper-caste’ women that same night, in a brutal, isolated tragedy. Sarkar called the contradictions in the news story a kind of “unexpected reversal” that grand history often misses. When questioned by *Economic and Political Weekly* on this, he replied simply: “All historians are entitled to try and understand their Others.”

Sumit Sarkar leaves behind his wife Tanika Sarkar, and a legacy that lives not only in bookshelves, but also in the minds of students who first understood modern India through his pages. A historian’s death is a different kind of leaving. He does not leave behind just a body of work, but also a work unfinished, one that the next generation must walk into archive rooms to complete. Like evening light streaming through the window of an old house, his impact will linger on the walls long after the room has gone dark.

The writer is chief, research, The Indian Express, Hindi

Am I a Naxal?



FIFTH COLUMN
BY TAVLEEN SINGH

AM I a ‘*dimagi* Naxal’? Ever since the Prime Minister identified this new genre of traitor in his Red Fort speech, I have brooded over this question. In simple English, this new kind of traitor is an intellectual with leftist tendencies who takes inspiration from the teachings of Chairman Mao. So, as someone who is possibly the most economically right-wing, politically conservative columnist in our vast and wondrous land, why should I of all people worry? Well, because the definition of ‘*dimagi* Naxal’ is treacherously ambiguous and could encompass even those who despise Mao and totally oppose violent uprisings against the Indian State.

On this, my credentials are impeccable. I openly opposed the late Sant Jarnail Singh Bhindranwale at a time when you could be killed for doing so. And, never at any stage of my long career in journalism have I had the smallest sympathy for the Naxalites. Not even in the seventies when many young people of my acquaintance were not just in sympathy with this movement but had given up college to march with the comrades in the jungles. In those days it was fashionable to be extremely leftist and unfashionable to be mildly rightist, either politically or economically.

Memories come back as I write these words of conversations in dingy, smoke-filled ‘*barsatis*’ where over cheap rum and cheaper cigarettes we talked of how only a revolution could save India. I joined in these conversations and drank the rum but was never persuaded. When I became older and wiser and learned to analyse economic and political ideas, I became convinced that it was decades of ‘socialism’ that kept millions of Indians mired in poverty. It is simply not possible to distribute wealth without first creating it. In this column I have said more than once that I believe India would have been among the richest countries in the world if we had adopted the principles of free markets and liberal democracy.

Instead, we chose to emulate the Soviet Union, and this has meant that millions of Indians continue to live on government handouts and the dream of a government job. Those aged lefties who still believe Mao and Stalin are heroes pretend that they have not noticed that it was only after the leaders of Russia and China started following free market economic policies that their people began to enjoy a measure of prosperity.

With ideas that are so far from being leftist, why do I fear that I might end up in the ‘*dimagi* Naxal’ category? Well, because I oppose many of the policies that the Modi government has chosen to follow. I agree with the Cockroach Janta Party’s campaign to improve village schools. And I agree with Abhishek Dipke when he says that it is only when political leaders and high officials are forced to send their children to government schools that these schools will improve dramatically. When I see the ‘cockroaches’ fan out across villages to make reels of the horrific conditions in government schools, I see them as nationalists and patriots and not subversives. Could this put me in the ‘*dimagi* Naxal’ category?

Since the Prime Minister’s Independence Day speech, there has been an explosion of public support for him from his devotees and spokespersons on television. In oneshow, I heard these acolytes explain that Modi was talking about intellectuals who were really Naxal collaborators. But these worthies have not noticed the reels that the BJP’s propagandists are posting on social media in which they illustrate the definition of the new traitors with photos of Modi’s political opponents.

If you believe in liberal democracy, as I do, you necessarily believe that dissent is the oxygen that allows democracy to breathe and remain healthy. Sadly, this is not an idea that has been much cherished since Modi became prime minister. The opposite is true. Every effort has been made to silence dissenting voices and crush dissidents. The methods used are to unleash the most powerful investigative agencies on those who speak against the government. Journalists whose job it is to speak out against the things they see wrong are often treated as anti-nationals who should lose their rights as citizens. When the Jantar Mantar protests were at their peak, did you notice that many of Modi’s more passionate devotees demanded that the cockroaches should have their passports confiscated?

Every time I see dissidents attacked and dissidence crushed, it makes me realise that India is no longer the liberal democracy that it once was. Of course, leaders of yore did their own damage to liberal democratic values, as Indira Gandhi did when she declared the Emergency. But she did that so openly that defiance was much easier. In the past twelve years, the elimination of dissent and dissenters has been more insidious and more dangerous. The first time I saw that invisible pall of fear lift was when the Cockroach Janta Party began to mock Modi in their reels and in their speeches.

As I was writing this piece, I noticed on Instagram that some Modi devotees had set up a makeshift temple, in which stood a cardboard cutout of Modi dressed as Lord Rama. His devotees were reciting what they called the ‘Modi *chalisa*’ and, with lighted *diyas*, were praying to the cardboard deity. This sickened and shamed me. Does that make me a ‘*dimagi* Naxal’?

The writer is director, Hutkay Films

Imitation isn’t the sincerest form of flattery

TENS OF thousands of people attended a vigil in London to pay tribute to 41-year-old Jason Arday, the former Cambridge professor who died right after being publicly accused of plagiarism and making grandiose claims about his supposed achievements. Delicately poetic looking with dreadlocks and kohl rimmed eyes, young Arday cut a dashing figure, indeed. His good looks combined with a prestigious post in academia ensured admiration and celebrity. Ultimately, it all came to naught; he was brutally roasted for wildly inconsistent lies, each one gleefully torn apart by the British mainstream media.

The crowd at the vigil seemed greatly moved by the “unfair” level of scrutiny Arday endured, the sub-text being his white peers wouldn’t have had to face the same. Emotional speeches about the vicious media “hounding” that led to his death touched on “institutional racism”, but there

hasn’t been much said about the far more likely cause, the devastating embarrassment that stems from being trapped and exposed in a situation of one’s own making. For someone extra sensitive, being outed as a fraud is shattering enough to not want to wake up the next morning. In other words, it’s all too possible that Arday couldn’t hack his own stupidity. This outpouring of sympathy for his tragic end brings to mind Jim Morrison’s profound observation in the poem *A Feast of Friends*: Death makes angels of us all, and gives us wings where we had shoulders smooth as raven claws.

After any shocking incident, an instinct kicks in, reminding us we are all flawed beings, trying our best to get by. We’re forced to reflect on our own mortality. It’s more comforting to ascribe blame or find reasons to explain ordinary human fragility than hold people responsible for their choices. On the scale of terrible things people do to one another, garnering the



ON THE LOOSE
BY LEHER KALA

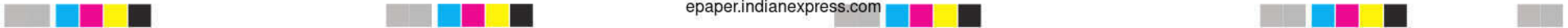
spotlight by boasting seems pretty minor. Ideally, nobody should have to die for it. However, the reactions and conversations around Arday’s death raise important questions and shed an (alarming) light on changing value systems. Does pursuing the right to social justice trump pursuing the truth? Or can we agree that both racial injustice and intellectual dishonesty are to be lamented equally?

It is worth noting that the ChatGPT era has redefined how we think about originality. Plagiarism used to mean passing off someone else’s work as one’s own, but students now are open about using AI to write academically perfect essays. A far cry from when we grew up in the 80s when anyone who cheated during an exam was treated with withering scorn (copycat!). Interestingly, one no longer hears of schools rusticating students for unethical exam practices. In this scenario, the thinking goes: everyone’s handing in AI-assisted assign-

ments, so is it so bad that Arday was masquerading as a pseudo highbrow?

I’m going to stick my neck out and say it is actually that bad. Post-generative AI is so clever that plagiarism can no longer be reliably detected, as long as the user asks ChatGPT to paraphrase the content. If the Ardays’ of this world are allowed to flourish unheeded, the future means endless, tired regurgitations of stuff that already exists. Nothing new will emerge; society will remain stagnant. And surely that poor, nameless PhD student who toiled away in obscurity to come up with a new perspective — only to have the far more famous and networked Arday grab it for himself — deserves some sympathy, too. We’re told not to badmouth the dead, but there’s the thought that people who’ve made their fortune via a public reputation have a greater duty to maintain the highest integrity.

The writer is director, Hutkay Films



Left-armers star as Australia take 101-run lead in 2nd Test



Mitchell Starc picked up six wickets for just 12 runs. AP

Reuters
Melbourne, August 22

LEFT-ARM pacemen Mitchell Starc and Shoriful Islam starred with six-wicket hauls as Bangladesh rallied from a dreadful start to pin back Australia on a roller-coaster opening day of the second Test on Saturday.

Eighteen wickets fell on the bouncy Mackay wicket, with Australia limping to 165 for eight at stumps but holding a 101-run lead after blasting out the tourists for 64 in the first innings. All-rounder Cameron Green, one of the few batters to stand up amid the carnage, was 51 not out, continuing his renaissance after scoring a century in Australia's stunning nine-wicket loss in the series opener in Darwin.

Tailender Nathan Lyon was 10 not out. The recalled Shoriful took three wickets in five balls in the final hour to celebrate his first five-wicket haul in tests after missing Darwin with a hamstring strain.

He finished the day with 6-35, having helped drag Bangladesh back into the match after all seemed lost in the morning.

With Australia trailing 1-0 in the two-match series and under fire after the Darwin shock, captain Pat Cummins won the toss and put his quicks to work on a wicket prepared like a typical Gabba pitch.

Starc delivered with a brilliant display of swing bowling, taking 6-12.

The 36-year-old's masterclass was the sixth-fastest five-wicket haul in tests. He also holds the fastest, having taken five in 15 balls against West Indies in Kingston last year.

His fifth wicket on Saturday, dismissing wicketkeeper Litton Das lbw for a duck, lifted him above South Africa's Dale Steyn to 10th on the all-time test wickets list with 441 dismissals.

Starc's final wicket – Shoriful for 14 – wrapped up Bangladesh's innings just after lunch, but Najmul Hossain Shanto's side hit back hard.

Shoriful led the way with 6-35, rattling through Australia's top order. He bowled opener Travis Head (22) and out-of-form number three Marnus Labuschagne (4), before trapping Steve Smith lbw for 42, ending a 77-run partnership with Green.

BRIEF SCORES: Bangladesh 64 all out (Shoriful Islam 14; Mitchell Starc 6/12, Pat Cummins 3/25) vs Australia 165/8 (Cameron Green 51 not out, Steve Smith 42; Shoriful Islam 6/35) at stumps on Day 1.

INDIA VS SRI LANKA, 2ND TEST

Ten years after Kohli, Gill has chance to conquer Colombo

A series win here wouldn't put him alongside his predecessor, but it would be the first sign of an identity forming

Shankar Narayan
Mumbai, August 22

IN 2015, Colombo's Sinhalese Sports Club was the venue where Virat Kohli took a big step in shaping his vision for India's Test side.

On a green pitch, India won a series decider through pace, with Ishant Sharma, Umesh Yadav and Stuart Binny taking 13 of Sri Lanka's 20 wickets. It was an early statement that India could win away from home not with spin, but with a fast-bowling attack that could control and dominate Tests.

A decade later, the same venue offers Shubman Gill an opportunity that could prove similarly revealing. His captaincy is still a work in progress, and Sunday's second Test offers a chance to seal the series, and to show that the instincts seen in England last year, and in the first Test at Galle, are evolving into something more substantial.

The question is not simply whether Gill can win another Test. It is whether he is establishing an identity as a captain.

Gill has spoken about being comfortable in the role, and about India taking "all the right steps in the right direction." The next step is seeing whether his ideas can bring consistent success. "I'm very comfortable with the role, and the kind of way we have been progressing in the past one year has been very pleasing to see, in my perspective. I think we are taking all the right steps in the right direction," he said before the Galle Test.

After his maiden assignment in England last year, the first Test at Galle gave the clearest indication yet of what that identity could look like.

Gill's approach has so far been defined more by individual decisions than by a clear method. At Galle, though, those decisions looked connected: he backed his players, attacked with the ball, and kept looking for ways to create pressure.

He trusted Manav Suthar on his first Test outside India, bowling him ahead of Ravindra Jadeja and Kuldeep Yadav in the first innings and handing him the new ball in the second. The left-arm spinner responded with a match haul of 10 for 131, including 6 for 55 in the second innings.

Gill made a similar call with Prasidh Krishna. With speculation that Gurnoor Brar could debut, Gill backed Prasidh instead, saying it was the best he had seen the pacer bowl. The 30-year-old has long had the attributes to trouble batsmen, height, bounce, awkward lift, but consistency has deserted him.

He repaid the captain's faith with a match haul of 3 for 63. He broke the 146-run Niroshan

Dickwella-Sonal Dinusha partnership in the first innings. But his second-innings spell was more revealing. Gill used him for eight overs on Day 4, and Prasidh responded with a probing 1 for 13.

Coming from around the wicket, Prasidh dismissed Kamindu Mendis with a short-of-length delivery, extracting extra bounce and forcing a loose slash to slip. Against Dhananjaya de Silva, he consistently took away movement and surprised him with the ball coming in. Against Lahiru Udara, he varied fuller balls nipping back in with shorter ones.

The captain's encouraging words before the match seemed to have had the desired effect.

Questions still persist about how much of Gill's tactical thinking is his own, and how much reflects coach Gautam Gambhir. Those doubts could clear as Gill's body of work grows. But once players cross the boundary rope, the onus is on the captain to make things work.

At Galle, Gill did exactly that. Ajinkya Rahane later praised his proactive bowling changes and field placements. Colombo now gives Gill the chance to show that Galle was not a one-off.

That matters, because the challenge facing Gill is bigger than winning one Test. His early captaincy was encouraging: 754 runs in England, an enthralling 2-2 series draw, a dominant home performance against the West Indies. But South Africa exposed the first cracks, with India losing 2-0. Colombo's setting recalls Kohli, but Gill doesn't need to copy him. What matters more is how Kohli handled players like Ishant.

Kohli's role was not to transform Ishant into a different bowler. It was to back him, demand greater discipline, and eventually get the best out of him.

Prasidh has the height and bounce to trouble batsmen, but consistency has often kept him from becoming a reliable wicket-taker. Like Ishant before him, Prasidh may not need to become a different bowler. He may only need a captain willing to trust his strengths and demand reliability in his lines and lengths, and through that, help him find the consistency that's eluded him.

Gill showed real promise as captain in England, but he has yet to win a major series abroad. Sri Lanka offers that opportunity now. A 2-0 sweep would not place him alongside Kohli overnight, but it would be his first significant overseas win as Test captain, and it could mark Colombo as the place where his leadership began to show its own identity.

LIVE: Sony Sports Network and Sony LIV, 10 am



India captain Shubman Gill bats in the nets ahead of the second Test in Colombo. CREIMAS

Gambhir on India's recent Test results: 'We are not struggling'

Express News Service
Mumbai, August 22

EVER SINCE Gautam Gambhir took over as India's men's team coach in 2024, results in red-ball and white-ball cricket have been chalk and cheese. India remain a dominant force in the latter, but have had mixed results in the former, including two home series defeats.

The former India opener, however, felt the side were not struggling in Test cricket, and the losses were merely a consequence of the team's transitional phase.

"Not at all. We are not struggling that much. Rankings do not matter. I think we are going through a transition, and I am sure that people sitting in the press box and in the commentary box know that we are going through a transition. And despite that, yes, there will be blips; there will be ups and downs," Gambhir told reporters on Saturday.

"But I thought that since the last one year, since the England tour, I think we have played reasonably consistent cricket in Test cricket as well. So I think you guys can go by the ranking, but we don't. Because we know that wherever we are heading, we are heading in the right direction," he added.

A constant around Gamb-

hir's tenure has been outside noise over performances and players. The head coach dismissed such talk and said his role was only to help the team win. "My job is to win trophies, not views and likes. That's all I believe in, and that is the difference between me and everyone. I wish I could talk. I could tell you about the conversations only that we have, me and the chairman selectors have. It's only about how we want to move forward with Indian cricket and what is important and what the right decisions are to make for the betterment of Indian cricket," he added.

India were without some regular players in the first Test at Galle, but Devdutt Padikkal stepped up with a standout performance. Gambhir expressed satisfaction, but cautioned

against judging players quickly.

"Extremely satisfied. Because when you get those younger players coming in and delivering straight away, but again, there is still a lot of work to be done. You can't judge players by only one or two performances. Yes, there is a lot of talent. That's why they are playing for India, and they have delivered straight away, which again is very good for Indian cricket as well.

"Because we want to see that depth not only in white-ball cricket, but in red-ball cricket as well. We have seen that they are getting an opportunity at number three and making the most of it."

The last few days have also seen talk about Kuldeep Yadav and his role in the team. Gambhir said, "We will try and pick the best bowling attack which can get us 20 wickets. For me, I think when winning Test matches, you try and pick the best attack that can get you 20 wickets, whether you have got three left-arm spinners in it or whether you have got an off-fielder or whether you have got three seamers. So we have all our options open."

“My job is to win trophies, not views and likes. That's all I believe in, and that is the difference between me and everyone.”

GAUTAM GAMBHIR,
INDIA HEAD COACH

'Sooryavanshi must learn to bat differently in red-ball cricket'

Venkata Krishna B
Bengaluru, August 22

VAIBHAV SOORYAVANSHI returns to the BCCI's Centre of Excellence (CoE), the place where his destiny changed.

During the 2024 off-season, the junior selection panel, then headed by Tilak Naidu were short-listing players for a camp with an eye on the 2026 Under-19 World Cup. Naidu & his team were in two minds, given that Sooryavanshi was just 13 years old. But BCCI's head of cricket VVS Laxman gave his approval. Sooryavanshi would join the camp and by September that year would hit a century in a Youth Test against Australia.

It is exactly two years since Sooryavanshi turned up for that camp at the CoE. On Sunday when he walks out for East Zone in the Duleep Trophy against North East Zone, he will do so as a different player. He has won the Under-19 World Cup. Has set the IPL stage on fire in successive seasons. He is already the youngest ever Indian to make an international T20 debut. In the IPL, there is no reputed bowler he hasn't taken down.

As India's new domestic season gets underway on Sunday, as has been the case in the tournaments that Sooryavanshi has featured in, the focus is on him. The Question is if he can find big runs in red-ball cricket.

The signs are encouraging. Much before he made headlines in the IPL, in the Youth Tests, Sooryavanshi showed he can score runs at a rapid pace. Apart from a century against Australia at Chepauk, he has one at Brisbane's Ian Healy Oval as well. Of course, when it comes to first-class cricket, where he has featured in 8 matches, he has only one fifty to show and has an average of 17.25.

The road to India's T20I team may have happened at a breakneck speed, but the same can't be said about his entry into the Test side. For at 15, Sooryavanshi still remains at a developmental stage as a batsman, still taking the baby steps.

"When it comes to T20s, he got an opportunity to play a lot of white-ball matches. In white-ball cricket, because he was able to score quickly, he was able to get into the Indian team quickly, but when it comes to making it to India's Test team there is plenty to travel for Sooryavanshi," Manish Ojha, who is Soo-

ryavanshi's childhood coach, tells *The Indian Express*.

Having coached Sooryavanshi from the start, Ojha knows the batsman inside out. While the ambition all along has been to make him a Test batsman, Sooryavanshi's style of game happened to be a reflection of the era he has grown up. "From the time he started, much of his practice has happened against the red-ball. The white-ball came up much later. So I don't see him not adapting to play red-ball cricket. But how quickly he adapts is the key. White-ball cricket is different," Ojha says.

Those who have been keeping a close tab on him from junior to senior level, point out one interesting aspect. Even in the IPL or in the limited internationals he has featured in, he has seldom been dismissed fishing outside off-stump or caught in the slip cordon. Of course, the short deliveries have troubled him, but he is a teenager who has shown he can learn quickly from the mistakes and adjust accordingly. While Sooryavanshi's game is built on aggression, if he can counter the red-ball, which moves more than the white ball, he can make life difficult for bowlers, like Virender Sehwag did in Test cricket.

Constructing innings

"The biggest adjustment he has to make will be on the mental side. In white-ball cricket, he is hitting every ball. You can't have a similar approach against the new ball. You have to wait for the right deliveries and minimise the risk. He has to learn to ride the wave, bat in different gears and learn the art of constructing an innings. Show the world, you can play 300 deliveries. This is the exposure he needs to gain from red ball cricket before we think of his next step," Ojha says.

While the North East Zone may not offer him a bigger challenge, in the coming rounds, stern tests await him. With India having a busy T20 calendar, how many Ranji fixtures Sooryavanshi will be able to turn up for remains a question. And Ojha wants to remind us of an important message. "He needs time to develop. Making the India Test team won't be easy. In Duleep and Ranji he might get only 7-10 matches a season. And you have to consistently score centuries and double centuries to be in the reckoning."



Vaibhav Sooryavanshi will walk out for East Zone against North East Zone in the Duleep Trophy on Sunday. FILE

HOCKEY WORLD CUP

More possession, less control: Loss to Dutch imperils India's semis hopes

Mihir Vasavda
New Delhi, August 22

HARMANPREET SINGH flung a low, powerful flick to beat the Dutch goalkeeper, halve India's deficit, and raise the team's hopes. He then sprinted back to the dugout, lay down and got a massage on his aching back. Just as he returned a couple of minutes later, his teammates lost the ball in the middle, the Netherlands launched a blistering counter, and Thijs van Dam restored the two-goal cushion.

Another comeback wasn't to be. The 3-1 loss to the Olympic champions means India's fate is no longer in their hands. Their hopes of reaching the World Cup semifinals rest on how England and Argentina perform, given that the Netherlands are in pole position with six points.

Craig Fulton & Co. will look back at the campaign with melancholy.

There was always something holding India back at

this World Cup. They had the bursts, the fast starts, the spells when they looked capable of taking on anyone. But they never quite got the handbrake off.

Against the Netherlands, that was exposed more starkly than it had been all tournament. India had more of the ball – 61.6 percent possession. Had more circle entries – 20 to the Netherlands' 16. Won more penalty corners – 7 to 4. But none of it mattered much.

The Netherlands looked in control even when they were without it, comfortable enough to let India circulate possession in areas that did not really hurt them and confident that the openings would eventually come. It was a lesson in the difference between possession and control.

"Three quarters we played very well," Harmanpreet told the broadcasters after the match. "We managed the ball and defence-wise, we did good things. But we have to stay focused and consistent for 60



India lost 1-3 to Olympic champions Netherlands. HOCKEY INDIA

minutes. Last quarter, we made the same mistakes. They scored from our mistakes only."

Harmanpreet had a point. India were competitive for long periods. Manpreet Singh, as he has done throughout this World Cup, put his body on the

line as the first line of defence, rushing out to close down the Dutch drag-flicks and disrupting their routines. Shilanand Lakra did well to run behind the defence and create passing channels. There were spells when India moved the ball well

India had more of the ball, more circle entries, and won more penalty corners. But none of it mattered much

and looked capable of stretching the Netherlands.

Devil in the details

But too many of their most influential players never managed to impose themselves on the game, as has been the case through the campaign.

Harmanpreet, nursing back pain, was sparingly used and, although he scored India's only goal of the match, struggled to leave his imprint. Hardik Singh, whose ability to carry India through midfield can change the rhythm of a game, was similarly unable to establish himself. Abhishek Nain, one of India's most dangerous attacking outlets, was effectively marked out of the contest.

The Netherlands never looked particularly flustered.

That was the most revealing part of the evening. India could have the ball, but the Dutch decided where India could have it. They could allow possession without surrendering control. They were patient, organised and sufficiently comfortable to wait for the moments when India lost their structure.

And when the first goal came, in the 41st minute from Duco Telgenkamp, it felt less like a sucker punch than the eventual reward for a team that had gradually taken ownership of the game.

That is perhaps the most uncomfortable takeaway from a 3-1 defeat. India may not be miles away from the best teams in the world. They can play with them. They can make them defend. They can even have more of the ball. But they are still some distance from making those teams play on India's terms.

That has been the story of this World Cup in many ways.

India have had their moments – sometimes very good ones. But they have rarely been able to sustain them. Against Pakistan, the chaos worked in their favour. Against the Netherlands, there was no chaos to exploit. The Dutch simply kept their shape, absorbed the pressure and waited.

The handbrake never quite came off. And that is what the Netherlands have shown India: the gap between being competitive against the big nations and actually controlling a game against them remains a significant one. India can hurt the best teams. They can match them for stretches. But at this World Cup, they have rarely made the best teams uncomfortable for an entire 60 minutes.

Against the Netherlands, they had more possession but less control. And perhaps no statistic better captures where Indian hockey stands today.

PLAYING TONIGHT: India vs Australia, 10.30 pm, Live on Star Sports & JioHotstar

492 athletes named in Asian Games final list

New Delhi: India will send a 492-strong contingent for next month's Asian Games in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan. The team comprises 265 men and 227 women across 35 sports disciplines, according to a sports ministry communication on Saturday. Athletics will have the largest representation, with 73 athletes comprising 35 men and 38 women. 3000m steeplechaser Avinash Sable and injured 110m hurdler Tejas Shirse have also been named in the squad. Sable, who won 3000m steeplechase gold medals in the 2022 Asian and 2025 Asian Championships, has competed only once after undergoing surgery last year, and that also in 5000m in Belgium earlier this month. He was not in the Glasgow CWG squad. ENS



The Table, by Two

As Mumbai's sought after dining space turns 15, founders Gauri Devidayal and Jay Yousuf on building an empire, one brand at a time

Samanth Subramanian connects the dots



Suanshu Khurana

THESE IS an almost monastic simplicity to the spacious, uncluttered room in Mumbai's Lokhandwala where 54-year-old poet and lyricist Irshad Kamil spends his days, and often nights, searching for words. Nearly nothing in the space suggests that one of contemporary Hindi cinema's most prolific lyricists, whose songs were recently heard in *Main Vaapas Aaunga* (2026), *Dhurandhar* (2025), *Amar Singh Chamkila* (2024), *Saiyaara* (2025), and whose earlier work includes some of Hindi cinema's most resonant and textured melodies in *Rockstar* (2011) *Tamasha* (2015) and *Jab We Met* (2007), works here.

There is no imposing bookshelf here, not even for Ghalib, Dushyant Kumar, Sahir Ludhianvi, Faiz, Uday Prakash and Mohan Singh — poets Kamil keeps close and returns to. No shelf crowded with awards, no gallery of photographs with those from the film industry, just about nothing to distract him. But for all its austerity, with only a simple wooden desk, a Marshall speaker and an ordinary pencil with a small eraser fixed on its back, the room comes with one indulgence: a lush garden, a patch of earth amid Mumbai's concrete. It, perhaps, carries something of the landscape that Kamil grew up with in Punjab, allowing for his instinct to remain rooted in the places, people and cadences that have chiselled his writing over the last three decades.

"Some of the phrases that find their way into my songs are those that I have heard around me at various junctures in my life. Many songs come from the visuals one's memory holds," says Kamil. While he has written for many composers and directors, his writing seems to have found its fullest expression in his long-running collaboration with Imtiaz Ali. While it was earlier with Pritam, for the last few years, he has worked more with AR Rahman. Despite coming from very different geographies, it is intriguing how Ali, Rahman and Kamil inhabit the same emotional world. "There has been no better partnership of this sort in contemporary Hindi cinema. Irshad's metaphors from his Punjabi *viraasat* are unique," says filmmaker, lyricist and stand-up comedian Varun Grover.

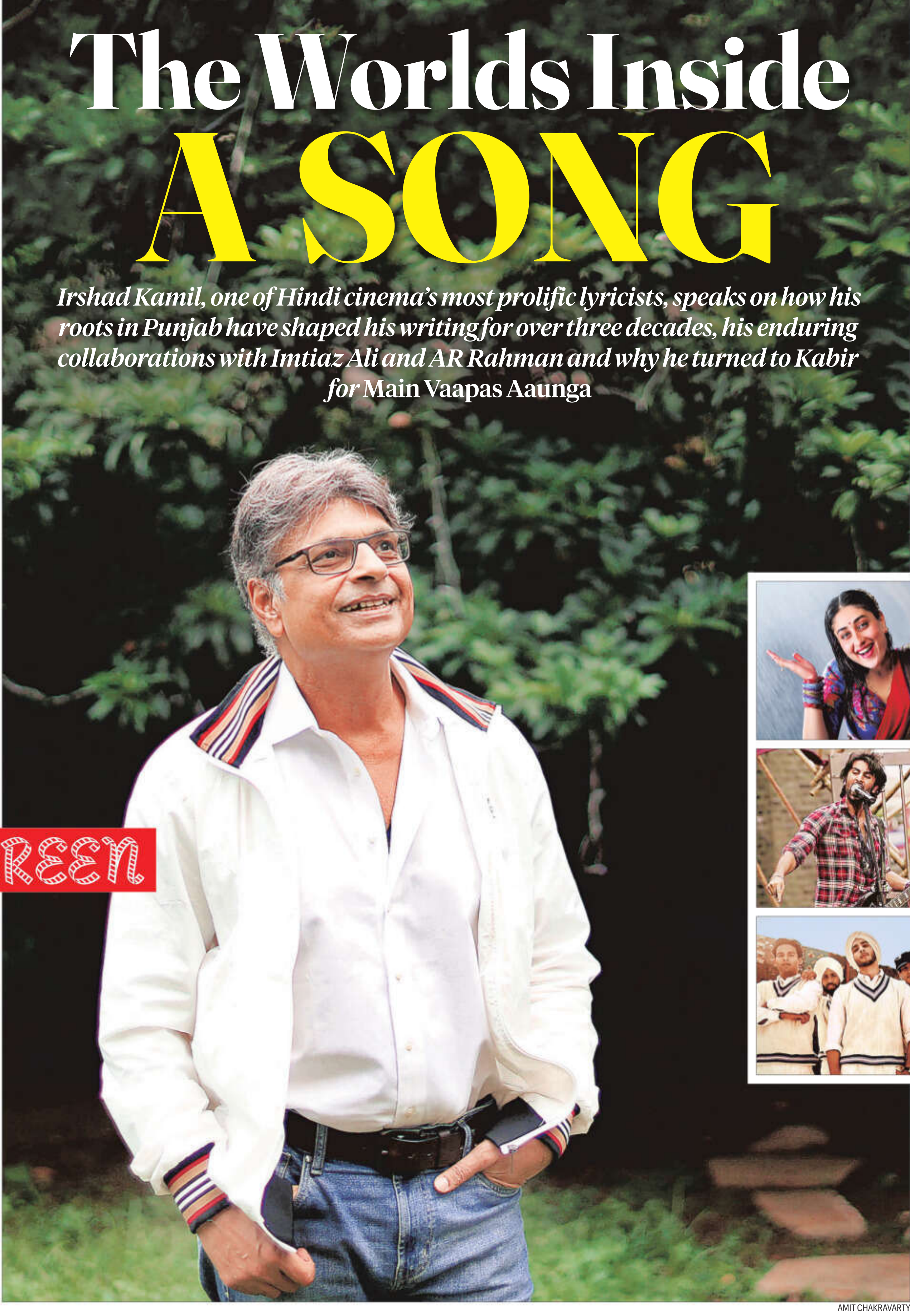
The raw angst in *Sadda Haq* (Rockstar, 2011), for instance, drew from Punjab's *ki-asaan aandolans* of the '80s, when the rallying cry 'Sadda haq, aithe rakh' appeared on walls and Kamil saw it his way to school. The protest anthem was also heard during the recent Jantar Mantar protests, acquiring resonance among Gen Z. A wedding song in *Love Aaj Kal* (2009) came from a grandmother in his working-class neighbourhood in Malerkotla, where 'jhai', as everyone called her, was the superstar of *sangeet* nights, singing titillating lyrics. Kamil drew on her for *Thoda thoda pyar*. If for *Amar Singh Chamkila*, he returned to his youth in the insurgency-ridden Punjab of the '80s, Kamil's more recent work includes top-tier writing for Ali's *Main Vaapas Aaunga*, rooted in the Partition stories he grew up knowing through family and what he heard and read as the collective grief of the region.

What makes the Kamil-Rahman-Ali partnership work

Probably what has allowed the Kamil-Rahman-Ali collaboration to run smoothly is that the trio does not have to deal with the tyranny of numbers or compulsion to chase a hit song, despite an industry increasingly governed by streams and reels. "Besides a mutual respect for each other's craft, there is also never any pressure to deliver a hit. *Kaam karne mein maza aana chahiye. Ab uss kaam se maza lena ki khwahish mein kuch cheezin aisi ho jaati hain jo routine se alag hoti hain*. Perhaps that freedom is the secret," says Kamil.

In the Partition saga, Kamil's *Ishq Mastana* draws from Kabir's famed line *Haman hai ishq mastana*. He chose it for the love story of a Sikh boy and a Muslim girl, not only because the 15th-century poet-saint straddled both Hindu and Muslim worlds without belonging to either but also because of Kabir's directness. "If I had used a line by another poet, it probably wouldn't have landed the same way. Also, the ease in it, *aajki zubaan lagti hai* and still has history in it gentle quiet love song, it is the last piece Kamil wrote for the film. The pain of two lovers separated by a newly drawn border, comes through; the language stays conversational, a hallmark of Kamil's writing. *Jaise paani paas pyaase tere paas main / Jaise dil ke hain dilaase, tere paas main*, writes Kamil. "This song was my last attempt to sum up the film. By that time, I believe I had understood their pain well."

Its tenderness and Rahman's simple, intimate melody have allowed the song to linger. In the social-media universe, seldom has a song found a life beyond a couple of weeks



SCREEN

KAMIL KEEPS RETURNING TO THE SAME SOIL, WHERE PEOPLE SAY ORDINARY THINGS THAT BECOME SPECIAL IN A SONG. IT IS THE UNRUSHED QUALITY OF HIS SONGS THAT CONTINUES TO MAKE OLD FEELINGS FEEL NEW AGAIN

like this. "It is always more challenging to work with a great composition and much harder to fulfil it. *Takkar ke lafz aane chahiye. Chaliye lafz bhi aa gaye, usi takkar ke emotional lafz aane chahiye...*" says Kamil. Grover once heard *Jissaqbaazi* by Kamil in the flop that was *Zero* (2018), and was confused with the line: *Resahiba padhaku thi, Mirza tha tain, Tabhi toh wo English thi, desi hoon main*. Kamil told him it was a historical fact in the folk tragedy, *Sahiba and Mirza*. "I was amazed how something from history was so deftly transported in an item song," says Grover. "Irshad, for me, is immensely inspiring... That clarity has existed in my mind since *Rockstar* and *Highway*. *Sooha saaha amma ka...* how can anyone come up with that imagery, I wonder. It is brilliant," says Grover.

Malerkotla, where it all began

To understand Kamil, one has to begin with Malerkotla, the town in Punjab's Malwa region where he was born and raised. Malerkotla carries a distinctive history. Its Muslim rulers had a long association with the Sikh community, famously through Nawab Sher Mohammad Khan's protest against the sentence handed to Guru Gobind Singh's two sons by the ruler of Sirhind. Khan argued that executing children

was unjust. The boys were executed nevertheless, but the Sikh community held the Nawab's intervention in high regard. It became a story of solidarity that tied the two communities beyond their common language. To date, many Muslims frequent local *gurdwaras*, while community *iftar* meals are common during Ramzaan. When Partition tore through Punjab in 1947, Malerkotla remained relatively calm. Its Muslim population largely decided to not leave. Kamil's family, too, stayed back. It is this little town that Kamil identifies as home, this secular space that he absorbed before he could even think of it as an influence. "*Koi khushi hamesha padi reh ti hai vahan mitti mein dabi huyi* (Some happiness always lies there, buried beneath the earth)," Kamil wrote of Malerkotla in his book *Kaali Aurat Ka Khwaab* (Vani Prakashan), which traces the stories behind his songs and the journey that led him to the 'Black Lady', his first Filmfare Award in 2010. He remains deeply connected to those streets, his friends, family, neighbours. "We have some farmland there. I work there when I go. *Apni jaddon ki taraff jab aap vaapis ho jaate hain, shayad thode se aur hare ho jaate hain, thode aur zinda ho jaate hain* (When you return to your roots, perhaps you become a little greener, a little more alive). It is also a great leveller. I am still that same boy for them, not a film lyricist," says Kamil. The youngest of seven siblings, Kamil grew up in a modest home in a neighbourhood largely inhabited by masons, carpenters and painters. His father worked in the

chemistry department at the local government college and his plan for his children was clear: an education, followed by a job and then raising a family. While poetry was appreciated, it was never a career option. Kamil studied at Sanatan Dharam Prem Pracharak High School, an all-boys school, that introduced him to theatre. After his Class 10 exams, he one day heard a ghazal programme titled *Aabshaar* on All India Radio's Urdu service and was drawn by the world it opened up. "I was captivated by the way two lines could hold something so much larger within them," says Kamil.

From love letters to film lyrics

His experiments with writing, however, were steeped in the ordinary anxieties of first love. Boys from the boys' school went to co-ed college, met girls and "began falling in love". Kamil began writing love letters for them, finding phrases that others were struggling to articulate. While Kamil was enrolled as a science student "because my parents wanted me to be an engineer", he found little affinity with the subjects. After failing to clear his Maths and Physics exams, he went to Shimla with his friends for a jaunt with Rs 500 before preparing for supplementary exams. He couldn't tell his parents, so he decided not to return. The eight months there became his training ground. He joined Himachal Theatre and did a few plays, including Tagore's *Kabuliwala*. He came back on the condition that he would study Hindi literature. He also began writing poetry for the college magazine — a

MAKING OF A POET Irshad Kamil in his garden in Mumbai's Lokhandwala; his songs in *Chameli*; *Rockstar*; *Main Vaapas Aaunga*; with long-time collaborator, director Imtiaz Ali



AMIT CHAKRAVARTY



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start to his original writing. Around this time, Kamil, who was born Mohammad Irshad, decided to course-correct another issue. Even though it is central to poetic customs, Kamil disliked his given name. "I thought a name needed to carry some weight, like Amitabh Bachchan," he says. His mother and he scoured a dictionary and zeroed in on Kamil (meaning complete). "It fit better," he says. After a Master's in Hindi followed by a diploma in journalism, Kamil did a PhD in contemporary Hindi poetry from Punjab University in Chandigarh. Its open atmosphere was a period of mental adjustment," says Kamil. Since being a poet was not going to pay much and he did not want to teach, Kamil worked as a journalist, initially for *The Tribune* and then for *Loksatta*. One of his assignments was to interview director Lekh Tandon, who was shooting the show *Daraar* in the city. Tandon wanted a local writer as he was tired of waiting for the screenplay to reach him via courier from Mumbai. He turned to Kamal Tiwari, Chairman of Chandigarh Sangeet Natak Akademi, who recommended Kamil on the phone while he sat with Tandon in his hotel room for his interview. "Tandon *saab* turned to me and said, '*Kaka, tera na ki hai?* (Child, what is your name?) He got back to the phone and said, 'He is sitting right here'," recalls Kamil. He subsequently worked extensively on Tandon's screenplays and found much appreciation. But as weekly, well-made shows turned into daily soaps, with quality dwindling and writers' credits lost, Kamil lost interest. He began writing Punjabi songs for friends and left his job, deciding to move to Mumbai with Rs 9,000. "Institutions will not teach you life. Only life will teach you life," says Kamil, who returned soon after as he couldn't take to Mumbai.

The struggle years in Mumbai

It wasn't very long before Kamil collected some more courage and money and returned to Mumbai. The money got over again and so did the courage. With the last Rs 500, one could either return home or use it for food. Kamil returned home again. "These things are important. You don't value it if you haven't endured enough for it. Stories of struggle are not just stories. It is not about someone being hungry in Bombay. *Di-maag mein kya chala hoga, hauns la kaise toota hoga? Kya usne apne hunar pe shaq kiya hoga?* The way that inner turmoil can change a person, it cannot be expressed in words," says Kamil. He called a few composers and felt insulted when they would either not meet or were unavailable. One of his friends asked him to call composer Sandesh Shandilya, who agreed to meet and was impressed by Kamil's recitation. Around the same time, Ali was looking for a writer for his debut, *Socha Na Tha* (2005). Shandilya recommended Kamil. This would become a significant creative partnership. Kamil's words found an easy kinship with Ali's world of love, longing and the search for oneself. He finally won the Filmfare for *Ajji din chadheya* (*Love Aaj Kal*, 2009) and *Nadaan parindey* (*Rockstar*, 2011). He has never won a National Award. However, the first song one heard from Kamil was *Bhaage re man* (*Chameli*, 2003), which put him on the music map of Hindi films. What has also really worked in Kamil's writing is a unique mix of Urdu, Hindi and often Punjabi. His command over all three has resulted in an authentic blend. *Patalkha guddi, Nagada nagada, Ajji din chadheya* are a few examples. "I disliked the use of bad Punjabi in Hindi songs that often meant nothing. I wanted respectful use of literary Punjabi. I also wanted to exalt the idea of love in songs," says Kamil. What worked for the industry was that he could write *Kun faya kun, Tumse hi din hota hai* and also *Tune maari entriyaan*. Barring Rahman, who gives enough liberty to Kamil to write and even adjusts lyrics (unheard of these days), the lyricist continues to fight for words in a common tussle with composers and producers. "No one wants to change an approved composition. Sometimes they want a certain syllable/sound in the end. That specificity is problematic," says Kamil. These days, he is also collaborating with Papon for *Mehfilz with Papon* — Irshad, where the singer sings Kamil's ghazals, poetry that often does not find an opportunity in films. After three decades, Kamil's songs may have travelled much farther than the lanes where they began and even acquired a universality. The resonance to much of the writing, perhaps comes from the fact that he still hasn't left the simpler world that made him. He keeps returning to the same soil, where people say ordinary things that become special in a song. At a time when the Hindi film song increasingly feels like fast fashion, it is the unrushed quality of Kamil's songs, their stubbornness to stay in one's head, that continues to make old feelings feel new again.



DOWN IN JUNGLELAND

BY RANJIT LAL

AUTHOR, ENVIRONMENTALIST
AND BIRDWATCHER



WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

LEGEND HAS IT
Stone figurines called moai in Rapa Nui, Chile

Lessons from Easter Island

The volcanic island's ecological collapse has a warning for a world still plundering its forests, mountains and oceans

THIS REMOTE volcanic island in the south-east Pacific, 3,500 km off the western coast of Chile, also known as Rapa Nui, is world famous for its nearly 1,000 massive stone figurines called moai, carved from volcanic ash, featuring out-sized human heads standing on a plinth and facing inland, most of which are now 'knocked over'. The island was first settled by the Polynesians around the first millennium, and at the time had a wide variety of trees and birds, especially seabird life. The massive statues were believed to serve as a connection between the dead and the living, and faced inwards to keep out the evil spirits harboured by the ocean.

The natives prospered, but as their population grew, so did the competition for resources. Two rival tribes emerged and populations plummeted as their societies went into collapse. There are several theories to what exactly happened and when, but all relate to major changes in environmental factors — something we would do well to heed.

According to a hypothesis by the American scientist Jared Diamond, called the 'Ecocide Hypothesis', the natives even resorted to cannibalism. According to him, in order to get the stone figurines to their locations, they had to be put on huge wooden rollers, which resulted in massive deforestation. This, in turn, led to soil erosion and crop loss, apart from the extinction of all the trees and birds. With no more wood to build their boats, the natives were unable to harvest fish from the sea or hunt seabirds. The tribes had their own statues and believed that the knocking down of their rivals' statues would render them vulnerable. It is conjectured that between the mid-1600s and 1772 (when the first European settlers arrived), the population had plummeted from a high of 15,000 to between 2,000 and 3,000.

In the 1770s, came the Europeans, bringing with them hundreds of diseases which the Polynesians had no immunity to. Then, there was the slave trade. On the island, 'statue toppling' between the tribes continued to eradicate the 'socio-spiritual' power of the rival, and between 1862 and 1888, 94 per cent of the population perished.

Fierce controversy rages around the Ecocide Theory, with subsequent studies attempting to prove that ecocide did not, in fact, take place. There is apparently no conclusive evidence (including genetic) to show that mass death occurred. One counter argument suggested that while deforestation did take place, it was replaced by agriculture, which increased the food production on the island to the benefit of the population. (There seems to be no counter to the erosion argument though.)

Wherever the truth really lies, the messages come through loud and clear and are relevant to so many societies and ecosystems today. Over-populate and overexploit your resource base at an unsustainable level and there will be trouble. Allow superstition to dictate your moves and there will be trouble. Thus, we have baby and child genocide in Gaza (how far removed is this from cannibalism really?), wars over oil and gas and precious metals, the deep wounding of wilderness areas and the systematic destruction of ancient rainforests. In our blind greed for money and power, we blunder on rampantly, destroying the very resources we need to keep our living planet alive. Ecocide by a thousand cuts, if you like.

Thus, we have condemned 170,000 hectares of tropical forests in Hasdeo Arand in Central India, where *tendu patta* collection, and other minor forest produce, is a major income source for the Gond tribe and two million people; all because it sits on huge store of coal, which will now be mined by a big-shot industrialist who will ship the coal off to Rajasthan. The idyllic Nicobar Islands, where we probably still don't have the complete list of life forms, has been condemned in the name of national security and development against which no one can argue. The same holds true for the wholesale destruction of and tunnelling through mountains for the building of wide and smooth roads down which I'm sure an enemy will be delighted to drive his tanks.

I have always felt that a sludgy mosquito-riddled, disease-ridden mangrove forest, miles wide, will do more to discourage an enemy than a nice deep-sea port, which they can blithely sail into. (It was mosquitoes which prevented the rapacious white man from accessing several rainforest areas in Africa and South America, and remember what happened in Vietnam, where in spite of Agent Orange, the Vietcong, fighting tooth-and-nail won) thus saving them from exploitation. High Mountain passes, forever ice-bound and sheer cliff faces, are as equal an impediment to any attacking army as they are to a defending one.

We say piously, of course, that we care for wildlife and trees; we'll increase the area under 'tree cover' and replant 15 million tropical rainforest trees in arid Haryana, which god knows needs more green cover. We are mixing petrol with whisky to save on fossil fuels, even if it means we might have a few more 93-octane drunk drivers.

Then, when the forest fires go stir crazy and the storms and floods flatten us, and lethal viral infections turn into pandemics, we shake our heads and say, 'What can we do? These are acts of God!'



'The political is immanent'

Raqs Media Collective's first solo in India in a decade explores dissent, memory and time as a companion

Trisha Mukherjee

THE COLOURFUL fabric with the *navratna* pattern, spilling across the ceiling and walls of the 17th-century LAMO (Ladakh Arts and Media Organisation) building in Leh, is a familiar sight. It is the *shamiana* — a cloth traditionally used as a ceremonial tent in India and south Asia, but which is also an enduring symbol of resistance.

Before arriving in Ladakh earlier this month — for Raqs Media Collective's first solo in India in a decade — the *shamiana* was in Zurich's Migros Museum für Gegenwartskunst as part of another show, *Disobedience Archive* (*Canopy for Broken Time*) for four months till May.

As it moved from Zurich to Ladakh, its transit, as if to make a metaphorical pit-stop, coincided with another movement in Delhi last month: the student protest against the country's fragile education system in Jantar Mantar. It was under a different canopy but, by extension, Raqs and its *shamiana* became witnesses to what Jeebesh Bagchi, one of the co-founders, calls a "watershed" moment.

"It's a moment of renewal and transformation. There's a new generation thinking creatively about its future and politics. It is good for everyone," says Shuddhabrata Sengupta over a Zoom call, on a rainy Saturday afternoon.

Mining for the Political

This churning forms the core of Raqs Media Collective that borrows its name from the Sufi word meaning the whirling of a dervish. In essence, it encapsulates the paradoxical idea of "kinetic contemplation".

Bagchi, Sengupta and Monica Narula — former students of Delhi's Jamia Millia Isla-



KATO HAJIME

ma — formed the collective in 1992 while working on their first film, *Half the Night Left*, and *The Universe to Comprehend*.

Over the last three decades, this curiosity-driven restlessness has come to define their aesthetic — artistic and political, with a practice spanning films, installation and photography. But it was never just about art or politics for them. Take their 2017 film, *The Blood of Stars*, which was screened in Ladakh. Shot in Lulea, Sweden, it explores human-nature conflict through the story of iron, pointing to the irony of how a life-giving metal is also responsible for environmental destruction. Think mining.

Raqs works in what Narula terms the "subterranean political", where politics is inseparable from the quotidian. "Everything

OUT OF LINE (Clockwise from top) Installation of the *shamiana*, titled *Ferment*, in Ladakh's LAMO Building; *The Wayfarer Series*; Raqs Media Collective's Jeebesh Bagchi, Shuddhabrata Sengupta (right), Monica Narula



one does has a bearing on their surroundings. One gives back into the landscape — urban, emotional, community, aesthetic and poetic. We're all making these ecologies together, and the political is immanent. It is important not to see them as separate," she says.

The inextricability was most recently evident when Sengupta came out in support of fellow artist Srishti Gupta, who has been incarcerated since April 2026 for participating in Noida Workers' Protest. "I hope that the demands of art, life and freedom will make the judges make sensible decisions on how Srishti will live," he wrote after visiting Gupta in prison.

The Disobedient Tent

At other times, the art and the politics in-

In the three decades since Raqs's inception, a curiosity-driven restlessness has come to define their aesthetic — artistic and political. But it was never just about art or politics for them

termingle more visibly, like in their presentation of art theorist Marco Scotini's *Disobedience Archive* — an evolving video archive exploring intersections of art and dissent — in Zurich earlier this year.

They chose 50 films, including Sanjay Kak's *Words on Water*, that expose the fault-lines — ecological, political, technological — of our collapsing world and screened each under a different version of the canopy. In an act of repair, it attempted to mend the fissures in time between the protest on screen and the moment of watching it together. "The *shamiana* has been an important metaphor for us, yet it is not a metaphor at all. It is a reality we have all grown up with... reflecting upon something we have lived with and asking what the effective exchange between us and that thing is," says Narula.

The idea was also to qualify the very act of disobedience. "It's not simply saying no. It's epistemic disobedience... knowing that you are creating something," Bagchi adds.

For Raqs, the *shamiana*, the gatherings, the thinking and the questioning have been a way of life that finds perfect articulation in the title of their ongoing Ladakh exhibition — *The Time is Never Ripe*. For what? "Plucking an apricot," Bagchi analogises. "You don't want to pluck it until it is ready, but if you wait too long, it falls and squashes."

In this "refusal of finality", the *shamiana* takes on an evolving form through Zurich, Jantar Mantar, Ladakh and wherever it is headed next.

Between 'Not Yet' & 'Has Been'

Amid the quiet of Ladakh, the canopy assumes a renewed meaning as *Ferment*, but no less political. It shelters six other works, including *Communard Biscuits* (2017) that recalls the Paris Commune of 1871 and *Waiting* (2013) that brackets time between the states of 'not yet' and 'has been' in a stencil, thereby turning into a guardian of shared human history.

Through 25 works in all, the exhibition, supported by the RMZ Foundation, brings together these multiple temporalities. Sengupta wants us to look at it as a "layer cake". "You have different layers of time compressed on top of, and seeping into, each other." And the 300-year-old, two-storey LAMO building, made of mud becomes one of the strata.

In *The Wayfarer series*, time becomes a companion. It features prints of photographs of the Ladakh landscape, on which are outlined animals — beasts of all kinds — in glitter that are wayfaring with us. "Histories often coalesce around ideas of distortion and non-normativity," Narula says.

Pluralism has been crucial to the collective's internal functioning as well. There are "disagreements constantly", but Bagchi describes theirs as a heterarchical model, "where there is no singular moment of consolidation of roles".

The sense of solidarity is also at the heart of *Comic Contempt* (2021). Looking at humour as a form of dissent, it features panels bearing fragments of text to show how comedy can undermine authority. "It is particularly relevant today where there's a lack of understanding of the language a younger generation uses," Sengupta says.

What happens then, when something history cannot categorise tries to be part of it? Do you dismiss it as the 'other' or let it join the cavalcade? Do you comply or do you turn disobedient?

The time to open up the *shamiana* again is never ripe.

The Age of Aura

The calendar counts our years but curiosity decides whether we remain alive to the language, loves and longing of another generation



SLICE OF LIFE

BY SUVIR SARAN

CHEF, AUTHOR, EDUCATOR
AND WORLD TRAVELLER

WE MUST RECOGNISE WHAT WAS, UNDERSTAND WHAT IS, ANTICIPATE WHAT MAY BE AND PROTECT THE CLASSIC. THAT REQUIRES LISTENING TO THE YOUNG. NOT PATRONISING THEM

THE CHILDREN of my classmates occasionally tell me that I seem a generation, or sometimes two, younger than their parents. I accept this assessment with the solemn humility it deserves. Then, I remind them that if their parents appear older than me, the blame lies entirely with them. I have no children. My classmates do. Therefore, the only scientific conclusion available is that children cause ageing.

Their parents had school admissions, parent-teacher meetings, examination results and midnight curfews. I had restaurant openings, fashion shows, first dates, failed dates and the occasional man who disappeared between dessert and the promise of breakfast. They packed tiffins; I plated tasting menus. They waited outside tuition centres; I waited for critics.

Both are forms of parenting. Only one comes with a school bus.

Of course, these young people may simply be glazing me, lavishly buttering me up in a vocabulary their parents do not



SUVIR SARAN

understand. Perhaps, my aura is not immaculate. Perhaps, I do not possess rizz. Perhaps my drip — my style — is not "giving," and my latest fit check should have remained between me and my mirror.

Perhaps, I am already unc(uncle) not as a relationship but as a diagnosis. Still, I shall take the compliment. Age is not merely the number of candles perspiring upon a cake. There is chronological age — the arithmetic of arteries, ankles and anniversaries. But there is also the age of appetite: the willingness to encounter what we do not recognise without immediately condemning it.

Some people become old at 25 because they decide they have understood the world.

Others remain young at 80 because each morning arrives as a question. I have spent my life in retail, restaurants, fashion, music and the arts — industries forever in churn, crisis and costume change. Yesterday's revolution becomes today's reference and tomorrow's retro revival.

Relevance does not come from chasing every trend. It comes from knowing which winds announce weather and which merely disturb the curtains. We must recognise what was, understand what is, anticipate what may be and protect the classic.

That requires listening to the young. Not patronising them. Not mining them for fashionable phrases and performing youth

like an ill-fitting pair of leather trousers. Young people are society's early-warning system. Their slang may appear frivolous, but language never is. It reveals what a generation fears, desires and refuses to tolerate. Every new expression is a tiny social document, compressed like a spice between finger and thumb.

Technology has made connection convenient, but convenience is not intimacy. One may collect matches and remain profoundly unmatched. One may be delulu or be gaslighted into distrusting one's own hurt. One may develop "the ick" over the angle at which someone holds a fork and discard a human being whose kindness might have nourished a lifetime.

Words do not impoverish feeling; careless people do. A short word can contain a long wound. "Ghosted" may be modern slang, but abandonment is ancient. Language changes its clothing. The heart keeps returning to the same party. As a teacher and mentor to young chefs, I see this negotiation daily. A young cook may tell me another chef is "cooked" — defeated — or that someone "ate and left no crumbs," meaning they performed brilliantly. A dish may "slay." A culinary legend may be the G.O.A.T.

If I teach them the patience of tempering spices, they teach me the temperature of their times. I teach them that an onion cannot be bullied into sweetness; they teach me that authority without empathy is arrogance. I teach technique, memory and restraint. They teach speed, audacity and the courage to discard inherited rules.

Yet, each encounter leaves me with lore — the accumulated story behind a person, a friendship or a life. The body keeps the calendar. The soul keeps curiosity. And if the children of my classmates insist that I look younger than their parents, who am I to gaslight them?

THE WORD
THIS WEEK

Brother tells Princess Diana’s story

CHARLES SPENCER will publish a memoir about his sister Diana, Princess of Wales, on September 22. Titled *Swan Song: Diana, My Sister*, it marks his first extensive personal account nearly three decades after his Westminster Abbey eulogy. Spencer says he aims to tell her story “once and for all” before the 30th anniversary of her death. The book covers their childhood through her royal marriage and the week she died. Penguin Michael Joseph will publish globally, with translations in 12 languages.



Amazon eating rare books for AI

A HIDDEN AIRTAG tracked to an Amazon facility in Las Vegas has confirmed the tech giant is destroying rare books after scanning them to train AI models, 404 Media reported. The tracker was followed to Amazon’s VGT3 warehouse, where workers tear books from spines and scan pages. The team’s logo shows a Tyrannosaurus rex devouring a book. Amazon declined comment on AI training. Booksellers fear historically valuable works, including the only surviving copies of some editions, are being lost forever, with scanned content never shared publicly.



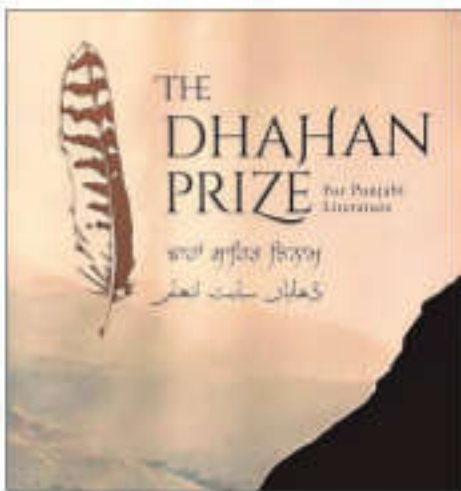
Is Natalie Portman Rachel Cusk’s M?

RACHEL CUSK’S upcoming novel, *Life of M*, has sparked speculation that the titular character is based on Natalie Portman. The book centres on an actor known only as “M”, whose autobiography a narrator is tasked with writing. Early reviews note parallels to Portman’s filmography, including references to a tortured ballerina (*Black Swan*) and a child actor role reminiscent of *Léon: The Professional*. Portman has long admired Cusk, calling her a “genius.” She has not commented. *The Times* called the portrayal a “calculated form of humiliation.”



\$51K Punjabi Prize names finalists

THREE AUTHORS have been named finalists for the 2026 Dhahan Prize for Punjabi Literature, competing for \$51,000 CAD. The winner receives \$25,000, with two finalists receiving \$10,000 each. An additional \$6,000 supports transliteration into Gurmukhi or Shahmukhi. Finalists include Amber Hosseini for *Nawan Pind*, Akmal Shahzad Ghuman for *Parchhawan* and Rajpreet Kaur Benipal for *Qabran Vich Ugge Phull*. The winner will be announced on November 18 in Surrey, B.C. Punjabi is Canada’s third most spoken non-official language.



The Extraordinary Life of Ordinary Things

In The Web Beneath the Waves, his wide-ranging collection of reportage, Samanth Subramanian connects the seemingly mundane to the political, historical and technological forces shaping our world

Shalini Langer

THE EPONYMOUS story in this book by writer-journalist Samanth Subramanian is the very last one, astonishing in the breadth of its detail into the web of seabed cables that power the Internet. From the laying of those cables in oceans to how they creep overground from sand, and converge within surprisingly and deliberately drab cabins; to the men involved in the exercise, from the pioneers and the prosaic to the ‘Meta’ rich; to the perils posed by both an interconnected and an increasingly disparate world to this, yet, vulnerable infrastructure on which rests the future of the modern world; to the aftermath of a volcanic eruption that leaves an island more isolated than it has been in over a century — nothing escapes Subramanian’s storytelling arc.

However, it is in the chapters preceding this one, especially the ones right at the start, that Subramanian really impresses with how he prises out the not-so-obvious webs and waves of routine news events. A compilation of articles written by him, which have appeared in various publications over the years, these do not neatly fall into one book, but they are retelling in the ground Subramanian covers and, as journalism is boxed into “micro attention spans”, in the space he has for it.

The book starts with ‘Midnight’s Grown-Ups’, in which Subramanian connects with a group of then 20-year-olds who appeared in a 1967 film called *I Am 20*, meant to mark two decades of Independence. Subramanian writes that he chanced upon the 19-minute film on YouTube in 2013 — towards the end of the Manmohan Singh government — “a dispiriting season for India, a season vacant of cheer or promise.”

As Subramanian chases the members of that group — many of whom have moved abroad, including the ones who seemed unlikely to do so in the summer of 1967 — he concludes “the true comforts were (those)... who could be excited and idealistic about our country’s future eleven as they remained worried and uncertain about it.” This wasn’t a “contradiction”, he writes, “it was an absolute necessity.” Not unlike the Gen Z who rocked a mighty government with some slogans and videos from Jantar Mantar; or the inspired Gen Alpha who are taking the same route now. In ‘The Confidence Man’, Subramanian charts the sparkle and sophistry of Lalit Modi, writing that the “audacity” of IPL’s success “depended entirely upon



WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

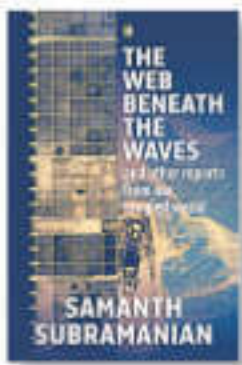
SHOOTING BILLS
An IPL match in India

Modi”, that “this tide of money could be disguised as a tide of cricket, guaranteed to wash over an Indian audience that is forever willing to diagnose itself as cricket-mad.”

In ‘The Vultures’, Subramanian’s writing truly takes flight as he links a bird saved from extinction to how it evolved differently in the New and Old Worlds, and occupies a crucial space in different Indian religions. His descriptions of people and places are sterling but, even so, this stands out: “Standing near a carcass, the long-billed vulture looks like a morose undertaker who has doffed his hat but refuses to take off his two-tone overcoat.”

In ‘Breach Candy’, Mumbai, which most of us know for the hospital by its name, Subramanian takes on its swimming pool, shaped like the map of India. “In building the pool... the British were emphasising their ownership of India... After 1947, the club insisted that it would continue to restrict membership to Europeans only,” he writes.

The pushback started in the 1960s but came to a head in 2012. “There were rumbles of fraud and corruption, of a mania for land and of politicians flexing their muscles... until we appeared to be talking not of the Breach Candy Club but of India herself, the country once again in perfect congruence with the pool... Even Indians, it appeared,



THE WEB
BENEATH THE
WAVES
SAMANTH
SUBRAMANIAN
324 pages
₹699
Westland

wished to be insulated from India.”

In a neat bit of irony, Subramanian returns to the theme in ‘The Rich vs The Very Very Rich’, where a quintessential English club is fretting over its takeover by a Chinese magnate. In ‘Lifetime Opportunity’, Subramanian writes about real-estate marketing, of the kind where properties have names such as ‘Empire Estate’, which “sounds like a manor where Cecil Rhodes might have retired after saving the Crown.” He writes about visiting model bedrooms with books “so widely out of the mainstream that they felt like genuine personal choices.” Examples: *Tom Bedlam* by George Hagen, and *Wanting* by Richard Flanagan.

He writes about the sprouting of apartments in Gurgaon and Noida, and visiting a development “that was not really a development, next to a racetrack that was struggling to become a racetrack, opposite a night safari that was years away from looking like a night safari, in an aspiring township that was still mostly fields and disputed land.” The estimated timeline for completion of all such townships: “three years.”

In ‘Hold Your Tongue’, Subramanian traces the life’s work of Ganesh Devy, the ambition and problems with his documentation of India’s languages, many of them

dying — a man talks of “speaking to stones” to keep his alive — as part of which he speaks with other linguist scholars across the world. In Devy’s view, Subramanian writes, “the co-existence of languages has long allowed Indians to ‘accept many gods, many worlds’ — an indispensable trait for a country so sprawling and kaleidoscopic.”

The chapter repeatedly goes into how this is under threat in the current ruling dispensation’s monotheistic worldview. Subramanian quotes Friedrich Max Muller. “It is said that blood is thicker than water, but it may be said with even greater truth that language is thicker than blood.” On another note, Devy’s close associate Jyotirmaya Sharma tells Subramanian: “When many languages thrive, there is the possibility that the smallest language, the most innocuous dialect, might contain the potential of saying that all-important word: No.”

Subramanian will lose readers over the next few chapters as he delves into the self-confessed micro world of quizzers like him, Singapore’s quest for land, Nigeria’s Jews, and cricket — writings that are more indulgent, less indulging. But then, he comes to Sri Lanka and its Easter Sunday terror attacks, and brings together the many strands of history and geography, and a religion besieged, to give us a story that can belong anywhere. As it does, with alarming regularity.

A chapter full of surprises follows, on the decades-long duel between paper towels and dryers on which does the job better, in riding hands of unwanted moisture — especially in public loos. As machines expand hold on our lives, Subramanian writes: “The wife of a hand upon a square of natural fibre is an astonishingly ancient action... The hand dryer’s essential ambition is to break a human habit tens of thousands of years old, and to persuade us that the few times we dry our hands daily... warrants a machine. It dares us to submit to its idea of modern life.”

Modern life is what Subramanian finally deals with in ‘The Web Beneath The Waves’ too, talking about, “a paradoxical wrinkle in the world of undersea cables.” “At a time when many wealthy governments are growing increasingly jumpy about their sovereign control over data infrastructure, poorer nations find that if they want better Internet at all, they must relinquish some of their sovereign control to Western tech giants.”

This, Subramanian writes, is “the liquid medium of the modern world” and — as has always been the case — it is difficult to gauge its depth. This book is a good effort.

QUICK VERDICT

MISS

Fever Dream

MINAKSHI THAKUR’S second novel, *Grief Burns Like Fever*, portrays the second wave of COVID lockdown. Set in Delhi, it follows an ambulance driver who ferries patients, and increasingly, bodies, to an overfilled crematorium.



GRIEF BURNS LIKE
FEVER
BY MINAKSHI
THAKUR
Tranquebar (Westland
Books)
296 pages
₹499

own interpretation. “It was tit-for-tat, an eye for an eye, untethered laughter and uncontrolled tears trying to defeat each other at any cost,” for instance.

Ultimately, *Grief Burns Like Fever* has the bones of an important book, but the meat isn’t quite there yet.

REVA THAKKAR

HIT

Bend it Like Nani

AUTHOR AND journalist Jasreen Mayal Khanna’s *Bullet Nani and Other Badass Indian Grandmas* will make you forget everything you know about grandmothers — knit sweaters, cook your favourite meal and dole out unsolicited marriage advice. Through 12 riveting accounts, she introduces feminist grannies who prove that reinvention has no expiry date.

These women are doctors, war-zone medic, scientists, models, entrepreneurs, YouTube creators, IPS officers, and much more. They belong to different regions, communities and class, but are bound by a refusal to let patriarchal expectations script their lives.

Khanna never presents these as larger-than-life figures. They are flawed; even their acts of rebellion can sometimes seem small and ordinary, but transformative nonetheless.

Khanna starts each story with an interesting anecdote, and then takes one back to the beginning of each of their journeys. It is a book about grandmothers, but really, it is about what we owe the women who came before us, and what we can still learn from them.

ANUSREE K C

MISS

In a Knot

BELLE BURDEN’S *Strangers: A Memoir of Marriage* was marketed as a cautionary tale for women who outsource their finances to their husbands. If a lawyer and Vanderbilt heiress could be blindsided by her husband of 20 years — father of



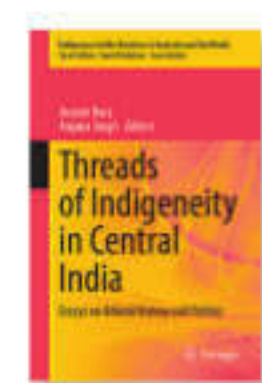
STRANGERS: A
MEMOIR OF
MARRIAGE
BY BELLE BURDEN
Jadden Collection
256 pages
₹599

relentless litany of club-room snubs. Where is the chapter on why she married a man who mirrored her own emotionally unavailable father? She tells you everything about what he did, almost nothing about who she was. It is a neat story of a wronged woman finding herself by the last chapter; it refuses to tangle with the messy bits. Utterly hollow.

AISHWARYA KHOSLA

Who Owns the Adivasi Story?

Joseph Bara and Anjana Singh’s anthology, *Threads of Indigeneity in Central India, identifies the silences in Adivasi historiography*



THREADS OF
INDIGENEITY IN
CENTRAL INDIA
BY JOSEPH BARA
ANJANA SINGH
Springer
327 pages

Aditi Athreya

APPROPRIATION, EXCLUSION and exoticisation. Since colonial days, the studies on Adivasis have mostly been confined within these three registers. In the last few decades, Adivasi scholars and academics have challenged this Orientalist and myopic view. Yet, our political discourse(s) continue to reproduce these presumptions, often using words like *vanvasi*, meaning “forest dwellers”, that deny Adivasis the right to claim “adi” ness or the first nationhood. The latest movement for separate religious recognition of Adivasis across central India also dismantles the premises of assimilative imaginations.

Against this backdrop, Joseph Bara and Anjana Singh’s new anthology, *Threads of Indigeneity in Central India*, is a necessary intervention. Divided into four sections — Land, forest and customary rights; Adivasi struggle for survival; Adivasi idea and identity; and Art, religion, language and culture of Adivasis — and 16 chapters, this anthology “acts to be in dialogue with the facts of the past and its interpretation of the present.” It is a significant contribution towards the studies of the marginalised in India, precisely for three reasons.

First, it challenges the recognition of Adivasis as “backward Hindus”, a term used by

sociologist G S Ghurye, regarded as the father of Indian Sociology. Drawing on archival sources and theoretical critique, Bara, in his introductory chapter, ‘Adivasi in history and history on Adivasis’, points out that “Adivasis have long been self-aware communities actively resisting assimilation.” Tribal scholar Virginus Xaxa, in his paper, reminds us of India’s rationale for not being a signatory to the United Nations Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples: Adivasis do not qualify to be termed indigenous people because they have always belonged to the broader Hindu Pantheon. This inherent logic of assimilation, Bara notes, led to the colonial and postcolonial policies that have mischaracterised Adivasis as “lesser people.”

Second, amidst the Hindutva groups’ demands for denotification (removal of Christian Adivasis from the reserved category) and a campaign against the alleged conversion of Adivasis to Christianity, this book offers a nuanced perspective. Mary Girard’s chapter, ‘Revitalisation of Adivasi language and culture: Grammars of Christian Missionaries’, highlights how Christian missionaries inadvertently became custodians of Adivasi languages and cultural practices. Through the production of grammars, dictionaries and scriptural translations, they documented oral traditions and linguistic struc-



WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

THE RIGHT STORY
Birsa Munda statue in Jharkhand

tures that might otherwise have disappeared. Girard argues that despite the colonial entanglements of missionary work, Adivasi communities benefited from these linguistic projects, using them to preserve and revitalise their traditions and heritage.

Third, it is telling that the editors devoted an entire chapter not only to narrate the rev-

olutionary life of Birsa Munda but also to interrogate why he was never unanimously embraced as a “freedom fighter” within the nationalist canon. This hesitation itself exposes how Adivasi resistance has been systematically marginalised and muted in the grand narrative of India’s Independence. It reminds us that the subcontinent’s historical memory has long been curated to privilege elite actors, while figures like Birsa Munda who embodied a radically different vision of liberation are either contested or erased.

The book foregrounds Adivasi voices, but its scope remains uneven. Its heavy concentration on eastern India — Jharkhand, Odisha and Chhattisgarh — portrays a partial picture of indigeneity in the subcontinent. By privileging this geography, the book risks reproducing the very silencing it seeks to challenge, leaving out the lived realities of Adivasis in southern India. Moreover, the absence of the hill tribes of the Northeast, particularly in Nagaland, Mizoram, Meghalaya, and Arunachal Pradesh, feels particularly glaring. Their histories of resistance complicate any singular narrative of “tribal” identity. The editors’ regional focus thus narrows the conceptual reach of indigeneity, inadvertently reinforcing the idea that Adivasi experience is homogeneous and primarily eastern. A more expansive lens would have enriched the project and challenged the tendency of mainstream scholarship to compartmentalise tribal histories. In this sense, the book opens an important conversation but leaves critical geographies and voices waiting to be heard.

Athreya is an assistant professor at Symbiosis School for Liberal Arts, Symbiosis International University

Heena Khandelwal

THE YEAR was 2007. Gauri Devidayal, a tax consultant with PricewaterhouseCoopers, and Jay Yousuf, who ran a telecom business in San Francisco, crossed paths. They married three years later, weeks before they opened The Table, despite no background in hospitality. Fifteen years on, they have turned it into one of Mumbai's most formidable names in food and beverage.

The award-winning restaurant refuses easy categorisation: Its "community table" is so popular that an Argentine consulate official ate there every night for years and left with real friendships to show for it. The Table Farm in Alibaug, supplying around 1.5 tonnes of produce a year, including the kohlrabi (turnip cabbage) surplus that became one of The Table's most-loved dishes. Magazine Street Kitchen (MSK), a 2,500-sq ft kitchen-on-hire that hosts regional chefs and serves as a residency for expat chefs alongside workshops and pop-ups. Mag ST., an all-day diner; Iktara, a delivery-only Indian kitchen; and the barely-a-year-old French sister of The Table, Kaspers.

None of it, they say, was ever planned further than a year or two out. "It's almost always driven by real estate," Jay says.

A bakery/cafe that wasn't

Jay first thought of a cafe and bakery, inspired by the patisseries he loved in San Francisco. The idea died quickly when a visiting chef, after spending four days assessing Mumbai's flour, water and equipment, delivered a flat 'no'.

Jay then pivoted towards what he had actually been missing — standalone, chef-led, ingredient-forward restaurants of the kind he frequented abroad. "Most fine dining in Bombay and Delhi is inside five-star hotels," he says. Those outside were serving Italian or Mediterranean or continental. Their dating-era was a loop of Indigo, Olive and Indian-Chinese standbys like Nanking. "It got repetitive after a while," says Gauri, who tried talking Jay out of the idea, before coming on board herself.

Kaspers, a high-street space that sat unused as a warehouse, was their biggest creative risk. But they credit its success to an unlikely source: the failure of an earlier venture



AKASH PATIL

KEEPING THE PLATES SPINNING

(Above) The Table founders Gauri Devidayal and Jay Yousuf; soft shell crab sandwich

The Table, by Two

As Mumbai's sought after dining space turns 15, founders Gauri Devidayal and Jay Yousuf on building an empire, one brand at a time

Launching a modern American restaurant meant finding an expat chef. Jay had long followed San Francisco chef and TV host Joey Altman, who recommended his cousin, the young Culinary Institute of America(CIA)-trained chef Alex Sanchez (now chef-founder of Americano and Otra), who was willing to relocate. The space, an old military cafe in south Bombay, nearly didn't happen either. Jay thought it too small and the couple chased a property at the World Trade Centre for months before returning, adding a mezzanine and finding their scale. It took 14 months to build.

Losing the founding chef

The Table opened in 2011 by word of mouth, to what Gauri calls "the foreign hangover" catered to by an expat chef. It also opened into a vacuum: nothing new had

launched in the city in six months.

The real test came in 2017, when Alex — whose food had defined The Table for seven years — left. "The team knew how to run the kitchen effectively but a lot of image management needed to be done," recalls Gauri. Roughly six months later, the arrival of John Solari settled the narrative. The Table has since cycled through two more expat chefs: Luke Robinson, whose precision Gauri viewed as stylistic detour from the restaurant's casual-but-technically-serious DNA. It returned with Will Ag-hajanian in 2023.

Walk in on any day and the room tells its own story — families at the community table, couples on dates, regulars who don't need the menu. The food matches that duality: precise enough for a special occa-



Neil Patil

Founder, COO & CTO, Veena World
neil@veenaworld.com

T wo weeks ago, we talked about the India you fly over. This week, I want to shift our attention from India to something that is deeply connected to India, but sits 7,700 kilometres away, on the western edge of Europe, largely invisible to Indian travellers.

Portugal. The country that actually shaped one of India's most beloved states for 451 years, gave us one of our most famous dishes, introduced chillies to our cuisine, built the churches that are now UNESCO World Heritage Sites in Old Goa, and then somehow ended up as the forgotten sibling of European tourism.

Indian travellers will fly to Barcelona, drive to the South of France, spend a week in the Italian countryside, and completely skip Portugal, a country that shares more cultural DNA with India than almost any other nation in Europe. And I should be honest here: I have been party to this myself. I have been to dozens of countries in Europe, I run a travel business, and I still haven't been to Portugal. The country that built the churches I have walked through in Old Goa, that gave us the vindaloo that we often relish, that ruled a part of India for longer than the British did. And I have never been. That, I think, tells you something about how invisible Portugal has become. In spite of that, I am convinced it's one of the great missed connections in Indian travel. Let me explain why.

You Already Know Portugal. You Just Don't Know You Know It.

Start with what's on our plate. The vindaloo we have in India, at home, at your favourite Goan restaurant, at the Sunday lunch that's been a family tradition for years, is Portuguese. The word vindaloo is a Goan pronunciation of carne de vinha d'alhos, which translates to meat in wine and garlic. Portuguese sailors brought the dish to Goa in the early 16th century as a way to preserve pork during long sea voyages. Goan cooks took it, swapped the wine for palm

vinegar, added the chillies that the Portuguese themselves had brought from South America, threw in tamarind and black pepper and cinnamon, and created something entirely new. But the bones of the dish, the vinegar, the garlic, the pork, are Portuguese. Every vindaloo is a 500-year-old conversation between Lisbon and Goa.

Now look at the buildings. If you have been to Old Goa, you have stood inside Portuguese architecture without necessarily thinking about where it came from. The Basilica of Bom Jesus, built in 1594, is Portuguese Baroque, the same style you will find in churches across Lisbon. The Se Cathedral, the largest church in Asia, combines Gothic and Manueline elements. Manueline is a style of architecture that exists nowhere outside Portugal and its former colonies. The azulejo tiles, those blue-and-white ceramic panels depicting saints and biblical scenes, that line the interiors of Goa's churches are the exact same tiles that cover the facades of buildings across Lisbon and Porto. The Royal Chapel of St. Anthony in North Goa has azulejo panels dating to 1681. Walk through the Alfama district in Lisbon, and you will see the same craft, the same palette, the same storytelling technique on every other building.

Even the pasteis de nata, those flaky custard tarts that Portugal is now globally famous for, have a cousin in Goa. The bebinca, Goa's layered coconut pudding, shares the same Portuguese obsession with eggs, sugar, and patience. Different dish, same DNA. The point is this: if you have been to Goa, you have already been to a version of Portugal. The real thing is waiting.

The Capital Nobody Expected

Lisbon is the most underrated capital in Western Europe. I don't say that lightly. It sits on seven hills overlooking the Tagus River, built in layers. Moorish foundations, medieval streets, Baroque churches, Art Nouveau shopfronts, and a modern food scene that's become one of the most exciting in Europe. The Alfama district is a maze of narrow cobblestone lanes where fado music drifts out of open doorways at night. Not the tourist-performance kind, but the real thing, sung in small bars where the singer closes their eyes and the room goes silent. Fado is to Portugal what ghazals are to Lucknow: an entire emotional vocabulary compressed into music.

Tram 28 rattles through the old city, climbing impossibly steep streets past



tile-covered facades. The Belem district, six kilometres west along the river, is where Portugal's Age of Discovery comes alive. The Belem Tower, the Jeronimos Monastery, and Pasteis de Belem, the bakery that has been making the original pasteis de nata since 1837. The tarts arrive warm, dusted with cinnamon, and cost less than two euros. There's a reason the queue never stops.

And here's the number that is worth noting: Lisbon is significantly cheaper than Paris, London, Rome, or Barcelona. A full meal with wine at a neighbourhood tasca costs what a starter costs in central Paris. Hotel rates are lower. Transport is cheaper. The Lisbon Metro is clean, efficient, and covers more than most tourists need.

Lisbon has everything the marquee European capitals have, the history, the architecture, the food, the nightlife, the culture, at a fraction of the price. It just hasn't had the marketing budget.

Where the Wine Lives

If Lisbon is Portugal's head, Porto is its heart. Portugal's second city sits on the steep banks of the Douro River, and it's one of the most visually dramatic cities in Europe. The Ribeira waterfront, a UNESCO World Heritage Site, is a cascade of terracotta-roofed buildings tumbling down to the river. Across the water in

Vila Nova de Gaia, the port wine cellars line the opposite bank. Taylor's, Graham's, Sandeman, Ferreira. You can walk from one to the next, tasting wines that have been ageing in oak barrels since before you were born.

Port wine is to Porto what champagne is to Reims: it can only be called port if it comes from here. The cellar tours are extraordinary, not just for the tasting but for the scale. Vast underground warehouses stacked with barrels, some holding wines from the 1800s. A tasting of four or five ports, including a twenty-year tawny that tastes like caramel and dried apricots, costs roughly what a single glass of wine costs in a London bar.

Porto's food scene is earthy and generous. The francesinha, a sandwich of ham, sausage, and steak, covered in melted cheese and drenched in a spicy tomato-beer sauce, is the kind of dish that sounds excessive on paper and feels absolutely necessary when it arrives. Bacalhau, salt cod, is prepared in what the Portuguese claim are 365 different ways, one for each day of the year. Whether that's true or not, you will eat it in at least five forms during a week in Porto, and not one will taste the same.

The Livraria Lello bookshop, with its crimson staircase and stained-glass

sion, unpretentious enough for a Tuesday — chicken wings and a soft shell crab sandwich alongside a rotating pasta programme — from a sourdough cacio e pepe named after Shannen Alexandra (head chef, Mag St. Bread Co.), who is obsessed with sourdough, to a lamb ragù pappardelle.

The estate bounty

Unlike The Table, which had its own small odyssey, MSK fell into their laps. The space belonged to Gauri's family — a stainless-steel manufacturing estate set up after Partition. A portion of it had been sitting empty since her father's business outgrew it. He had asked Jay to take a look.

Drawing on the underground pop-up dinner scenes they had experienced abroad, they launched a multi-purpose space for visiting chefs, workshops and one-off dinners in 2016. The early years brought in a wave of foreign chefs — including Will and Luke, who both first appeared in Mumbai as pop-up guests at MSK before joining The Table's kitchen. The space also spawned Mag Street Bread Co. Once bread production scaled past what Table needed, it grew into a B2C brand during Covid, before folding back into supplying the group's own restaurants, including Mag Street, now an all-day diner that began as a café.

Covid changed how they saw MSK. With the lockdown and freeze on travel, Gauri and Jay pivoted to hyper-local, regional Indian chefs. Today, "MSK2.0" holds space for both: regional Indian talent alongside expat chefs. Kaspers, too, began as a lease — a small high-street space that sat unused as a warehouse. They call Kaspers their biggest creative risk yet, crediting an unlikely source for the confidence: the failure of an earlier venture, Miss T. "Knowing that a restaurant not working out isn't catastrophic," Gauri says, "removed some of the fear of attempting bold new things."

Staying proud

Gauri's parents had warned her that going into business with your spouse was a recipe for disaster. So it would seem. She is logic-driven to a fault; Jay runs entirely on gut instinct. Her pushback changes his mind more than he would have guessed.

The group today employs roughly 600 people, remains entirely self-funded and has avoided the "scale game" — even after The Table's comeback on the awards circuit, landing at No. 1 on Condé Nast Traveller X District Top Restaurant Awards 2025. Ask how they would build The Table today, and they say: "Build something you are genuinely proud of. The rest follows."

HOME EDIT

CURATED BY SHINY VARGHESE

It works for you

A home study is about finding a space to slow down

Nilanjan Bhowal

A HOME study or office is more than a room full of books. It's a space to think, read, work or just find some quiet. Here are some simple tips to make your space shine:



DESIGN CONSORTIUM

SELECT THE PROPER LOCATION

Choose a quiet corner, away from the high traffic areas of the house. Natural light can make the space more inviting.

STORAGE THAT FITS YOUR NEEDS

Get shelves with solid shutters to store files, a separate one for books with glass shutters and keep space for open shelves.

FURNITURE MATTERS

A nice chair with a foot rest / a recliner and a functional desk with a high-back chair can make all the difference.

INCLUDE PERSONAL TOUCHES

Artwork, plants, photographs or objects can make the space feel more your own.

MAKE ROOM

Placing furniture or shelves on every corner can make the space feel heavy, give the room space to breathe.

Delhi-based Nilanjan Bhowal is principal architect, Design Consortium

ADVERTORIAL

Portugal isn't just another European country to add to the list. For Indian travellers, especially those from Goa or those who love Goa, it's the other half of a story you already know. The original half. And when you walk through Lisbon's Alfama district and see the same azulejo tiles that line the churches of Old Goa, or when you bite into a pastel de nata and taste the ancestor of every egg-based Goan sweet you have ever had, or when you hear fado for the first time and feel something familiar in its melancholy, you will understand that you didn't discover Portugal. Portugal, in a way, had already found you.

Know the Unknown

Ever since flight bookings launched on Veena World, I've been falling down rabbit holes about airports and runways. Since we're talking Portugal this week, here's one that stopped me. Madeira's airport had a problem - mountains on one side, ocean on the other, and a 1964 runway too short for most aircraft, with no land to extend it on.

So they built over the ocean: a platform on 180 concrete pillars rising up to 70 metres from the seabed, extending the runway to 2,781 metres by 2000. For a moment on take-off, there's nothing below but ocean and columns. It's won engineering awards, ranks among the world's toughest airports to land in, and only certified pilots attempt it. In 2017, it was renamed after Madeira's most famous son: Cristiano Ronaldo.

A runaway on stilts, named after a footballer, on an island belonging to the country that colonised Goa. Portugal doesn't do ordinary. See you next week...

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